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The Household Diary Study

Mail Use & Attitudes in FY 2021

UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE

John Mazzone - Financial Economist
Strategic Business and Financial Planning

United States Postal Service Headquarters
475 L'Enfant Plaza, SW RM 8441
Washington, D.C. 20260-5323

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NuStats
218 Trademark Drive, Suite A
Buda, Texas 78610

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Executive Summary

This report documents the findings of the United States Postal Service's Household Diary Study (HDS) for Fiscal Year (FY) 2021. The main objectives of the study are to:

- Measure the types and volumes of mail sent and received by U.S. households,
- Track trends in mail usage over time, and
- Compare mail usage by households' demographic characteristics.

The report examines these trends in the context of changes and developments in the wider markets for communications and package delivery.

Background

The Household Diary Study survey, fielded continuously since 1987, aims to collect information about households' use of the mail and how that use changes over time. The information collected includes household demographics, lifestyle, attitudes toward mail and advertising, bill payment behavior, and use of the Internet and other information technologies.

The FY 2021 report covers Government Fiscal Year 2021, with comparisons to 2019, 2020, and other years, as appropriate.

Overview

As seen in Table E.1, in 2021 U.S. households received 104.2 billion pieces of mail and sent 7.1 billion pieces. In total, mail sent and received by households accounted for 84% of all U.S. mail. Fifty-seven percent of mail received was sent via Marketing Mail. Only 2.5% of household mail (2.7 billion pieces) was sent between households while the rest was sent between households and non-households.

Table E.1:
Mail Received and Sent by Households
(Millions of Pieces)

Mail Classification	Received	Sent
First-Class Mail	35.1	6.5
Marketing Mail-Regular	47.0	—
Marketing Mail Nonprofit	12.2	—
Periodicals	3.6	—
Package & Shipping Services	6.4	0.7
Total	**104.2**	**7.1**
Household to Household	2.7	
Total Mail Received and Sent by Households *	108.7	
FY 2021 RPW Total	128.9	
Non-household to Non-household	20.2	
Unaddressed	0.9	—

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.
Note: Totals may not sum due to rounding.
* Total (108.7) is less than received (104.2) plus sent (7.1) because household to household mail (2.7) is included in both categories.

In 2021 households sent or received 84% of all U.S. mail.

Mail Markets

The Household Diary Study examines mail by the markets it serves. This design cuts across classes to provide a foundation for understanding mail flows and the marketplace changes that affect them. Table E.2 shows household mail volumes by market for 2019 through 2021.

Table E.2:
Household Mail Volume Received and Sent by Market Served
(Billions of Pieces)

Market	2019	2020	2021
Correspondence	15.1	15.1	15.0
Transactions	20.4	19.7	18.7
Advertising	73.2	61.2	65.8
Periodicals	4.2	3.9	3.6
Packages	4.9	6.3	6.9
Unclassified	1.8	1.7	1.5
Total	**116.0**	**104.8**	**108.7**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2019, 2020, and 2021.
Notes:

1. Correspondence and packages exclude double-counted pieces reported as both sent and received by households.

2. Advertising includes 3.1 billion pieces of First-Class advertising-enclosed mail but excluded from total.

3. Package volumes include 0.2 billion pieces of CD/DVD rental reported in First-Class Mail letters in Tables E.1, 1.5, and 1.6.

In 2021 correspondence mail totaled 15.0 billion pieces, accounting for 14% of all mail sent and received by households. Correspondence fell continuously since the early 2000's, driven by the growing migration of mail to emails and social media on the Internet. Over the last decade correspondence mail fell 15% but remained relatively flat in both 2020 and 2021. According to survey results, the recent volume plateau was driven by increases in government correspondence which offset most of volumes lost to online migration. The increases in government correspondence were likely related to the wide distributions of pandemic-related information and 2020 Census materials.

As in the case of correspondence, transaction mail was also significantly impacted by electronic diversion. Bill payments were the first type of transactions to migrate to the Internet, as banks and businesses were quick to provide convenient and inexpensive ways to make payments online instead of mailing checks or paying in person. Payments by mail started migrating to the Internet in 2004 and by 2010 their volume was less than payments made electronically. As Table E.3 indicates, over the last ten years the share of payments by mail plummeted, falling from 44% in 2011 to 19% in 2021, while online payments surged from 51% to 79%.

Table E.3:
Bill Payment Methods

Shares	2011	2021
By Mail	44%	19%
Electronically	51%	79%
In Person	5%	2%
Total Bills Paid	**100%**	**100%**

Bills and statements were the next transactions to start migrating to the Internet in the early 2000's. While the pace was initially slow, the transition accelerated quickly, as households became increasingly comfortable with receiving bills and statements electronically. In order to further accelerate households' transition to the Internet and reduce mailing costs, billers often introduced incentives (or penalties) to encourage (or pressure) households to move their transactions online. As a result, from 2011 to 2021 the percentage of bills received electronically increased from 15% to 40%, respectively, leaving a slimmer 60% majority in the mail-stream.

By 2021 80% of payments and 40% of bills had migrated to the Internet.

Advertising mail accounted for 60% of all mail sent and received by households in 2021. As Table E.4 illustrates, 89% of advertising mail received by households consisted of Marketing Mail (59.2 billion commercial and non-profit pieces). Another 10% (6.7 billion pieces) consisted of First-Class Mail ads, either stand-alone advertising (3.6 billion pieces) or advertising-enclosed (3.1 billion pieces). The latter is not counted as advertising mail pieces because the primary content (be it a bill, statement, or correspondence mailing) is already accounted for in the corresponding First-Class Mail category. In 2021 First-Class Mail advertising (stand-alone only) and Marketing Mail increased 5% and 8%, respectively, partly recovering from sharp losses incurred during the 2020 COVID-19 pandemic. Over the last ten years, stand-alone advertising and ads-enclosed fell 33% and 58%, respectively. As a share of total First-Class advertising, stand-alone ads increased from 43% in 2011 to 54% in 2021.

Table E.4:
Advertising by Mail Class

Mail Classification	Volume *(Billions)*	Percent of Total Advertising
First-Class Advertising	6.7	10%
Marketing Mail-Commercial	47.0	71%
Marketing Mail Nonprofit	12.2	18%
Total Advertising Mail	**65.8**	**100%**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.

Note: First-Class Advertising includes 3.1 billion pieces of advertising-enclosed pieces.

As shown in Table E.2, households received 3.6 billion periodicals by mail in 2021, a 6% decrease from 3.9 billion pieces received in 2020. According to Table E.5, magazines made up 70% of Periodicals delivered by mail and newspapers accounted for another 21%.

Over the last ten years periodicals fell 39% as readership and circulation levels fell sharply across all categories of periodicals. Principally, however, the decline was driven by a rapid transition from print to electronic publications, which were often cheaper or free substitutes of hard-copy content.

Table E.5:
Periodical Type Received

Mail Classification	Volume *(Billions)*	Percent of Total Periodicals
Magazines	2.5	70%
Newspaper	0.8	21%
Newsletters	0.2	6%
Unclassified	0.1	4%
Total Periodicals	**3.6**	**100%**

Source: Household Diary Study, FY 2021.

Note: Totals may not sum due to rounding.

The COVID-19 pandemic generated a surge in e-commerce activity which sparked significant increases in the number of packages delivered by the Postal Service. In 2021 households received 6.4 billion packages and sent 0.7 billion pieces (see Table E.6). Packages received by households increased 10% following a surge of 27% in 2020.

Table E.6
Packages Received and Sent via the U.S. Postal Service
(Millions of Pieces)

Mail Classification	2021			
	Received		Sent	
	Number	Percent	Number	Percent
First-Class Mail	2,198	34%	280	42%
Expedited	954	15%	260	39%
Ground Parcels and Packages	3,145	49%	110	16%
Unclassified	122	2%	20	3%
Total Packages	**6,420**	**100%**	**670**	**100%**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.
Notes:
Totals may not sum due to rounding.
Expedited includes Priority Mail and Express Mail.

Chapter 1: Introduction – Volumes & Trends

The United States Postal Service Household Diary Study (HDS) Report documents the findings of the Fiscal Year (FY) 2021 study. The HDS measures the mail sent and received by U.S. households, tracks household mail trends, and compares mail use between different types of households.

The Household Diary Study surveys over 8,000 households annually to gather information on the types, volumes, and uses of mail sent and received

The Survey

The Household Diary Study survey, fielded continuously since 1987, aims to collect information on household's use of the mail and how usage changes over time. The survey collects household information on:

- Volumes and types of mail sent and received,
- Demographics,
- Attitudes toward mail and advertising,
- Bill payment behavior, and
- Use of the Internet and other information technologies.

Findings are used for market research, forecasting, and strategic planning within the Postal Service and can be viewed on the Postal Rate Commission website.

The Survey Consists of Two Parts:

1) An **entry, or recruitment interview**, conducted by phone or Web, collects demographic and attitudinal information from about 8,500 households.
2) These households then receive a **mail diary**, which collects information on the mail the household sends and receives in a one-week period. Annually, about 5,200 households complete the diary.

The data generated by these two instruments are the basis of the analysis in this rep ort. The FY 2021 HDS report covers the period from October 2020 through September 2021, equivalent to the Government Fiscal Year (GFY) used by the Postal Service. Data from FY 2019 and FY 2020 are also reported on a GFY basis.

U.S. Postal Service Volumes

(This section reviews all mail volumes processed by the Postal Service, as reported in RPW reports. They include mail to/from households as well as business-to-business mail. All other sections of the report will focus exclusively on household mail.)

The COVID-19 pandemic has significantly transformed the mix of mail and packages processed by the Postal Service. At the onset of the pandemic, the Postal Service experienced steep declines in mail volumes and substantial growth in packages compared to pre-pandemic levels. As the U.S. economy recovered, the impact of COVID-19 on Postal Service's volume has partially abated. However, trends that continue to move further away from traditional paper communications and into electronic media have been further exacerbated by the pandemic.

In 2021, the Postal Service delivered 128.9 billion pieces of mail, a 0.2% decline compared to 2020 (see Table 1.1). Although minor the decline was the net result of a steep 3.9% decrease in First-Class Mail (FCM) which was mostly offset by increases of 3.4% and 3.5% in Marketing Mail and Shipping & Package Services, respectively.

The 3.9% (2.1 billion pieces) decline in FCM in 2021, which followed an even steeper decline of 4.8% in 2020, was driven by the migration of mail to the Internet as well as significant impacts of COVID-19 on mail usage. As an example of the latter, the pandemic-driven recession resulted in unprecedented job losses and lower consumer spending, which, in turn, contributed to a decrease in the number of bills households received and paid. Additionally, while confined to their home during the pandemic, household members spent more time using emails and on social media for their communications with others. This contributed to significant declines in the volumes of correspondence and greeting cards sent and received by mail. Nonetheless, while electronic migration continued, the effects of the pandemic on mail usage started to subside in the second half of 2021, as the economy recovered and people returned to work.

Marketing Mail, consisting mostly of advertising materials, increased 2.2 billion pieces, or 3.4%, in 2021, partly recovering from a steep loss of 11.7 billion pieces (or 15.5%) in 2020, at the onset of the pandemic. While it rebounded as the economy recovered, Marketing Mail volume remained well below pre-pandemic levels. Marketing Mail also benefited from high volumes of political and election mail associated with the 2020 general election season, which took place in the 2021 fiscal year.

Shipping and Packages volume increased 125.1 million pieces, or 1.8% percent, spurred by a surge in e-commerce activity that developed during the pandemic. The growth began to abate as the economy recovered and market competition intensified, but Shipping and Packages remained higher than pre-pandemic levels.

The Postal Service publishes the revenues, volumes, and weight of mail pieces going through the postal network in the Revenue, Pieces, and Weight (RPW) Reports. Table 1.1 presents the RPW volumes for FY 2021, including FY 2020 and 2019.

Letters, flats, and parcels are defined as follows:

- **Letters** refer to pieces that are less than 11.5 inches wide by 6.125 inches tall and less than .25 inches thick.
- **Flats** consist of pieces that are greater than 11.5 inches wide, 6.125 inches tall, or .25 inches thick, but less than 12 by 15 by .75 inches.
- **Parcels** are pieces that are larger than 12 by 15 inches, or thicker than 0.75 inches.

Because of the difficulty involved in recording mail-piece characteristics in the Household Diary, these categories do not correspond precisely to the shape categories used in RPW reports.

Table 1.1:
Total Mail Volume: FY 2019, 2020, and 2021
(Billions of Pieces)

	2019	2020	2021
Market Dominant Mail:			
First-Class Mail:			
Single-Piece	16.5	15.2	13.9
Presort	37.1	36.2	35.6
Other	2	1.5	1.3
Total First-Class Mail	**55.6**	**52.9**	**50.9**
Marketing Mail:			
Letters	53.2	44.9	47.7
Flats	21.8	18.5	17.9
Parcels & Other	0.7	0.6	0.6
Total Marketing Mail	**75.7**	**64.0**	**66.2**
Periodicals	**4.6**	**4.0**	**3.7**
USPS and Free Mail	**0.3**	**0.5**	**0.3**
Package Services Mail	**0.6**	**0.6**	**0.5**
Tot Market Dominant Mail	**136.8**	**121.9**	**121.6**
Total Competitive Mail	**5.7**	**7.1**	**7.3**
Total All Mail	**142.6**	**129.2**	**128.9**

Source: RPW Reports.
Note: Totals may not sum due to rounding.

Mail Flows

Mail volume can be broken into four basic flows, based on origin and destination. These flows are:

1) Household to household,
2) Household to non-household,
3) Non-household to household, and
4) Non-household to non-household, which is calculated as the residual of total RPW volumes less mail sent and received by households, as determined from HDS surveys.

Tables 1.2 and 1.3 show total volumes for each type of mail flow. Table 1.4 shows pieces per household per week for each flow.

Table 1.2:
Total Domestic Mail Flows
(Billions of Pieces)

Sent By:	Received By:		
	Household	Non-household	Total Originating
Household	2.7	4.4	7.1
Non-household	101.5	20.2	121.8
Total Destinating	**104.2**	**24.7**	**128.9**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.
Note: Totals may not sum due to rounding.

Table 1.3:
Total Domestic Mail Flows

Mail Flows	Billions of Pieces	Percent of Total Mail
Sent by Household	7.1	7%
Received by Household	104.2	81%
Total Household Mail*	**108.7**	**84%**
Non-Household to Non-Household	20.2	16%
Total Mail	**128.9**	**100%**

**Excludes 2.7 billion pieces sent from household to household*

Table 1.4:
Domestic Mail Flows per Household per Week

Sent By:	Received By:	
	Household	Non-household
Household	0.4	0.7
Non-household	15.0	N/A

Source: Household Diary Study, FY 2021.

Household Mail

As shown in Table 1.3 above, domestic mail to and from households represented 84 percent of total FY 2021 mail volume; equating to 108.7 billion pieces sent and received by U.S. households. As Table 1.5 shows, households received 104.2 billion pieces of mail and sent 7.1 billion. Both totals include 2.7 billion pieces of mail that households sent to each other in 2021, leaving 108.7 billion pieces of mail households sent and received in FY 2021.

Table 1.5:
Mail Received and Sent by Households
(Billions of Pieces)

Mail Classification	Received	Sent
First-Class Mail	35.1	6.5
Marketing Mail Regular	47.0	—
Marketing Mail Nonprofit	12.2	—
Periodicals	3.6	—
Packages & Shipping Services	6.4	0.7
Total	**104.2**	**7.1**
Household to Household	2.7	
Total Mail Received and Sent by Households	108.7	
FY 2021 RPW Total	128.9	
Non-household to Non-household (Residual)	20.2	
Unaddressed	0.9	—

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.
Note: Totals may not sum due to rounding.

Table 1.6 presents these data in two other forms, annual volumes per household and pieces per household per week. Many of the subsequent results in this report are presented in terms of pieces per household per week.

Table 1.6:
Pieces Received and Sent per Household

Classification	Annual Pieces per Household	Pieces per Household per Week
Mail Received		
First-Class Mail	270	5.2
Marketing Mail Regular	361	7.0
Marketing Mail Nonprofit	94	1.8
Periodicals	28	0.5
Packages & Shipping Services	49	1.0
Total Mail Received	**802**	**15.4**
Mail Sent		
First-Class Mail:	50	1.0
Packages & Shipping Services	5	0.1
Total Mail Sent	**55**	**1.1**
Unaddressed	7	0.1

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.
Note: Totals may not sum due to rounding.

Classes and Markets

- **First-Class Mail** is used to send transactional mail, correspondence, and advertising. Because it is limited to pieces weighing thirteen ounces or less, it primarily includes letters and cards.
- **Marketing Mail** is advertising mail. For the most part, Marketing Mail comprises letters and flats, although it contains a few postcards and packages as well.
- **Periodicals** are magazines, newspapers, and newsletters and are predominantly flat-shaped.
- **Package and Shipping Services** is used to deliver merchandise, books, catalogs, and media. Most of this mail is parcel-shaped.

Table 1.7 crosswalks between classes of mail and the markets they serve.

Table 1.7:
Mail Received and Sent by Households

Class	Market (Billions of Pieces)						
	Correspondence	Transactions	Advertising	Periodicals	Packages	Unclassified	Total
First-Class Mail	15.0	18.7	6.7	—	0.2	1.4	**38.9**
Marketing Mail	—	—	59.1	—	0.2	—	**59.2**
Periodicals	—	—	—	3.6	—	—	**3.6**
Packages & Shipping Services	—	—	—	—	6.5	0.1	**6.7**
Total Mail Received and Sent by Households	**15.0**	**18.7**	**65.8**	**3.6**	**6.9**	**1.5**	**108.7**

Source: Household Diary Study, FY 2021
1. Correspondence and Packages exclude double-counted pieces when reported separately as both sent and received by households.
2. Advertising includes 3.1 billion pieces of First-Class advertising-enclosed mail but excluded from total
3. First-Class Packages include 0.2 billion pieces of CD/DVD rentals sent to and received from Netflix and other vendors, reported in First-Class Mail letters in Tables E.1, 1.5, and 1.6.
Note: Totals may not sum due to rounding

Report Organization

The rest of the Household Diary Study report is organized around the markets the mail serves. Each chapter contains an analysis of the trends in the HDS data, as well as a discussion of how those trends affect and are affected by changes in the broader market. The following provides an overview of each chapter.

Chapter 2: Profile of Mail Usage gives an analysis of household demographics. This chapter examines demographic trends over time and their impact on the mail, and discusses attributing factors, such as access to technology and changing attitudes.

Chapter 3: Correspondence examines mail that is used solely or primarily to deliver (non-sales-related) communications, such as letters and greeting cards. This chapter includes analysis of both personal and business correspondence.

Chapter 4: Transactions reviews financial transactions in the mail and the impact of new technologies on that market. It analyzes household bill payment trends with a focus on technological and demographic change.

Chapter 5: Advertising Mail presents the trends in mail used to deliver sales-related messages. It contains information on household attitudes towards advertising by various media, treatment of advertising mail, and demographic determinants of advertising mail receipt.

Chapter 6: Periodicals examines magazines and newspapers delivered in the mail. It looks at how changing demographics are affecting the market for periodicals, and what the implications are for future volume.

Chapter 7: Packages analyzes household use of various types of packages.

In addition, there are three appendices to the report:

Appendix A contains a set of trend tables for major classes and types of mail

Appendix B documents the study methodology and discusses how the data were collected, weighted, and adjusted, and compares demographic data in the sample to that of the population as a whole.

Appendix C contains the instruments used to administer the survey.

Chapter 2: Profile of Mail Usage

Introduction

This chapter provides an overview of demographic trends and other factors affecting mail volume and a helpful tool when attempting to assess changes in mail volume. The breakouts introduced provide the framework for much of the analyses in subsequent chapters.

The first section looks at growth in mail volume, population, households, and delivery points over recent decades. The next section examines the demographic characteristics of mail users, contrasting higher-mail-volume households with lower-volume households. The third section details the emerging demographic and technological trends that will affect the future of mail. The last section examines some of the factors affecting the use of post offices and mailboxes.

Mail Volume and Demographics

Total U.S. mail volume grew from 110 billion pieces in 1981 to 128.9 billion in 2021, a cumulative increase of 17% which was closely related to the rates of both population growth and household formation. According to the U.S. Census Bureau, from 1981 to 2021 the adult population and the number of households increased 46% and 58%, respectively. The number of places to which the Postal Service delivers grew even faster, expanding 66% since 1981 (see the USPS annual reports). However, as Table 2.1 illustrates, from 2001 to 2021 average volume fell 2.3% annually. During the same period U.S. population growth, household formation, and delivery points increased close to 1% annually. Those diverging trends led to a combination of falling revenues and rising costs which resulted in significant financial losses for the Postal Service.

Between 2011 and 2021 mail volume fell 23% while delivery points and household formation increased 8% and 9%, respectively, thus hindering USPS' ability to fund universal service

Referring to Table 2.1, the 1980s were a time of extraordinary mail volume growth (4.6% annually) that began in 1978 and continued through 1988. During that period technology was a key facilitator of growth. Construction of computerized databases and techniques for sorting large amounts of data created a fertile climate for direct mail marketing. Computerization of financial systems encouraged billing and payments through the mail. These innovations were further encouraged by the expansion of postal rate discounts. The Postal Service introduced work-sharing discounts, encouraging mailers to prepare the mail in ways that reduced total system costs for creating and delivering mail. Mailers could take advantage of these discounts by sorting their mail by Zip code in advance.

In the late 1980s and early 1990s, mail volume growth decelerated, barely keeping pace with household growth as demand for mail contracted in response to a recession and two very large rate increases. The latter half of the 1990s, however, saw a rapid increase in mail volume, spurred by a strong economy and rates that increased by less than inflation. The Postal Service also realigned the incentives built into its price structure. It reduced the incentives mailers had for presorting mail and encouraged them to pre-barcode their mail. By 2002, the majority of letters the Postal Service received had qualifying barcodes on them. This restructuring of the rates took advantage of the extensive automation of mail preparation and sorting that occurred in the previous decade.

Table 2.1:
Mail Volume and Demographics
Average Annual Growth, 1981-2021

	1981-1990	1991-2000	2001-2010	2011-2021
Total Mail Volume	4.6%	2.3%	-2.1%	-2.6%
Delivery Points	1.7%	1.5%	1.0%	0.7%
Adult Population	1.5%	1.3%	1.2%	1.0%
Households	1.4%	0.9%	1.2%	0.9%

Source: U.S. Postal Service, U.S. Census Bureau.

During the 1990s, the U.S. economy rapidly embraced information technology and integrated the Internet into its business processes. An economic recession followed that began in March 2001. The 2001 terrorist attacks on the World Trade Center and the Pentagon, combined with the economic recession, caused a steep 2.2% decline in mail volume in 2002, which was, at the time, the largest annual decline since World War II. In 2003, Marketing Mail volume recovered to a new high, but total First-Class volume continued to decline. Since 2003, Marketing Mail volume grew along with the economy, reaching new highs and, in 2005, surpassing First-Class Mail volume for the first time. The ongoing decline in First-Class volume was caused, in large part, by the electronic diversion of payments, bills, and statements to various substitutes available on the Internet. The economic recession that began in December 2007 and ended in June 2009 had a severe impact on the mail. Total volume fell 12.8 percent in 2009—the largest decline since the Great Depression. In July 2009, the recession was officially over but was followed by a slow recovery that continued into 2020, when the COVID-19 pandemic emerged and returned the economy into recession.

Over the last decade, from 2011 to 2021, total mail volume fell 23%, driven by steep declines in Marketing Mail (-21%) and First-Class Mail (-30%), both impacted by the continuing diversion of mail to the Internet and, more recently, by the COVID-19 pandemic. In contrast, from 2011 to 2021 population growth, household formation, and delivery points increased 10%, 9%, and 8%, respectively. Such combination of lower volumes and more delivery point raised the costs of delivering fewer mail pieces and, hindered USPS' ability to fund universal service.

Characteristics of Higher- and Lower-Volume Households

Tables 2.2 and 2.3 illustrate how some households' demographic characteristics can drive mail usage more than others. For example, while the volume of mail received appears to be strongly correlated to income, it does not seem to be influenced by educational attainment.

Table 2.2 shows that households receiving less than 12 pieces of mail per week earned an average of $45,691 annually; by contrast, those receiving 36 to 44 pieces per week earned $99,512. Table 2.3, on the other hand, shows that mail volume was related to college graduates but not as clearly at lower levels of education.

Table 2.2:
Characteristics of Higher- and Lower-Mail-Volume Households

Mail Received *(Pieces per Household per week)*	Households *(Millions)*	Median Annual Household Income	Households w/ Internet Access *(Percent)*	Total Bills Paid *(Pieces per Household per week)*	Bills Paid by Internet *(Pieces per Household per week)*	Mail Sent *(Pieces per Household per week)*
45 or more	2.5	$104,752	96%	3.2	1.3	3.5
36-44	4.6	$99,512	92%	3.1	1.4	3.1
30-35	6.8	$84,795	92%	2.8	1.1	2.3
24-29	12.8	$95,154	95%	3.1	1.4	1.8
18-23	22.9	$84,611	97%	2.9	1.4	1.3
12-17	28.9	$77,112	96%	2.6	1.3	0.9
Less than 12	51.6	$45,691	93%	2.2	1.1	0.4
Total	**129.9**	**$66,991**	**95%**	**2.6**	**1.3**	**1.1**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.
Note: Mail received includes USPS and Non-USPS mail.

Table 2.3:
Education of Higher- and Lower-Mail-Volume Households

Mail Received *(Pieces per Household per week)*	Households *(Millions)*	Educational Attainment of Head of Household			
		Less than High School	High School Graduate	Some College or Technical School	College Graduate
45 or more	2.5	5%	23%	16%	55%
36-44	4.6	5%	22%	19%	53%
30-35	6.8	8%	23%	17%	52%
24-29	12.8	7%	20%	20%	51%
18-23	22.9	6%	27%	20%	45%
17-Dec	28.9	7%	25%	21%	45%
Less than 12	51.6	10%	27%	21%	40%
Total	**129.9**	**8%**	**26%**	**20%**	**45%**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.
Note: Percentages may not total 100 percent due to heads of households who did not answer the educational attainment question.
Percentages in this table are row percentages.
Excludes households not receiving any mail delivery at heir home address (using mailbox only).

Demographic Characteristics of U.S. Households

This section presents breakouts of households by demographic categories that can influence the volume of mail sent and received. It looks at both traditional and newly emerging factors. The following chapters will show how mail volume varies with these household characteristics.

Income, Education, and Age

Historically, mail usage has been determined by household income, education, and age. As Table 2.4 shows, in 2021 the relationship between income and education was fairly consistent at each level of income. At the lower end of the income scale (under $35K), a greater percentage of households (52%) were either HS graduates or had less than HS education. At the highest level of income (over $100K) the majority of households (67%) were college graduates.

The relationship between income and age, shown in Table 2.5, is somewhat more complicated. Up to retirement, at each income level, household income and age were fairly closely related. After retirement, households earn substantially less than those between 35 and 54 years old. However, by that point, mail behavior is pretty well set, and older households continue to receive similar amounts of advertising and periodicals, and pay similar amounts of bills, even though their income declines.

Table 2.4:
Households by Income and Education
(Percent of Households)

Household Income *(Thousands)*	Educational Attainment of Head of Household				Total
	Less than High School	High School Graduate	Some College or Technical School	College Graduate	
Under $35	18%	34%	25%	24%	**20%**
$35 to $65	8%	33%	22%	36%	**21%**
$65 to $100	4%	26%	21%	48%	**18%**
Over $100	5%	13%	15%	67%	**25%**
Don't know/ Refused	5%	25%	20%	43%	**17%**
Total	**8%**	**26%**	**20%**	**45%**	**100%**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.
Notes:
Totals may not sum due to rounding.
Percentages may not total 100 percent due to heads of households who did not answer the educational attainment question.

Table 2.5:
Households by Income and Age
(Percent of Households)

Household Income *(Thousands)*	Age of Head of Household				Total
	Under 35	35 to 54	Over 55	Don't Know/ Refused	
Under $35	26%	26%	48%	0%	**20%**
$35 to $65	25%	27%	48%	0%	**21%**
$65 to $100	21%	33%	45%	0%	**18%**
Over $100	14%	49%	36%	0%	**25%**
Don't know/ Refused	14%	27%	51%	8%	**17%**
Total	**20%**	**33%**	**45%**	**2%**	**100%**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.
Note: Totals may not sum due to rounding.

Household Size

The changing composition of households is an important determinant of the trends, volumes, and types of mail they send and receive. For example, family structure can influence the number of bills and the types of advertising materials households receive in the mail.

In 2021 the majority of U.S. households included either one or two adults. Households with three or more adults made up only 15% of the total (Table 2.6). When all household members are included (adults and children), households with three or more members made up 33% of all households (Table 2.7).

Table 2.6:
Households by Number of Adults
(Millions of Households)

Number of Adults	
One	33.1
Two	77.1
Three or more	19.8
Total Households	**129.9**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.
Note: Totals may not sum due to rounding.

Table 2.7:
Households by Size
(Millions of Households)

Household Size	
One person	29.0
Two	57.6
Three	17.2
Four	15.6
Five or more	10.6
Total Households	**129.9**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.
Note: Total may not sum due to rounding.

Internet Access

Access to the Internet has a strong and growing influence on mail usage. Bills, statements and, to a lesser extent, bill payments represent a significant component of mail sent and received by households. However, electronic activity in this area is diverting mail once used for these purposes. On the positive side, online shopping adds a growing number of package deliveries to the Postal Service mail stream.

Table 2.8 shows that 93% of US households have Internet access and almost all now have Broadband access. The highest levels of Internet and Broadband access are now in almost all households with incomes over $100,000 (each with 99%), as seen in Figure 2.1a. By comparison, households with incomes below $35,000 are somewhat less likely to have access to the Internet - either Dial-Up or Broadband (83% and 81%, respectively).

Table 2.8:
Households by Type of Internet Access
(Millions of Households)

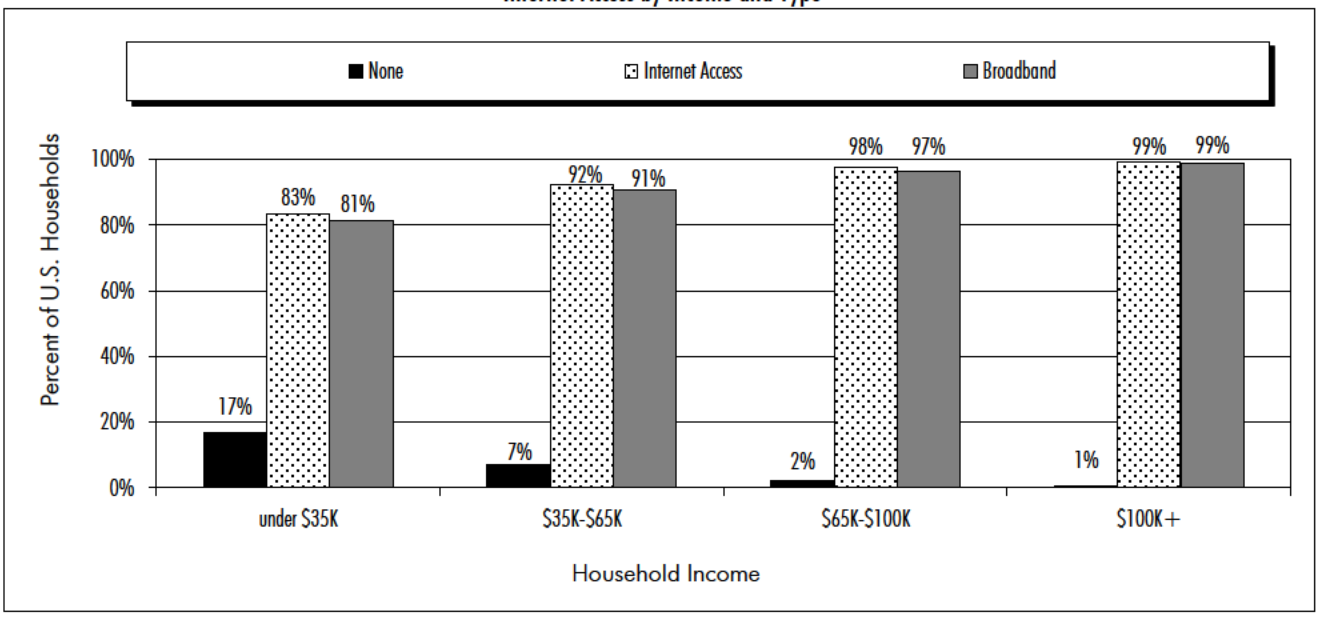
Type of Internet Access	
Broadband	120.6
Dial-up	0.4
None	7.0
Others	2.0
Total Households	**129.9**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.
Note: Totals may not sum due to rounding.
Others category include respondents with internet access but did not specify the type, missing answers and don't know/refuse answer.

According to Figure 2.1b, age is also a determinant of households' Internet access. Almost all younger heads of households (younger than 35 years old) have access to both the Internet and Broadband (99% and 97% respectively). However, about 15% of older heads of household (over 55) are still disconnected from either Dial-up or Broadband (87% and 85%, respectively).

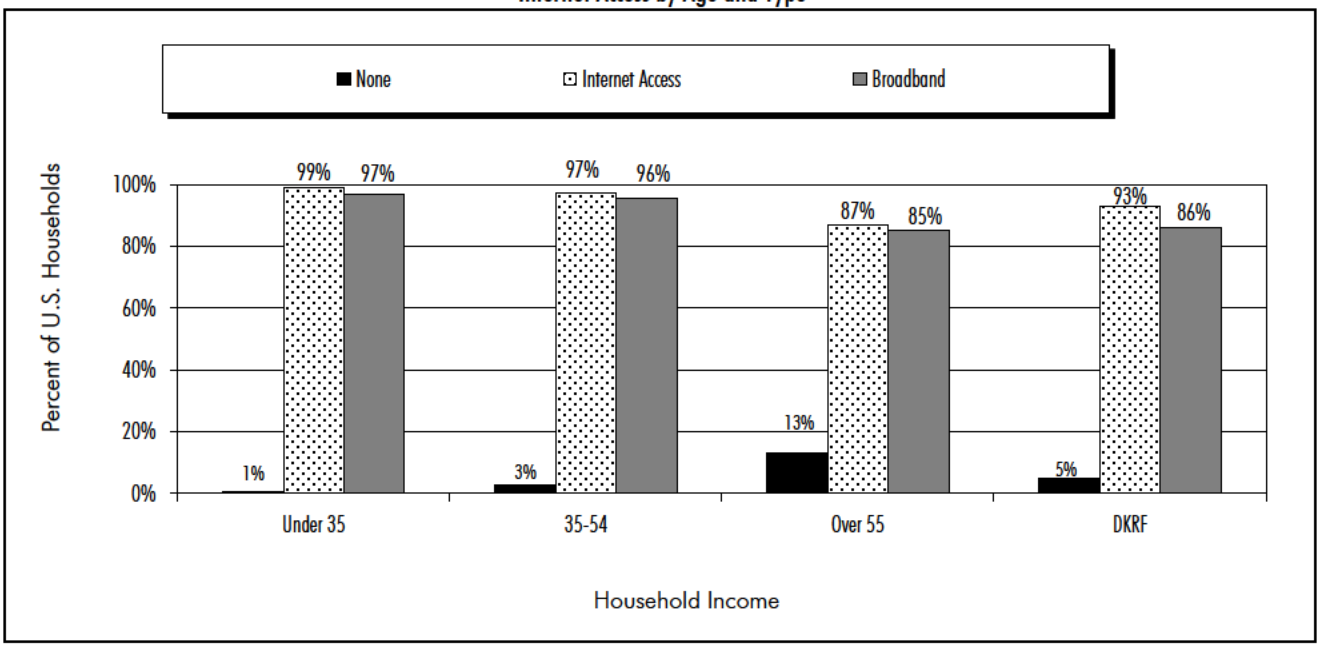
Figure 2.2 shows that number of Broadband subscribers has grown rapidly since the early 2000's. The number of subscribers reached 105 million in 2021, an increase of 42% just over the last ten years. Broadband's speed and ubiquity were key factors driving the rapid growth in the number of activities that could be conducted online, including several of the functions that were exclusive to the mail. Given that most households are now using Broadband, we can expect that bill payments, bills, periodicals, and even advertising mail, will continue to be diverted from the mail stream to other electronic channels.

Figure 2.1a:
Internet Access by Income and Type



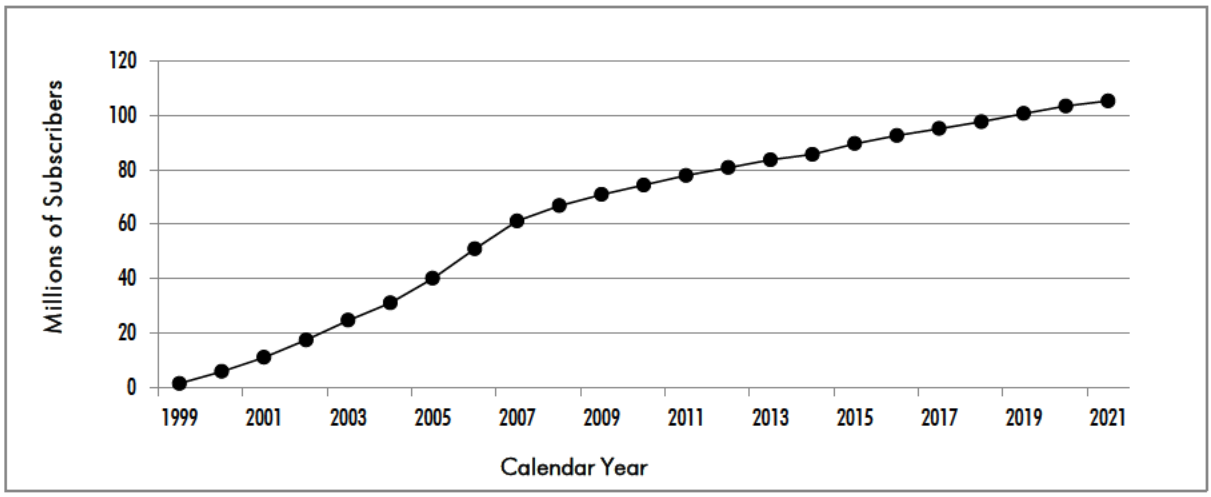
Source: HDS Recruitment Data, FY 2021.
Note: Sum of Internet Access and None does not equal 100 percent due to missing responses and access outside the home only.

Figure 2.1b:
Internet Access by Age and Type



Source: HDS Recruitment Data, FY 2021.
Note: Sum of Internet Access and None does not equal 100 percent due to missing responses and access outside the home only.

Figure 2.2:
Broadband Subscribers



Source: Leichtman Research Group.

Use of the Post Office

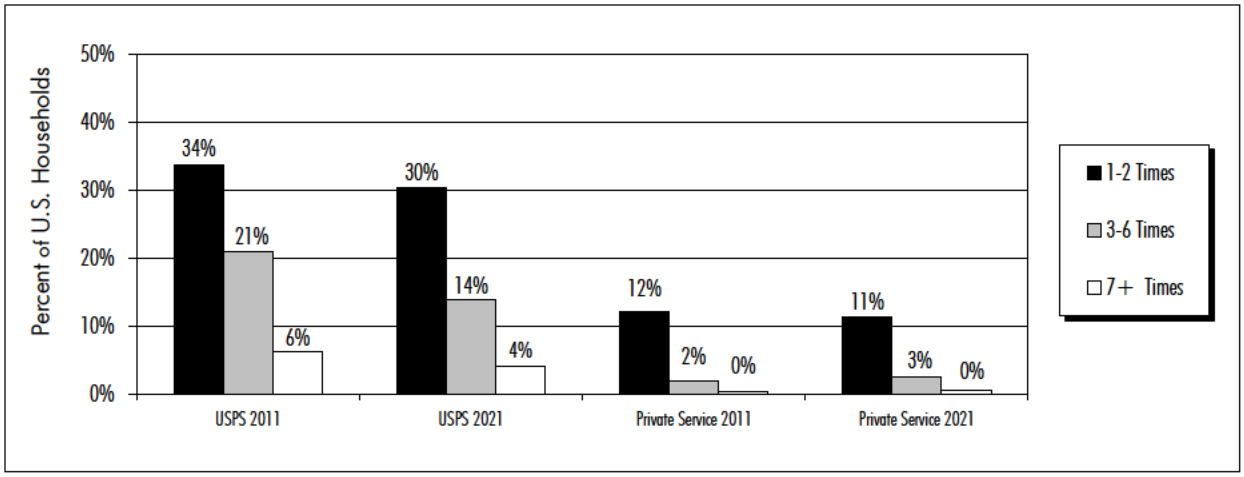
The Postal Service currently owns and operates 34,223 post office locations (including branches) throughout the U.S.

Figure 2.3 shows that, despite a declining frequency of visits over the last ten years, the use of post offices for mailing services continues to dominate the mail service industry. Forty-eight percent of all U.S. households patronized a post office at least once monthly in 2021, while only 14% visited a private mailing company. Also, more than 18% of households visited the post office three or more times a month.

Even with the growing availability of electronic alternatives to mail products and services, in-person visits to postal facilities remain strong.

A rented mailbox is one alternative that households use to manage their mail. In 2021, 3.1% of all households in the U.S. rented mailboxes from the Postal Service, compared to 0.8% that rented a box from a private company. Post office box use, however, declined sharply since the start of the millennium, when 10% of U.S. households rented a post office box.

Figure 2.3:
Household Visits to Post Office in Past Month



Source: HDS Recruitment Data, FY 2011 and 2021

Chapter 3: Correspondence

Introduction

This chapter examines correspondence mail among households and between households and businesses, including letters, greeting cards, invitations, and announcements. In several cases, this chapter, and several following it, examines comparisons in data between 2019 and 2021, providing an illustration of mail trends over time.

Correspondence Mail Volume

Correspondence mail volume started to decline in the early 2000's, when the Internet began introducing new and different ways of communicating with friends, family, and businesses. Ever-changing advancements in communication technologies led to widespread migrations of correspondence mail to faster and more convenient electronic alternatives, such as emails and social media. Such advances in technology have completely changed the marketplace and continue to have a strong influence on the use of correspondence mail today. As a result of these changes, correspondence mail experienced large and continuous losses in volume. Over the last ten years, from 2011 to 2021, volume fell 15%, a loss of 2.7 billion pieces of correspondence.

As seen in Table 3.1, in 2020 and 2021 correspondence volumes remained relatively flat. In both years, volumes lost to Internet were offset by increases in government correspondence, which were likely related to the wide distributions of pandemic-information and 2020 Census materials. As shown, in 2021 total correspondence fell just 0.2% to 15.0 billion pieces, accounting for 14% of all mail sent and received by households. Table 3.1 also provides a sector breakdown of correspondence mail flows. As shown, about three-quarters (74.3%) of the volume was sent by non-households (businesses and government) to households; another 19.4% of correspondence was sent from household to household. Households sent only 6.4% of their correspondence mail to non-households.

Table 3.1:
First-Class Mail Correspondence Sent and Received by Sector

Sector	Volume *(Millions of Pieces)*			Change, 2020-2021
	2019	2020	2021	
Household to household	2,803	2,819	2,793	-0.9%
Non-household to household	11,300	11,315	11,290	-0.2%
Household to non-household	973	946	966	+2.1%
Total	**15,076**	**15,080**	**15,049**	**-0.2%**
Sector	**Pieces per Household per Week**			**Share of 2021 Total**
	2019	**2020**	**2021**	
Household to household	0.4	0.4	0.4	19.4%
Non-household to household	1.7	1.7	1.7	74.3%
Household to non-household	0.1	0.1	0.1	6.4%
Total	**2.3**	**2.2**	**2.2**	**100%**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2019, 2020 and 2021.
Notes: Totals may not sum due to rounding.

Correspondence Mail and Household Characteristics

The following tables categorize correspondence mail sent and received by households according to the demographic characteristics developed in Chapter 2.

Income, Education, and Age

Tables 3.2 and 3.3 show that both household income and educational attainment have a strong influence on the volume of correspondence sent and received by households. In most cases, households with higher incomes or higher levels of education received and sent significantly more correspondence mail than those at the other end of each spectrum. These relationships are more evident when measured against household income than against educational levels.

Table 3.2:
Correspondence Mail Received by Income and Education
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Income *(Thousands)*	Educational Attainment of Head of Household				Average
	Less than High School	High School Graduate	Some College or Technical School	College Graduate	
Under $35	1.9	1.5	1.4	1.6	**1.6**
$35 to $65	3.1	1.8	1.9	1.7	**1.9**
$65 to $100	3.4	2.2	2.4	2.1	**2.2**
Over $100	3.0	2.6	2.1	2.4	**2.4**
Average	**2.4**	**2.0**	**1.9**	**2.2**	**2.1**

Table 3.3:
Correspondence Mail Sent by Income and Education
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Income *(Thousands)*	Educational Attainment of Head of Household				Average
	Less than High School	High School Graduate	Some College or Technical School	College Graduate	
Under $35	.4	.5	.3	.5	**.4**
$35 to $65	.3	.5	.5	.4	**.4**
$65 to $100	.2	.6	.7	.6	**.6**
Over $100	.8	.6	.6	.7	**.7**
Average	**.5**	**.5**	**.5**	**.7**	**.6**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.
Note: Excludes Don't Know/Refused.

Tables 3.4 and 3.5 illustrate that age is a strong determinant of households' use of correspondence mail. Irrespective of their income, younger households received fewer pieces of correspondence mail. Young adults have traditionally sent and received less mail than older adults; the Internet apparently widened the gap between age groups even further.

Table 3.4:
Correspondence Mail Received by Income and Age
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Income *(Thousands)*	Age of Head of Household			Average
	Under 34	35 to 54	Over 55	
Under $35	1.2	1.3	1.9	**1.6**
$35 to $65	1.3	1.4	2.5	**1.9**
$65 to $100	1.8	1.9	2.7	**2.2**
Over $100	1.6	2.2	3.0	**2.4**
Average	**1.4**	**1.9**	**2.5**	**2.1**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.

Table 3.5:
Correspondence Mail Sent by Income and Age
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Income *(Thousands)*	Age of Head of Household			Average
	Under 34	35 to 54	Over 55	
Under $35	.5	.3	.5	**.4**
$35 to $65	.3	.3	.6	**.4**
$65 to $100	.4	.5	.8	**.6**
Over $100	.3	.6	.8	**.7**
Average	**.4**	**.5**	**.7**	**.6**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.

Household Size

As would be expected, household size had a positive effect on the volume of correspondence mail sent and received. In Tables 3.6 and 3.7, the jump from one to two persons is associated with a considerable increase in correspondence mail use. Further increases in size, however, had no discernible impact. In Table 3.7, however, we do see that increases in correspondence related to household size were generally driven by the presence of additional adults in the household.

Table 3.6:
Correspondence Mail Received and Sent
by Household Size
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Size	Received	Sent
One person	1.6	.4
Two	2.1	.6
Three	2.5	.7
Four	2.4	.6
Five or more	2.5	.6
Total	**2.1**	**.6**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.

Table 3.7:
Correspondence Mail Received and Sent
by Number of Adults in Household
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Number of Adults	Received	Sent
One	1.5	.4
Two	2.2	.6
Three or more	2.8	.7
Average	**2.1**	**.6**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.

Internet Access

As illustrated in Table 3.8, households with Internet access received significantly more correspondence than households without such service. The explanation for this result lies in the strong relationship that both income and educational attainment have with the presence of an Internet connection in the home. In Table 3.9, households with Internet access have substantially more income and education than those without a connection.

With respect to correspondence mail sent by households, Table 3.8 does not indicate a clear impact of Internet access on volumes.

Table 3.8:
Correspondence Mail Received and Sent by Type of Internet Access
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Type of Internet Access	Received	Sent
Broadband	2.1	.6
Dial-up	1.5	.2
None	1.9	.7
Others	2.3	.6
Average	**2.1**	**.6**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.

Table 3.9:
Income and Education by Type of Internet Access

Type of Internet Access	Median Income	% w/ College Degree
Broadband	70,507	46%
Dial-up	44,686	9%
None	27,689	14%
Others	39,830	41%

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.

Personal Correspondence

In FY 2021 households sent and received 2.8 billion pieces of personal correspondence, a decline of 0.9% compared to 2020. Table 3.10 details volumes by type of correspondence. In 2021 both personal letter and greeting card volumes fell from 2020, but those declines were largely offset by a strong increase (28.2%) in the volume of invitations and announcements. The lower volumes of letters and greeting cards were in large part due to the migration of personal correspondence mail to emails and social networks on the Internet.

Table 3.10:
Personal Correspondence Sent and Received

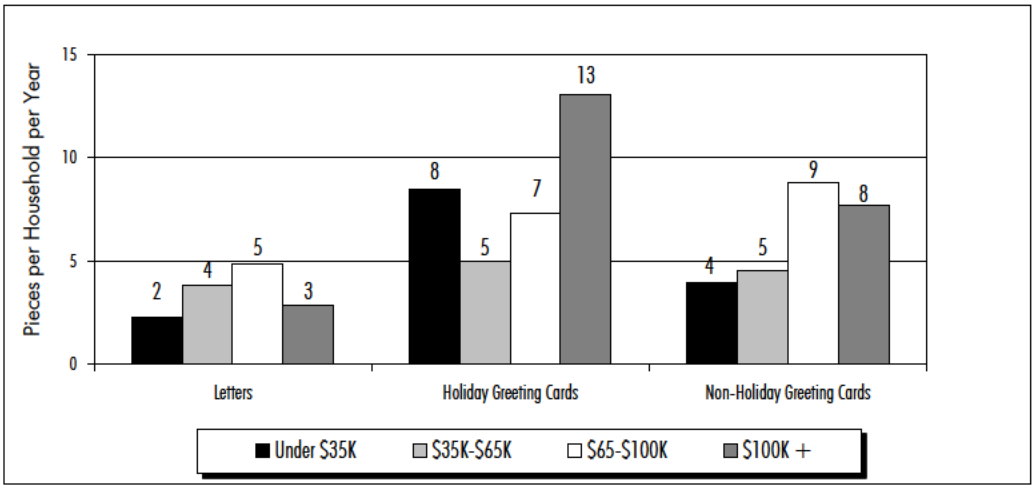
Correspondence Type	Volume *(Millions of Pieces)*			Change: 2020-2021
	2019	2020	2021	
Personal Letters	464	499	489	-2.0%
Holiday Greeting Cards	1,170	1,108	1,085	-2.1%
Non-Holiday Greeting Cards	797	925	858	-7.2%
Invitations/Announcements	315	238	305	+28.2%
Other Personal	57	50	55	+10.0%
Total	**2,803**	**2,819**	**2,793**	**-0.9%**
Correspondence Type	**Pieces per Household per Week**			**Share of 2021 Total**
	2019	**2020**	**2021**	
Personal Letters	.1	.1	.1	16.6%
Holiday Greeting Cards	.2	.1	.2	42.0%
Non-Holiday Greeting Cards	.1	.1	.1	29.1%
Invitations / Announcements	.0	.0	.0	10.3%
Other Personal	.0	.0	.0	1.9%
Total	**.4**	**.4**	**.4**	**100.0%**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2019, 2020 and 2021.
Note: Totals may not sum due to rounding

Figure 3.1 illustrates how the various categories of personal correspondence were impacted by income. The number of Holiday greeting cards sent by households showed a strong correlation with incomes over $35K. On the other hand, the relationship of both letters and non-Holiday greeting cards with income was strong only with incomes under $100K.

The largest disparity between high- and low-income households was in the volume of Holiday greeting cards sent. Households with incomes over $100K sent an average of 13 cards in FY 2021, while households with incomes of $35K to $65K sent only 5 cards annually.

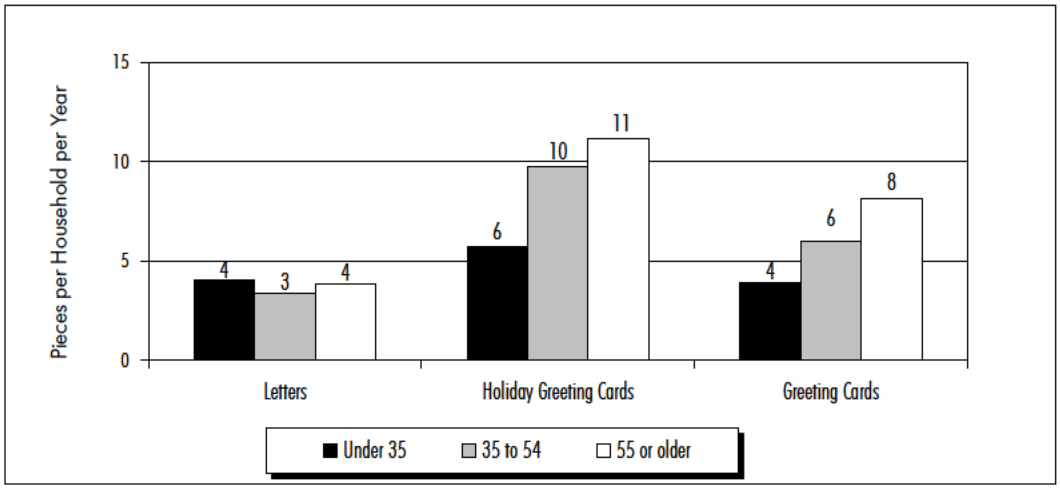
Figure 3.1:
Personal Correspondence Sent by Income Group
(Pieces per Household per Year)



Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.

In Figure 3.2, the number of greeting cards sent seems to follow a pattern where the number of greeting cards sent grows as the age of the head of household increases. The disparity between young and old is most significant for Holiday greeting cards. Letters do not appear to be affected by age.

Figure 3.2:
Personal Correspondence Sent by Age Cohort
(Pieces per Household per Year)

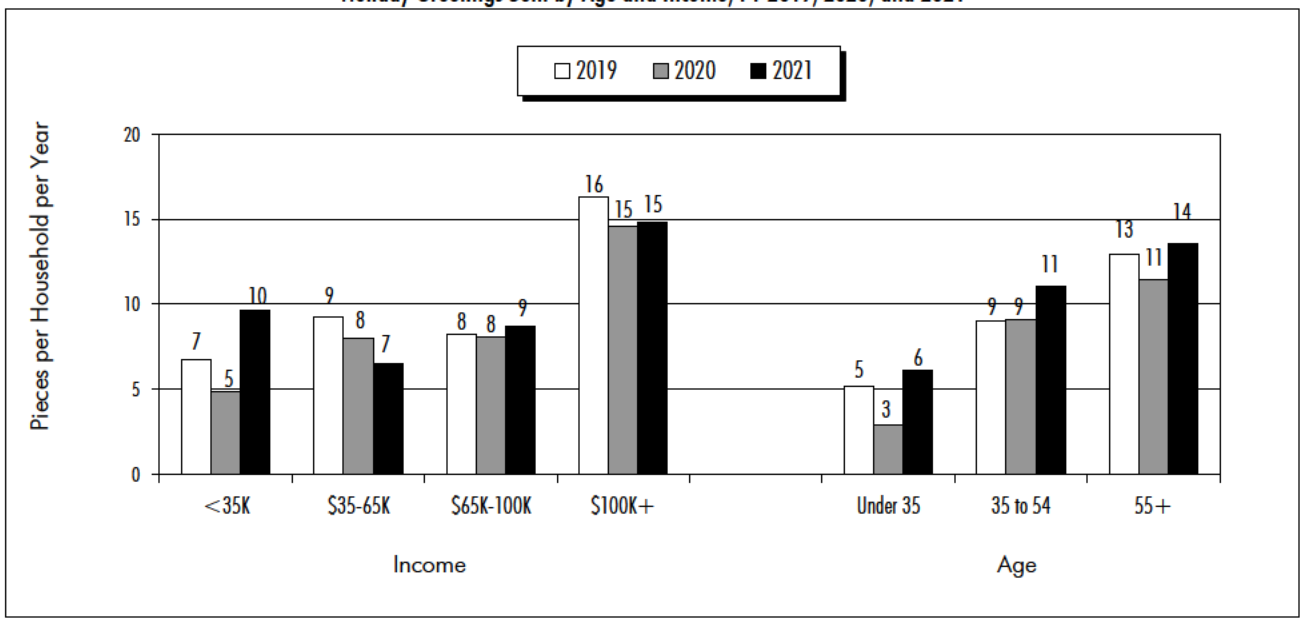


Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.

Figure 3.3 shows the effects of income and age on Holiday greeting cards sent over the last three-year period. In FY 2021, as in prior years, households with incomes over $100K sent more greeting cards than those with lower incomes, though they also experienced a decline in volume compared to 2019. Households with incomes lower than $35K, however, experienced the strongest growth in the volume of greeting cards sent, which increased from 5 to 10 cards from 2020 to 2021.

When examined by age, the number of Holiday greeting cards sent by households in 2021 increased for all age cohorts compared to 2020. As would be expected, younger heads of household mailed the least number of cards. However, they also experienced the largest increase in cards sent, which doubled from 3 to 6 from 2020 to 2021. As in prior years, heads of household over 55 mailed more Holiday greeting cards than any other age cohort.

Figure 3.3:
Holiday Greetings Sent by Age and Income, FY 2019, 2020, and 2021



Source: HDS Diary data, Diary Sample only, FY 2019, 2020, and 2021.

Typically, households with Internet access are more likely to make more frequent use of emails and social networking and consequently send fewer letters and cards. However, in 2021 results were somewhat mixed, showing the same number of total personal correspondence pieces (0.38), regardless of Internet access status. While internet access did display a slightly negative correlation with the number of letter and Holiday greeting cards sent, non-Holiday greeting cards showed a positive correlation. In net, both households with and without Internet access sent a total of 0.38 pieces of personal correspondence per week, as the lower number of letters and Holiday-greeting cards sent by households with Internet access was fully offset by the higher number of non-Holiday greeting cards sent.

Table 3.11:
Personal Correspondence by Type of Internet Access
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Correspondence Type	No Internet Access	Internet Access
Personal Letters	.08	.07
Holiday Greeting Cards	.20	.18
Non-Holiday Greeting Cards	.11	.13
Total	**.38**	**.38**

Source: HDS Diary Sample FY 2021

Business Correspondence

This section examines the use and types of correspondence mailed between households and non-households (primarily businesses but also government and social organizations). In addition to correspondence, households and businesses also exchange bills, payments, and advertising materials. These topics are discussed in detail in Chapters 4 (for transactions mail) and chapter 5 (for advertising mail).

According to Table 3.1 above, correspondence received from the non-household sector was the main component of total correspondence sent and received by households, accounting for about 74% of the total volume. Table 3.12 presents changes in business correspondence by type and by sector. In 2021 total business correspondence received by households fell just 0.2%; almost unchanged from 2020. The small decline was the net result of two large and offsetting changes, as the 14% decline in social correspondence received (mainly non-profit and political mail) was mostly offset by the 1.1% increase in business correspondence. The rise in government correspondence received was partly due to nationwide distributions of pandemic-related information and 2020 Census materials. Total business correspondence sent by households increased 2.1%, with all three major sectors (social, business, and government) contributing to the growth.

Table 3.12:
Business Correspondence Sent and Received by type and Sector
(Millions of Pieces)

Business Correspondence Type	2019	2020	2021	Change, 2020-2021
Business/Government/Social Received by Households				
Invitation/Announcement	4,546	4,492	4,376	-2.6%
Insurance Related (EOBs, etc.)	2,565	2,222	2,330	4.8%
Tax Related	1,159	1,221	1,399	14.6%
Other Business/Government	2,027	2,366	2,313	-2.2%
Total Business/Government Received	**10,297**	**10,301**	**10,418**	1.1%
Announcement	511	436	385	-11.7%
Other Social	492	579	487	-15.8%
Total Social Received	**1,003**	**1,014**	**872**	**-14.0%**
Total Business Correspondence Received	**11,300**	**11,315**	**11,290**	**-0.2%**
Business/Government/Social Sent by Households				
Tax-Related	151	109	178	62.5%
Surveys/Sweepstakes	236	145	166	15.1%
Greeting Cards/Letters/Invitations	104	118	146	24.1%
Other Business/Government	325	410	296	-27.9%
Total Business/Government Sent	**816**	**782**	**786**	**0.5%**
Letters/Surveys/Election Materials	96	123	80	-34.3%
Other Social	62	42	100	135.6%
Total Social Sent (Social includes social, political & nonprofit.)	**158**	**165**	**180**	**9.3%**
Total Business Correspondence Sent	**973**	**946**	**966**	**2.1%**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2019, 2020 and 2021.
Notes: Totals may not sum due to rounding

Chapter 4: Transactions

Introduction

This chapter examines the volumes and types of transaction mail sent and received by households. Transaction categories include bills, statements, payments, donations, rebates, and other minor categories.

Transaction Mail

In 2021 transaction mail sent and received accounted for 17% of all household mail (see Table E.2) and 48% of all First-Class Mail sent and received by households; as such, transactions represent a major component of the mail stream.

As Table 4.1 illustrates, in 2021 total transaction mail sent and received by households fell 5.1% from 2020. Most categories contributed to the decline and were in large part driven by the migration of mail to the Internet.

Businesses benefited significantly from the lower costs of processing bills, statements, and payments online (e.g.: lower printing, mailing, document processing, and labor costs) and, for that reason, offered incentives (or imposed penalties) to encourage (or force) more customers to move their transactions online.

Bills and statements were initially slow to migrate online as most households felt uncomfortable leaving the mail, mostly for record-keeping or account security reasons. Over the last decade, however, a growing share of households became more comfortable with the Internet and opted to make the switch, driving the volumes of bills and statements delivered by mail down 42% between 2011 and 2021.

Bill payments began migrating to the Internet in the early 2000's and, unlike bills and statements, were quickly adopted for their convenience, low cost, and ease of use. Payments by mail began declining in 2004 and by 2010 fell 45%, from 10.1 to 5.5 billion pieces. More recently, from 2011 to 2021, payments by mail fell an additional 56%, to 2.4 billion pieces.

As Table 4.1 illustrates, in 2021 bills and statements received by mail fell 7.4% and 7.5% respectively. Bill payments declined at a slower 1.4% rate, as most of the volume has already moved online. In Table 4.1 we also see that, for each of the three years, the number of bills paid represented only about one-third of bills received. The other two-thirds were mostly paid electronically.

Table 4.1:
Transactions Mail Sent and Received

Transaction Type	Volume (Millions of Pieces)			Change, 2020-2021
	2019	2020	2021	
Business				
Bills	11,301	10,535	9,751	-7.4%
Bill Payments	2,784	2,467	2,432	-1.4%
Statements	3,741	3,871	3,582	-7.5%
Payments (to households)	745	807	920	14.0%
Orders	143	169	132	-21.9%
Rebates	98	124	100	-19.4%
Other Transactions	612	660	703	6.5%
Total Business	**19,424**	**18,633**	**17,620**	**-5.4%**
Social/Charitable				
Request for Donation	482	515	522	1.4%
Donations	247	304	278	-8.6%
Bills	67	58	42	-27.6%
Confirmations	186	159	202	27.0%
Total Social/Charitable	**981**	**1,036**	**1,043**	**0.7%**
Total Transactions	**20,404**	**19,669**	**18,663**	**-5.1%**

Table 4.1:
Transactions Mail Sent and Received (cont.)

Transaction Type	Pieces per Household per Week			Share 2021
	2019	2020	2021	
Business				
Bills	1.7	1.6	1.4	52.2%
Bill Payments	0.4	0.4	0.4	13.0%
Statements	0.6	0.6	0.5	19.2%
Payments (to HH)	0.1	0.1	0.1	4.9%
Orders	0.02	0.03	0.02	0.7%
Rebates	0.01	0.02	0.01	0.5%
Other Transactions	0.1	0.1	0.1	3.8%
Total Business	**2.9**	**2.8**	**2.6**	**94.4%**
Social/Charitable				
Request for Donation	0.1	0.1	0.1	2.8%
Donations	0.0	0.05	0.04	1.5%
Bills	0.01	0.01	0.01	0.2%
Confirmations	0.03	0.02	0.03	1.1%
Total Social/Charitable	**0.1**	**0.2**	**0.2**	**5.6%**
Total Transactions	**3.1**	**2.9**	**2.8**	**100.0%**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2019, 2020 and 2021.

Transaction Mail and Household Characteristics

The following tables examine transactions mail sent and received by households based on the demographic characteristics outlined in Chapter 2.

Income, Education, and Age

As shown in Tables 4.2 and 4.3, household income had a strong influence on the volume of transaction mail received. Educational attainment, however, had no discernible effect on volume.

In general, higher-income households are more likely to be Internet users and recipients of electronic bills. However, higher income households also have more financial accounts which, in turn, generate more bills and statements, creating more transaction mail than lower income households.

As we look at transaction mail sent by households, neither income nor education seem to have a measurable impact on volumes (Table 4.3). While higher income households are inclined to have more financial accounts and more bills to pay, they are also likely to have greater access to the Internet and pay at least some portion of their bills online. In net, the positive impact of higher income and the negative impact of a portion of payments being made electronically tend to offset each other, leaving the volume of payments by mail relatively unaffected.

Table 4.2:
Transactions Mail Received by Income and Education
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Income *(Thousands)*	Educational Attainment of Head of Household				Average
	Less than High School	High School Graduate	Some College or Technical School	College Graduate	
Under $35	1.7	1.6	1.5	1.4	**1.5**
$35 to $65	2.4	2.4	2.4	1.8	**2.2**
$65 to $100	4.5	2.6	2.7	2.2	**2.5**
Over $100	4.2	3.2	2.9	2.6	**2.8**
Average	**2.6**	**2.3**	**2.4**	**2.3**	**2.3**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.

Table 4.3:
Transactions Mail Sent by Income and Education
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Income *(Thousands)*	Educational Attainment of Head of Household				Average
	Less than High School	High School Graduate	Some College or Technical School	College Graduate	
Under $35	0.4	0.4	0.3	0.5	**0.4**
$35 to $65	0.5	0.4	0.4	0.4	**0.4**
$65 to $100	0.1	0.3	0.4	0.4	**0.4**
Over $100	0.4	0.5	0.5	0.4	**0.4**
Average	**0.4**	**0.4**	**0.4**	**0.4**	**0.4**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.

Tables 4.4 and 4.5 show that age has a greater influence on the volume of transaction mail sent and received than other demographic characteristics. Across all income categories, younger heads of household sent and received fewer transaction mail pieces. In part, this was because younger individuals are less likely to own a home and usually have fewer insurance policies, investments, and the like. However, it is also the case that younger heads of household are more active users of electronic alternatives for traditionally mail-based transactions. This is particularly evident with transactions mail sent (primarily bill payments) by heads of household under 35 years old, as they mailed just 14% of all transaction mail sent by head of households over 55 years old.

Heads of household under 35 years of age mailed only 14% of transaction mail sent by heads over 55

Table 4.4:
Transactions Mail Received by Income and Age
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Income *(Thousands)*	Age of Head of Household			Average
	Under 35	35 to 54	Over 55	
Under $35	.9	1.3	2.0	**1.5**
$35 to $65	1.2	2.0	2.8	**2.2**
$65 to $100	1.8	2.2	3.1	**2.5**
Over $100	1.5	2.6	3.7	**2.8**
Average	**1.2**	**2.2**	**2.9**	**2.3**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.

Table 4.5:
Transactions Mail Sent by Income and Age
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Income *(Thousands)*	Age of Head of Household			Average
	Under 35	35 to 54	Over 55	
Under $35	0.1	0.3	0.6	**0.4**
$35 to $65	0.0	0.3	0.7	**0.4**
$65 to $100	0.1	0.2	0.6	**0.4**
Over $100	0.1	0.3	0.8	**0.4**
Average	**0.1**	**0.3**	**0.7**	**0.4**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.

Household Size

In terms of household size, Table 4.6 shows that an increase from a one-person household to two-person household adds 41% (0.7 pieces) more transaction mail received per week and 25% (0.1 pieces) more pieces of mail sent per week. Larger household sizes increase the number of pieces received (more bills to pay) but have no clear impact on the number of pieces sent.

Table 4.6:
Transactions Mail Received and Sent by Household Size
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Size	Received	Sent
One person	1.7	.4
Two	2.4	.5
Three	2.7	.3
Four	2.5	.3
Five or more	2.7	.3
Average	**2.3**	**.4**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.

With respect to transactions mail received, Table 4.7 shows that each additional adult adds almost one piece of mail received per week. Additional adults, however, do not generate additional pieces of mail sent.

Table 4.7:
Transactions Mail Received and Sent
by Number of Adults in Household
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Number of Adults in Household	Received	Sent
One	1.7	.4
Two	2.4	.4
Three or more	3.3	.5
Average	**2.3**	**.4**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.

Internet Access

As shown in Table 4.8, households with Internet access received more transaction mail than those without it. In part, this is because households with access tend to have higher incomes, are more likely to own a home, and have more bills to pay.

In contrast, household with Internet access sent significantly fewer pieces of transaction mail than households without access. The convenience of the Internet leads households to conduct at least some transactions online, thus reducing the number of payments that would have been made by mail. Lower income households, in many cases, do not have access to the Internet (see Table 4.9) and can only conduct transactions by mail.

Table 4.8:
Transactions Mail Received and Sent by Internet Access
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Type of Internet Access	Received	Sent
Broadband	2.3	.4
Dial-up	2.5	.4
None	2.2	.8
Others	2.4	.5
Average	**2.3**	**.4**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.

Table 4.9:
Income and Education by Type of Internet Access

Type of Internet Access	Median Income	% w/ College Degree
Broadband	70,507	46%
Dial-up	44,686	9%
None	27,689	14%
Others	39,830	41%

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.

Bill Payments

As mentioned earlier, households have a variety of ways available to make payments. Historically, bills were paid mostly by mail. However, as the Internet and other technologies provided many new and faster ways to pay bills, electronic payments became the predominant method used by households. In this study electronic methods include payments by PCs, mobile phones, automatic deductions from bank and credit card accounts, and phones.

The Household Diary Study gathers data to measure the volume of payments households make using the various methods currently available to them. Table 4.10 presents the number of bills paid monthly and other relevant statistics for each payment type. It also provides a 5-year comparison of findings, between 2016 and 2021. Interestingly, data show a decrease in total monthly payments from 14.0 in 2016 to 11.8 in 2021, which resulted from a decline in both online and mail payments. This finding likely reflects the impacts of the pandemic-driven recession and unprecedented job losses on households' ability to pay bills in both 2020 and 2021.

In 2021, 79% payments were made electronically; another 19% were paid by mail.

In 2021 only 19% of payments were made by mail, a significant decline from a 27% share in 2016. An additional 79% of payments were made electronically, a strong increase from a 69% share in 2016. Electronic payments include payments made online, by automatic deductions, by credit card, and by phone. Table 4.10 also shows that in 2021 only 51% of households paid at least one bill by mail, a substantial decline from 68% in 2016. In contrast, 92% of households reported making at least one payment electronically in 2021, a strong increase from 85% in 2016. Finally, the table also shows that in 2021 Internet payments were by far the most used type of electronic payment, representing 61% of all electronic payments.

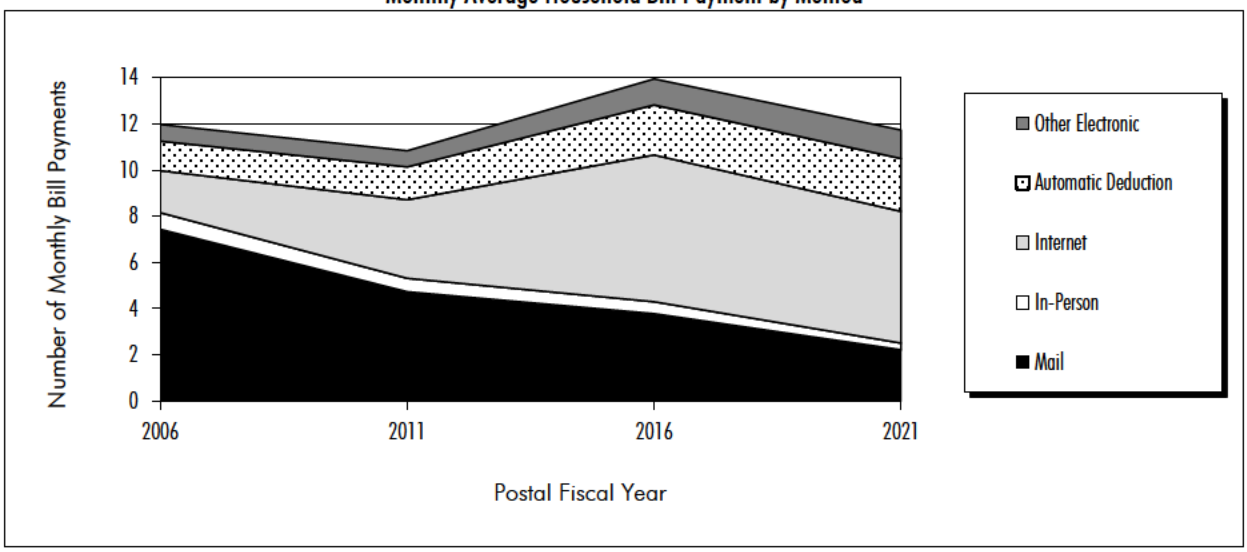
Table 4.10:
Bill Payment by Method, FY 2016 vs. 2021

Bill Payment Method	2016			2021		
	Average Number of Bills Paid per Month	Share of Bills Paid	Percent of Households Making at Least One Payment Using Method	Average Number of Bills Paid per Month	Share of Bills Paid	Percent of Households Making at Least One Payment Using Method
Mail	3.8	27%	68%	2.2	19%	51%
Using Internet	6.4	46%	67%	5.7	49%	76%
Automatic Deduction	2.2	15%	61%	2.3	19%	62%
Credit Card	0.7	5%	27%	0.9	8%	32%
Telephone	0.4	3%	19%	0.3	3%	14%
In-person	0.5	4%	25%	0.3	2%	14%
Total	**14.0**	**100%**	—	**11.8**	**100.0%**	—
Total Electronic	**9.7**	**69%**	**85%**	**9.3**	**79%**	**92%**

Source: HDS Recruitment Sample, FY 2016 and 2021.

As Figure 4.1 illustrates, electronic payments have accounted for a rapidly growing share of households' payments. Over the previous 15 years, the average number of bills paid electronically increased 142% (from 3.8 to 9.3 monthly bills), mostly at the expense of bills paid by mail, which fell 70% over the same period (from 7.4 to 2.2 monthly bills).

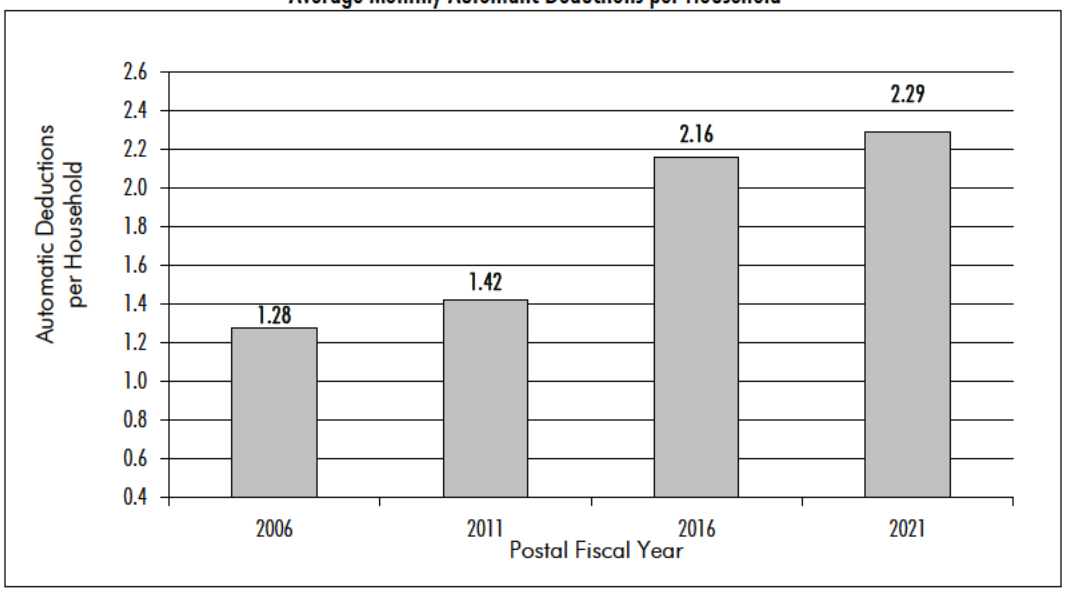
Figure 4.1:
Monthly Average Household Bill Payment by Method



Source: HDS Recruitment Sample, FY 2006-2021.
Note: Other Electronic includes telephone.

Automatic deductions increased continuously since the early 2000's. As Figure 4.2 illustrates, between 2006 and 2021, these types of payments almost doubled, increasing 79%. Interestingly, despite the growing popularity of online payments, automated deductions continued to grow. They ranked second behind Internet payments as a share of all bills paid monthly, accounting for 20% of all household payments. In 2021 payments by mail ranked third, representing only 19% of household payments.

Figure 4.2:
Average Monthly Automatic Deductions per Household

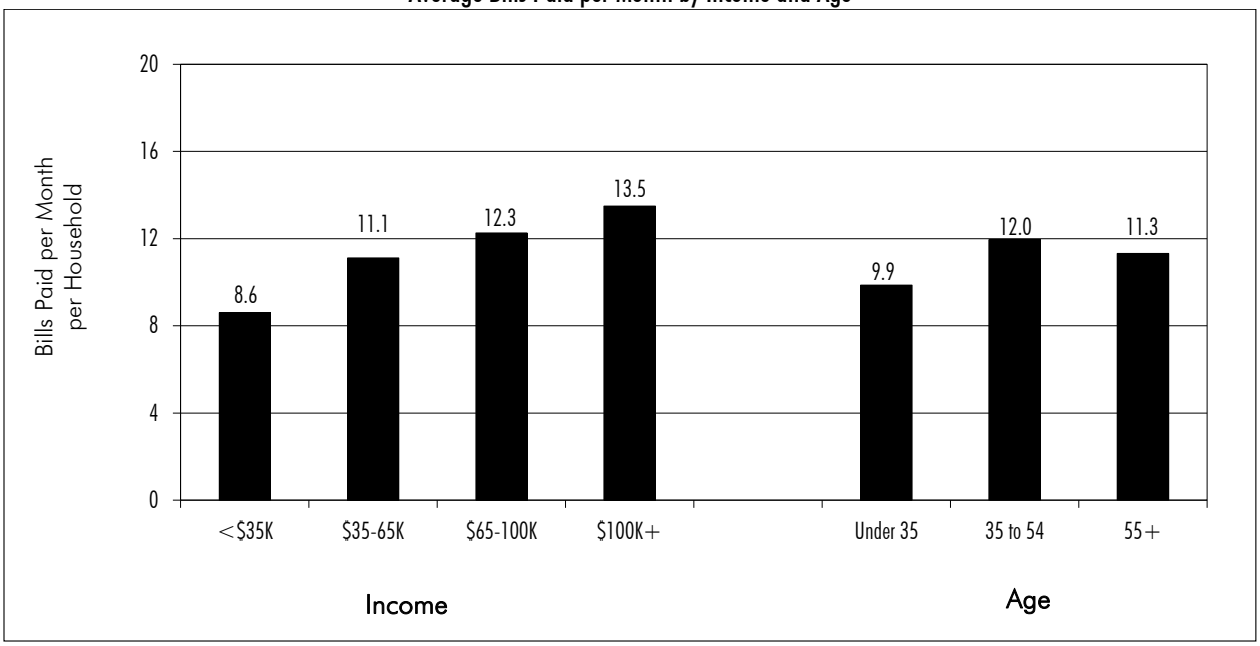


Source: HDS Recruitment Sample, FY 2006-2021.

As noted earlier in the report, the Household Diary Study has consistently found that the number of bills paid by mail is correlated to both the age and income of heads of household. Figure 4.3 provides an illustration of that relationship.

The left side of the chart shows the positive correlation between household income and the number of bills paid per month. In FY 2021, households with incomes over $100,000 paid an average of 13.5 bills monthly compared to 8.6 paid by households earning less than $35,000. Bills paid by mail showed only a partial correlation with age. Younger heads of household (under 35 years old) paid 9.9 bills by mail, or about 18% less than the bills paid by heads of household 35-54 years old (12.0 bills). However, heads of household over 55 paid 11.3 bills monthly, slightly less than those 35-54 years old. One explanation for this result is that, within the over-55 age cohort, heads of household approaching retirement age (generally over 67 years old) tend to moderate their spending habits.

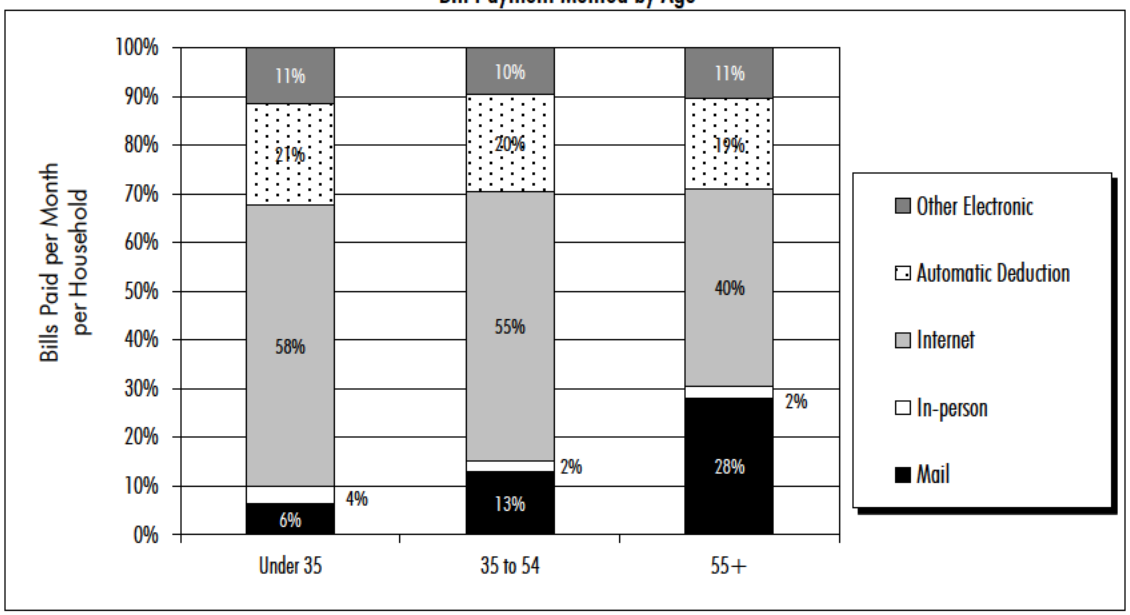
Figure 4.3:
Average Bills Paid per Month by Income and Age



Source: HDS Recruitment Sample, FY 2021.

As mentioned earlier, the age of heads of household can have a strong influence on the method they choose to pay their bills. Figure 4.4 shows the percentage of bills paid by each method and for each age category. In 2021, heads of household under 35 years old paid only 6% of their bill by mail. The majority of their bills (about 80%) were paid either online, by automatic deduction, or by some other electronic method. Notably, even heads of household over 55 on average paid only about one-quarter (28%) of their bills by mail. Another 59% of payments were made either online or by automatic deductions.

Figure 4.4:
Bill Payment Method by Age



Source: HDS Recruitment Sample, FY 2021.
Note: Other Electronic includes telephone.

Bills and Statements Received by Households

Table 4.11 shows an industry breakdown of bills and statements received by households. In 2021 households received a total of 13.4 billion pieces of bills and statements by mail, accounting for 38% of total First-Class Mail received. Bills received by households totaled 9.8 billion pieces, originating primarily from the financial and the Service industries, each representing 47% and 45% of household bills, respectively. Credit card companies were the main financial billers, sending 59% of the industry's volume; utility companies were the main service billers, mailing 41% of the industry's volume.

Statements received by households totaled 3.6 billion pieces and were mailed predominantly by banks with 50% of total household statements (1.8 billion pieces).

Table 4.11:
Bill and Statement Volumes by Industry

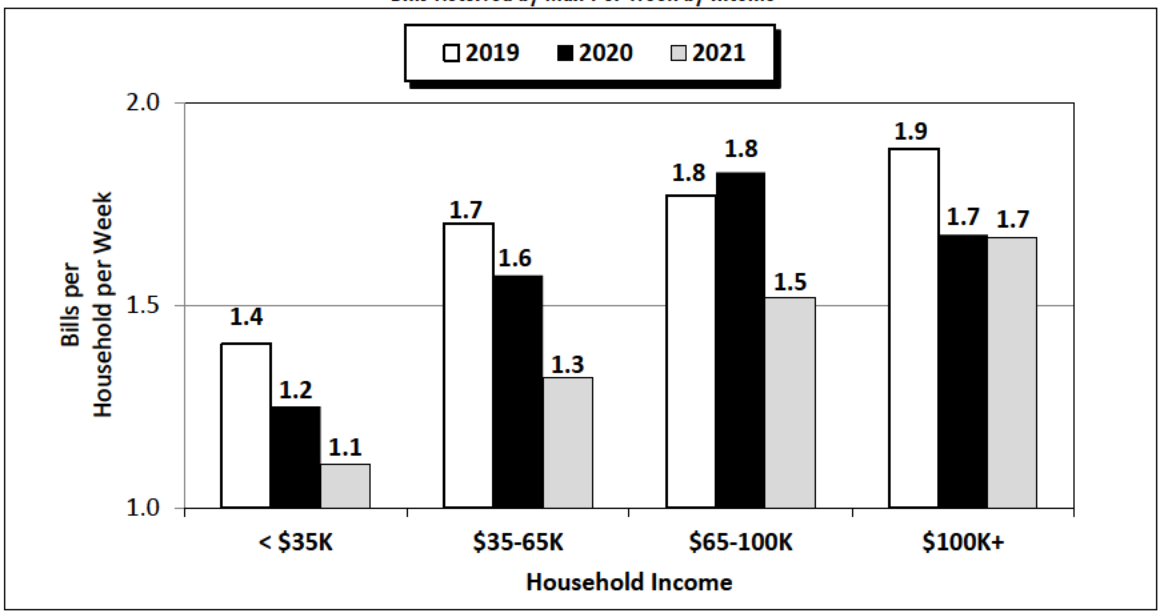
Industry	Volumes	
	Bills *(Millions)*	Statements *(Millions)*
Financial		
Bank, S&L, Credit Union	514	1,833
Credit Card	2,737	17
Insurance Company	1,090	203
Real Estate/Mortgage	198	100
Other Financial	85	1,053
Total Financial	**4,624**	**3,207**
Merchants		
Department Store	31	6
Publisher	94	1
Mail Order Company	31	12
Other Merchants	73	29
Total Merchants	**228**	**48**
Service		
Telephone/Cable Company	960	15
Utility Company	1,832	22
Medical and Other Professional	1,360	117
Other Service	286	20
Total Service	**4,438**	**173**
Manufacturers	47	12
Government	393	95
Social/Nonprofit	42	33
Other/Don't Know/Refused	21	14
Total – All Industries	**9,792**	**3,582**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.
Note: Social/Nonprofit bill and statement volumes were not collected separately.

Figures 4.5a and 4.5b, show number of bills and statements received in the mail, by household income. Typically, higher income households have more financial accounts and consequently receive more bills and statements compared to lower income households.

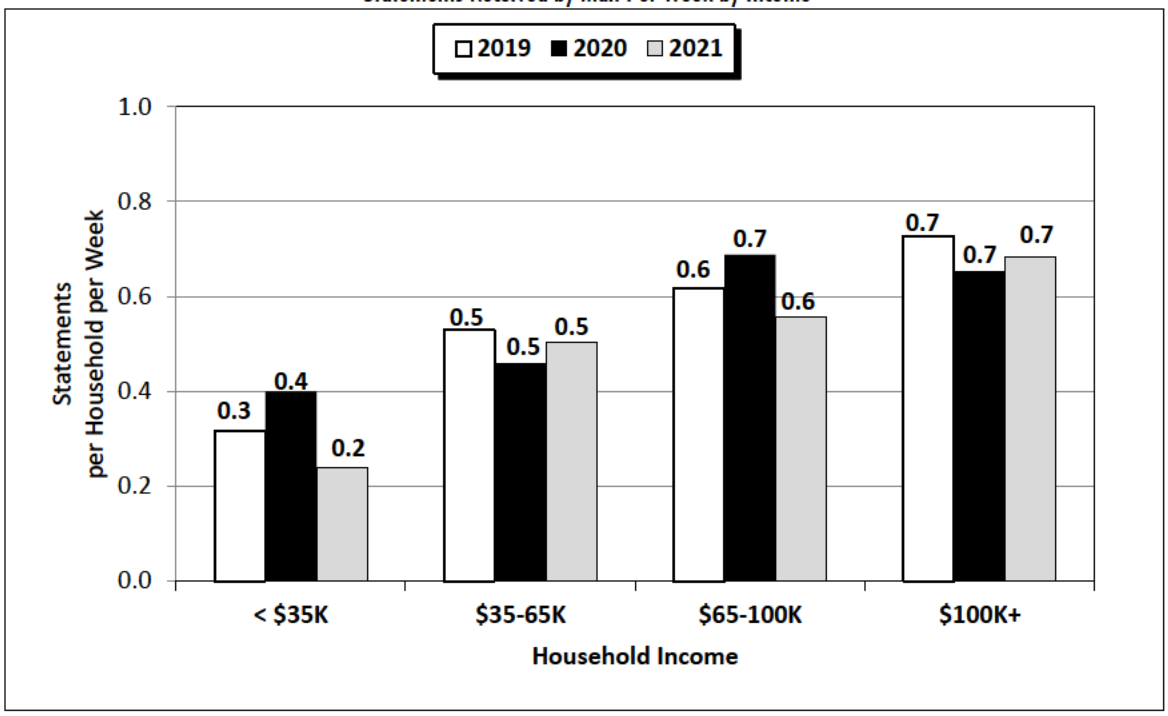
Between 2019 and 2021, there was a general and significant decrease in the number of bills received by mail, regardless of household income. Electronic diversion was a main driver of the decline, but volumes were also influenced by the impact of the recession and high unemployment during the COVID-19 pandemic in 2020 and 2021. From 2019 to 2021, the steepest declines were reported by lower income cohorts. This, however, was not always the case for statements, partly because many households prefer receiving paper copies for record keeping.

Figure 4.5a:
Bills Received by Mail Per Week by Income



Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2019, 2020 and 2021. Amounts are rounded.

Figure 4.5b:
Statements Received by Mail Per Week by Income



Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2019, 2020 and 2021. Amounts are rounded.

Table 4.12 shows the number of monthly bills received by mail and online from 2019 through 2021. While the majority of bills received in 2021 were still delivered through the mail, their volume was down 15% compared to 2019 and their share of total bills fell from 72% to 65%.

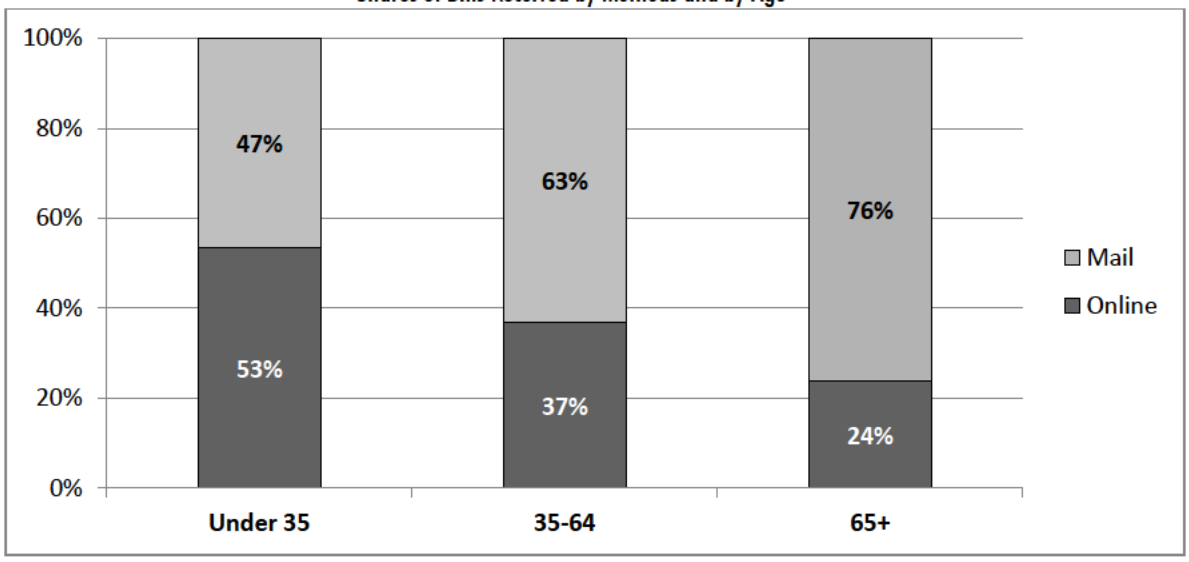
Conversely, the number of bills received online increased 17% from 2019, offsetting most of the decline in bill received by mail pieces, and their share rose from 28% in 2019 to 35% in 2021.

Table 4.12:
Average Monthly Bills Received by Method

Method	2019	2020	2021
Mail	7.4	6.9	6.3
Internet	2.9	3.1	3.4
Total	**10.2**	**10.0**	**9.7**
Share Received by Mail	**72%**	**69%**	**65%**

Figure 4.6 shows the shares of bills received either online or by mail for each age cohort. Since younger heads of household tend to be more active users of the Internet, they migrated to online billing earlier and faster than older cohorts. As a result, in 2021 heads of household less than 35 years old already received most of their bills online (53%). On the other hand, heads of household 35 and older continued to receive the majority (76%) of their bills in the mail.

Figure 4.6:
Shares of Bills Received by Methods and by Age



Source: HDS Recruitment Sample, FY 2021

Chapter 5: Advertising Mail

Introduction

This chapter examines advertising mail, which consists of any advertising, promotional, or sales material sent via the Postal Service. Advertising mail can be sent as First-Class or Marketing Mail.

The Advertising Market

According to GroupM, in 2021 American businesses spent approximately $294 billion advertising their products and services, an increase of 21.9% from 2020 that followed a 0.9% spending decrease in 2020. Of this total advertising spending, 4.9% was spent on direct mail, the fourth largest spending medium after the Internet (57.1%), TV (23.7%), and radio (5.0%).

As Table 5.1 illustrates, direct mail spending rose 12.8% from 2020. Partly recovering from a pandemic-related 19.9% plunge in 2020 but remaining roughly 10% below pre-pandemic spending levels of 2019. Internet advertising soared 38.0% after a strong 13.8% increase in 2020, supported by a surge in ecommerce activity that began at the start of the pandemic in 2020 and continued through 2021. As a consequence of the strong growth in Internet spending, however, fewer funds remained available for spending on most other advertising categories.

Table 5.1:
U.S. Advertising Spending Growth by Medium, 2019-2021
(Percent Growth from Prior Year)

Medium	2019	2020	2021
Direct Mail	-1.3%	-19.9%	12.8%
TV	-4.0%	-0.2%	4.1%
Radio	0.9%	-25.2%	18.2%
Newspapers	-12.5%	-28.7%	3.1%
Magazines	-5.1%	-19.9%	-10.0%
Internet	17.7%	13.8%	38.0%
Other	-0.9%	-29.2%	8.5%
Total	**4.5%**	**-0.9%**	**21.9%**

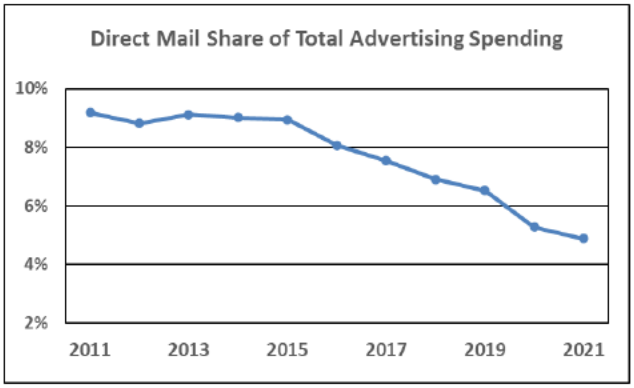
Source: GroupM—estimates.
Note: Totals may not sum due to rounding.

*Other fluctuations are due to political/Olympic advertising

The large fluctuations from one year to the next in the "Other" category of spending (in Table 5.1) are the result of seasonality associated with spending on election and Olympic campaigns.

According to GroupM's estimates, direct mail's share of total advertising spending began to decline aggressively in 2015, falling from 9% to 4.9% in 2021, the lowest level to-date (Fig 5.1).

Figure 5.1:
Direct Mail as a Share of Total Advertising, 2011-2021



Source: U.S. Postal Service calculations based on GroupM data.

Despite the general decrease in advertising dollars, direct mail continues to be a popular choice for its highly efficient and versatile method for businesses to communicate with consumers. Direct mail can be targeted to the interests of individual customers, and used both to locate new customers and maintain relationships with existing customers. Direct mail allows for a variety of different types of advertising: letters, postcards, catalogs, and free samples. It can be sent as First-Class or Marketing Mail, allowing advertisers to trade off expeditious, personalized First-Class mailings against cost-savings from Marketing Mail.

Importantly, the effectiveness of direct mail is readily measurable, more so than most other media. Businesses can track the response rate to a mailing far more precisely than for a television commercial or magazine advertisement. This feature alone gives advertising mail a key advantage over other media.

Advertising Mail Volume

In 2021 direct mail advertising totaled 65.8 billion pieces, accounting for 60% of all household mail. Total volume increased 7.6% from 2020, driven by increases in both First-Class Mail and Marketing Mail advertising. Marketing Mail totaled 59.1 billion pieces, representing 90% of total advertising mail. Volume increased 7.8% from 2020, partly recovering from steep losses at the onset of the pandemic in 2020 but remaining well below pre-pandemic levels. Marketing Mail also benefited from higher volumes of political and election mail associated with the 2020 general election season, which took place in the 2021 fiscal year.

Tables 5.2 and 5.3 show that in 2021 First-Class Mail advertising totaled 6.7 billion pieces, a 6.9% increase from 2020, representing 10% of total household ad mail received. Of this volume, 3.6 billion pieces contained only ad materials (also referred to as advertising-only mail), while the remaining 3.1 billion pieces were secondary advertising. The latter (also referred to as advertising-enclosed mail), is not included in the total volume count of advertising mail, as the primary piece (be it a bill, statement, or correspondence mailing) is already accounted for in the corresponding First-Class Mail category.

In 2021 advertising-only and ads-enclosed mail increased 4.9% and 9.3%, respectively, partly recovering from pandemic-related losses incurred in 2020. Over the longer term, from 2011 to 2021, advertising-only and ads-enclosed volumes fell 33% and 58%, respectively. The sharper decline in ads-enclosed led to an increase in the share of ads-only mail from 43% of First-Class advertising in 2011 to 54% in 2021.

In 2021 direct mail recovered part of the volume lost at the outset of the pandemic but remained well below pre-pandemic levels

Table 5.2:
Advertising Mail Received by Households by Mail Classification
(Volume in Billions of Pieces)

Mail Classification	Volume *(Billions of Pieces)*			Change 2020-2021
	2019	2020	2021	
First-Class Mail Advertising	**7.5**	**6.3**	**6.7**	**6.9%**
Advertising Only	4.0	3.5	3.6	4.9%
Secondary Advertising	3.5	2.8	3.1	9.3%
Marketing Mail Advertising	**65.7**	**54.9**	**59.1**	**7.8%**
Regular and ECR	53.7	43.6	47.0	7.7%
Nonprofit	12	11.2	12.2	8.2%
Unsolicited Packages	**0.03**	**0.04**	**0.03**	**-30.1%**
Total Advertising	**73.2**	**61.2**	**65.8**	**7.6%**
Unaddressed Mail	1.0	0.9	0.9	-6.7%

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2019, 2020, and 2021.
Notes: Totals may not sum due to rounding. Unaddressed Mail is not included in totals.

Table 5.3:
Advertising Mail by Mail Classification
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Mail Classification	Pieces per HH per Week			Share of Total
	2019	2020	2021	
First-Class Advertising	**1.1**	**0.9**	**1.0**	**10%**
Advertising Only	0.6	0.5	0.5	5%
Secondary Advertising	0.5	0.4	0.5	5%
Marketing Mail	**9.8**	**8.2**	**8.8**	**90%**
Regular and ECR	8.0	6.5	7.0	72%
Nonprofit	1.8	1.7	1.8	18.%
Unsolicited Periodicals/Packages	0.01	0.01	0.00	0%
Total Advertising	**10.9**	**9.2**	**9.7**	**100%**
Unaddressed Mail	0.1	0.1	0.1	1%

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2019, 2020, and 2021.
Note: Totals may not sum due to rounding. Unaddressed Mail is not included in totals.

Advertising Mail and Household Characteristics

Income, Education, and Age

Given that advertising mail is used to sell goods and services, it is not surprising that the volume of ad mail received by households is closely tied to their income and education.

As illustrated in Table 5.4, the relationship between advertising mail and household income is quite strong. In 2021, households with incomes of $100,000 or more received almost twice as many pieces as those earning less than $35,000 (12.4 and 6.3 pieces per week, respectively).

Table 5.4 also shows that education too played a key role in the volume of advertising mail received by households. For example, households headed by someone without a high school degree received 7.4 pieces per week, while households headed by a college graduate received 10.6 pieces. Higher income households without a high school diploma likely represent successful entrepreneurs who receive large volumes of business-related ad mail.

The role that education plays in advertising mail is two-fold. First, direct mail is a written type of communication, and education may play some role in its relative effectiveness compared to television or radio advertising. Second, education is not only tied to current household income, but also to future household income. A college graduate who currently has a relatively low income may, in a few years, earn a much higher income.

Table 5.4:
Advertising Mail Received by Income and Education
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Income (Thousands)	Education of Head of Household				Average
	Less than High School	High School graduate	Some College or Technical School	College graduate	
Under $35	5.8	6.8	6.3	6.1	**6.3**
$35 to $65	8.0	9.0	9.7	8.3	**8.8**
$65 to $100	8.5	9.7	10.3	10.1	**10.0**
Over $100	9.9	12.0	12.4	12.6	**12.4**
Average	**7.4**	**9.1**	**9.7**	**10.6**	**9.7**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.

As Table 5.5 illustrates, households headed by an older person receive significantly more advertising mail than their younger counterparts at every income level. In part, this was because age is correlated to other characteristics such as marriage, home ownership, and the presence of children in the household.

Moreover, the older a person is, the longer his or her buying history and the more businesses with which the person has relationships that advertising mail can help maintain. The number of ads received weekly is maximized when older age is combined with high household income. In Table 5.5 we see that, heads of household over 55 with incomes greater than $100,000 received 15.2 ad pieces per week, more than any other demographic combination.

The amount of advertising mail received increases as income, education, and age increase

Table 5.5:
Advertising Mail Received by Income and Age
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Income *(Thousands)*	Age of Head of Household			Average
	Under 34	35 to 54	Over 55	
Under $35	3.2	4.9	8.7	**6.3**
$35 to $65	4.2	6.8	12.2	**8.8**
$65 to $100	5.5	7.9	13.5	**10.0**
Over $100	8.4	11.0	15.8	**12.4**
Average	**5.0**	**8.5**	**12.7**	**9.7**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.

Household Size

Tables 5.6 and 5.7 show that advertising mail received increased with the size and number of adults in the household. Table 5.6 shows that, while this is evident when looking at changes in household sizes from one to two household members (a 35% increase), additional members over two do not increase, and may in fact reduce the number of advertising pieces received.

When looking at changes in the number of adults in the household, there is a more continuous increase in the number of advertising pieces received when the number of adults increases.

Table 5.6:
Advertising Mail Received by Size of Household
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Size	
One person	7.8
Two	10.5
Three	10.2
Four	9.8
Five or more	10.1
Average	**9.7**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.

In Table 5.7 we see that households with two adults received 33% more ad pieces than those with only one adult. When three or more adults were present, ad mail increased another 20%. These results stem from the likelihood that households with more than one adults are also two-income (or more) households.

Table 5.7:
Advertising Mail Received by Number of Adults
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Number of Adults	
One	7.6
Two	10.1
Three or more	12.1
Average	**9.7**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.

Internet Access

In Table 5.8 we see households without Internet access received about the same number of ads as those with either Broadband or Dial-up service. In part, the reason for this result is that Internet advertising continues to absorb a large percentage of the ad budgets businesses are willing to spend. With fewer dollars to spend on direct mail, businesses are mindful to avoid mailing to households already targeted by their online ads.

However, often it is also the case that advertising mail is sent even when Internet advertising is a viable alternative. One reason for doing so is when direct mail is used as a complement to Internet sales, by directing potential customers to specific company websites.

Table 5.8:
Advertising Mail Received by Internet Access
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Type of Internet Access	
Broadband	9.8
Dial-up	8.6
None	9.4
Others	9.5
Average	**9.7**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.

Table 5.9:
Income and Education by Type of Internet Access

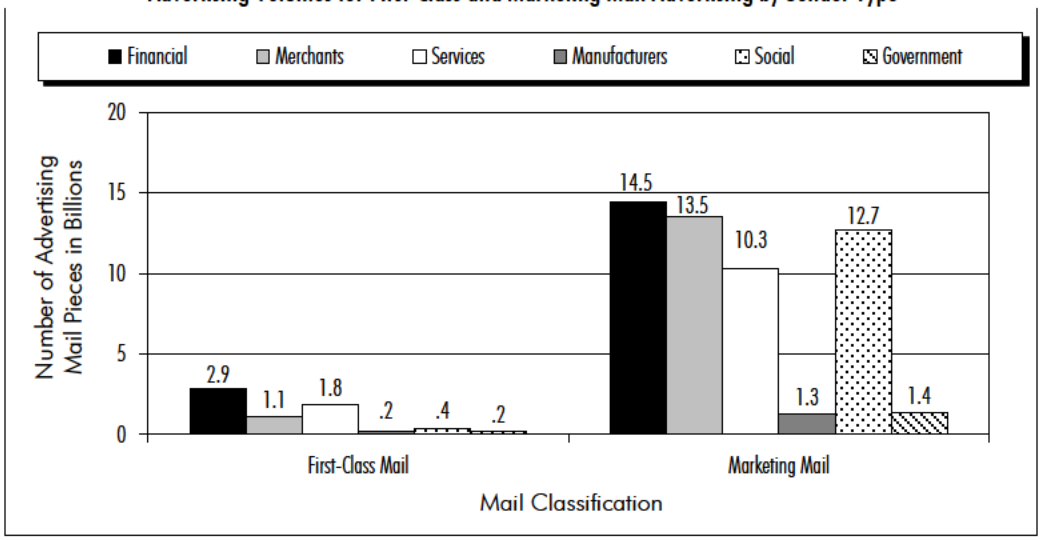
Type of Internet Access	Median Income	% w/ College Degree
Broadband	70,507	46%
Dial-up	44,686	9%
None	27,689	14%
Others	39,830	41%

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.

Senders of Advertising Mail

Figure 5.2 shows advertising mail volumes by major industry. In 2021 we see that, for the first time, merchants were no longer the largest mailers of advertising material, falling second to the financial industry. Merchants mailed 25% (13.5B pieces) of total Marketing Mail ads compared to 27% (14.5B pieces) mailed sent by the financial industry. Financial mailers were also the largest mailers of First-Class Mail advertising, sending 43% of ads received by households. They were followed by the service industry with 28% of FCM ads and merchants with 16%.

Figure 5.2:
Advertising Volumes for First-Class and Marketing Mail Advertising by Sender Type



Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021

Note: First-Class Mail advertising includes advertising-only and advertising enclosed volumes

Attitudes toward Advertising

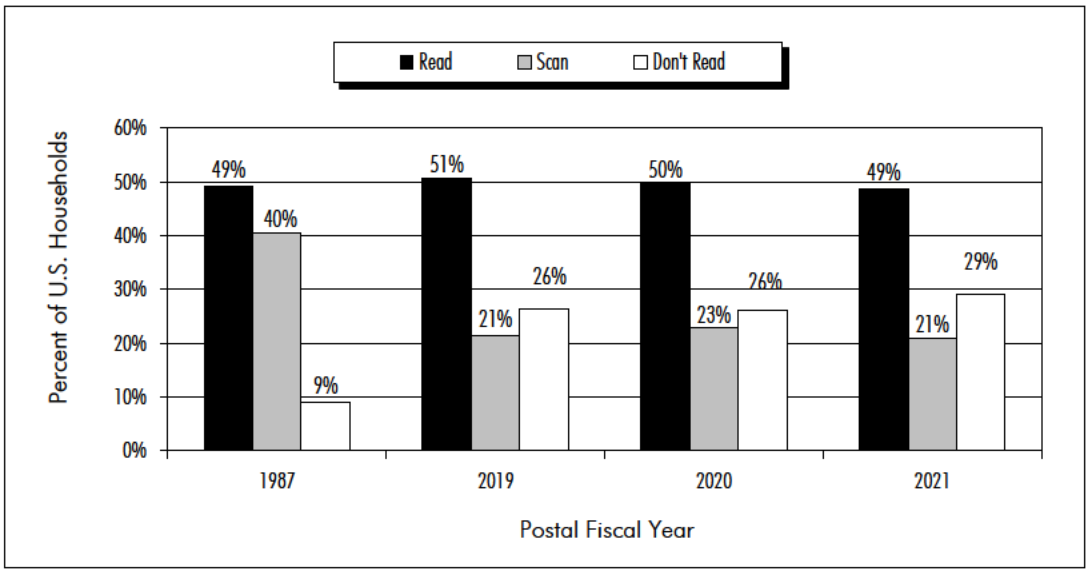
With $294 billion spent on advertising in the United States, few households would probably wish they received more.

Whether they wish to receive more or not, the household diary survey reveals that most households either read or scanned their advertising mail. In Figure 5.3 we see that, in 2021, 49% of households read ads received by mail, a percentage remarkably stable since 1987, when the Household Diary Study project first began. An additional 21% of households scanned the ads; a percentage was significantly lower than reported in 1987 but relatively stable from 2019 to 2021. A final 29% of households reported not reading advertising mail at all.

This percentage was three times higher than in 1987 but only slightly higher than in 2019 and 2020. Finally, given the large growth in advertising mail since 1987, it seems clear that U.S. households read more advertising mail now than in the past.

Households read or scanned 70% of all advertising mail, unchanged since 2019.

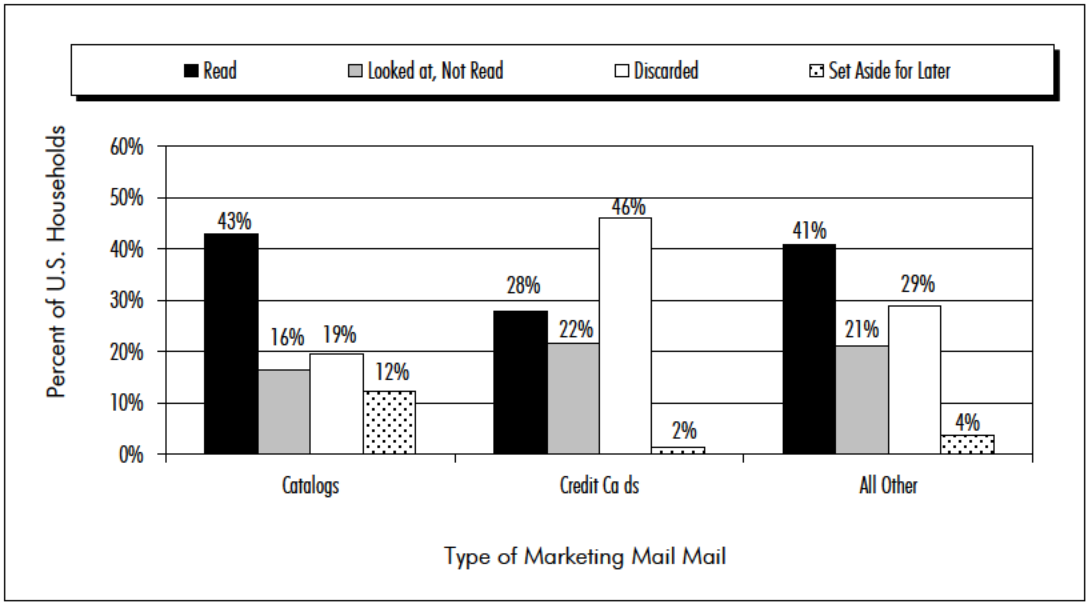
Figure 5.3:
Advertising Mail Behavioral Trends, FY 1987, 2019, 2020, and 2021



Source: HDS Recruitment Sample, FY 1987, 2019, 2020, and 2021.

Interestingly, not all advertising mail is treated equally. As Figure 5.4 illustrates, catalogs attract considerably more attention than credit card ads, as they typically are more interesting to read. In 2021, 43% of households read catalogs, with only 19% discarding them without reading the contents. In contrast, only 28% of households read credit card ads; 46% discarded them without reading the contents.

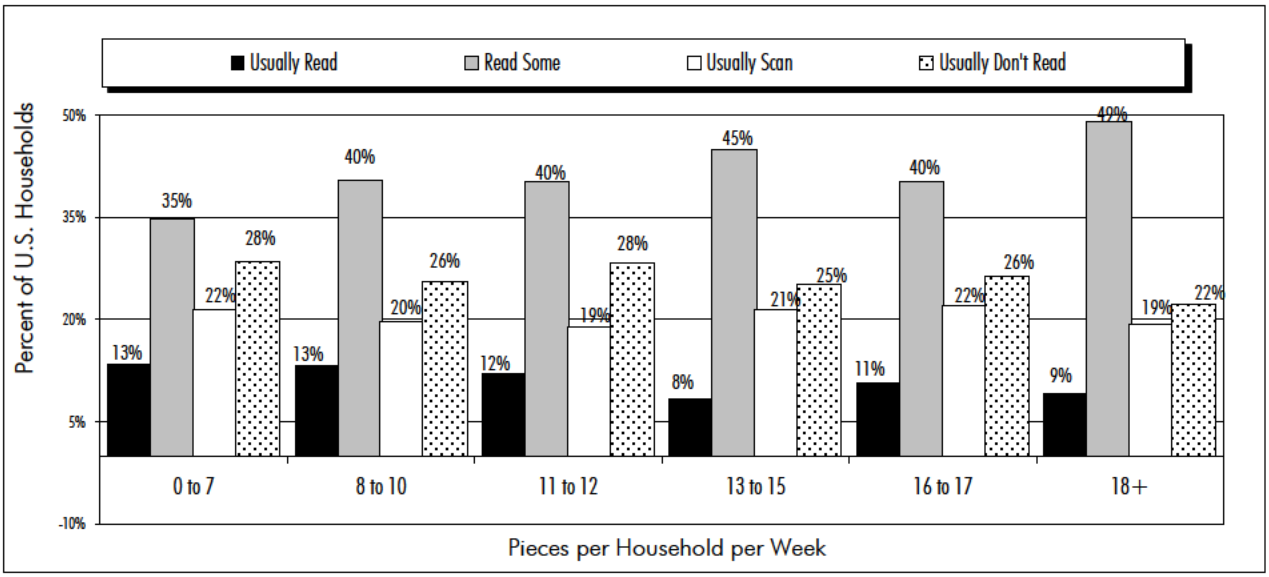
Figure 5.4:
Treatment of Marketing Mail Advertising by Type



Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.

Another interesting result can be seen in Figure 5.5. In some cases, household behavior toward advertising mail appears to depend on how much advertising mail they receive. For example, among households receiving zero to ten pieces of advertising mail weekly, 13% read all or some of them. On the other hand, in cases where households receive more than 10 pieces, fewer of them read the ads, as the percent of households varied from 8% to 12%. These results appear to indicate that households that receive more advertising mail than others are likely to be "turned off" by the high volume. However, Figure 5.5 also shows that, on average, more than 50% of households read all or some of the ads received, a percentage that, generally, is unaffected by the volume received. Similarly, the percentage of households that usually do not read advertising mail fluctuated between 22% and 28%, regardless of how much mail they received.

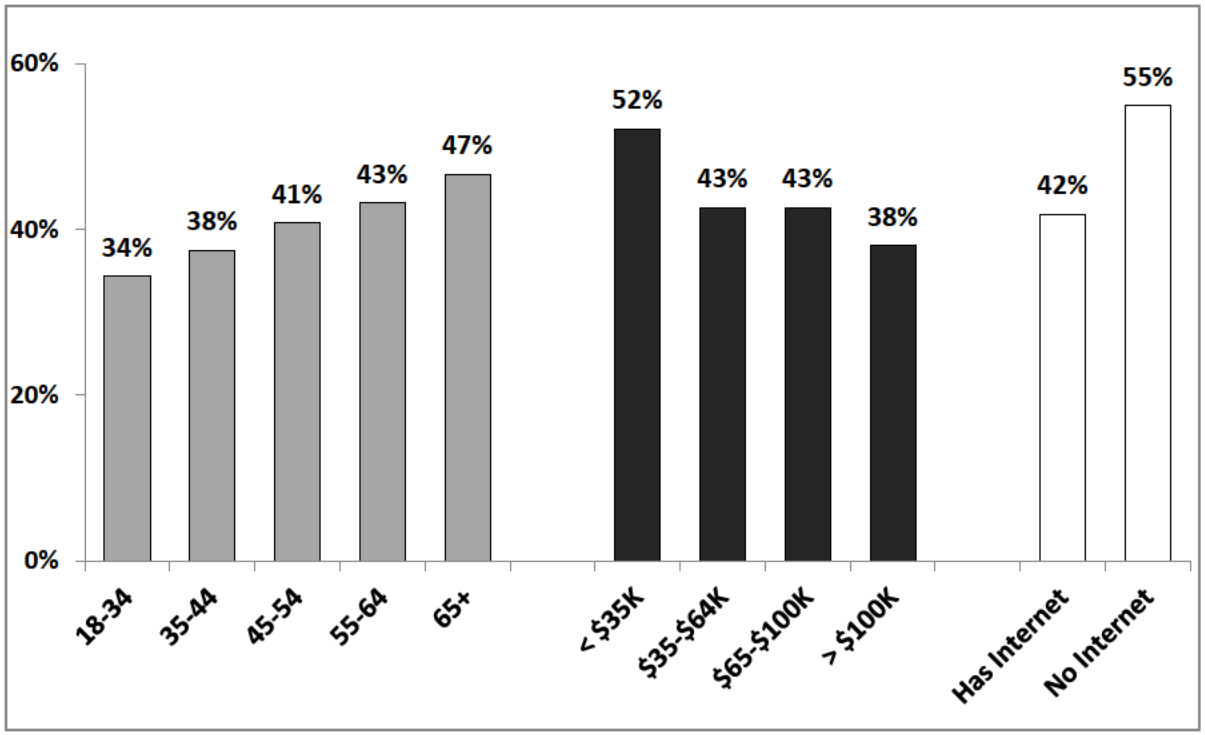
Figure 5.5:
Treatment of Advertising Mail by Number of Marketing Mail Pieces Received per Week



Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.

Figure 5.6 shows the effect of household demographics on ad mail reading rates. Lower income households report reading more ad mail than high earners; probably a result of receiving fewer ad pieces than higher income households. With respect to age, just as older heads of households generally read more than younger ones, they also tended to read more advertising mail. Finally, households with an Internet connection read less advertising mail than households without access, probably as a result of being exposed to a greater number of both online and mail ads.

Figure 5.6
Marketing Mail Reading Rates by Household Demographics - FY 2021



Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.

Effectiveness of Advertising Mail

Ultimately, advertisers send direct mail because it works—household members read and respond to it. Table 5.10 presents the intended response rates to advertising mail. Households report that they intend to respond to about 10% of either First-Class or Marketing Mail ads. While these intended response rates are usually higher than actual response rates, the data demonstrate that direct mail can have a significant impact on household purchasing behavior. The table also shows that households "may" respond to an additional 11% of First-Class advertising and another 13% of Marketing Mail advertising. This is not to say that a similar mail piece may receive a higher response rate if mailed via Marketing Mail; it is more likely that this is due to the difference in the mix of ads received. For example, catalogs, which typically enjoy a high response rate (linked to the high read rate shown in Figure 5.4), are routinely mailed by Marketing Mail and only rarely by First-Class Mail. Credit card ads, on the other hand, have the lowest response rate (linked to the low read rate shown in Figure 5.4) and are often mailed First-Class.

Figure 5.7 presents the total number of intended responses to advertising mail by income. As illustrated earlier in Tables 5.4 and 5.5, higher-income households received more advertising mail compared to other income groups. Figure 5.7 combines the weekly volume of advertising mail received by household income with the respective intended response rates reported in Table 5.10. The result is the average number of intended responses per week for each income level. For example, households with incomes greater than $150,000 reported they intended to respond to 1.1 pieces of advertising mail per week, and they might respond to another 1.4 pieces per week.

Other high-income households also indicated they intend to respond to about one piece of advertising mail per week. Starting from households earning $49,000 or less, both types of response rates start to decline.

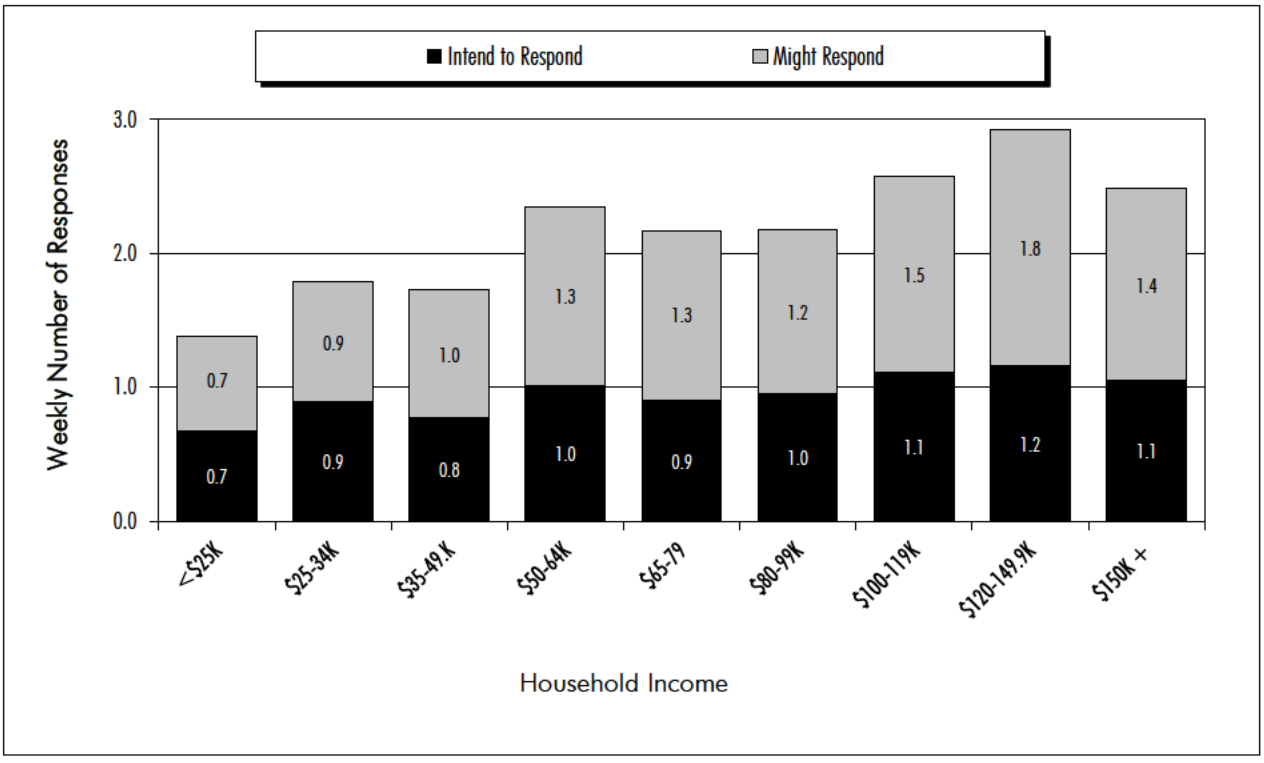
While intended responses do not always lead to actual responses, the data presented in Table 5.10 and Figure 5.7 help explain why direct mail is a popular choice of advertisers in the U.S. Although there is no completely equivalent measure for intended response to Internet ads, the click-through rate (the percentage of online visitors who viewed an ad and clicked on it) is widely used as an indicator of consumers' interest in online ads. As such, it is somewhat comparable to the read rates for mail ads. Based on recently published reports, the 2021 average click-through rate for online advertising was about 3% for search ads and 0.5% for display ads. Read rates and intended response rates for mail advertising, on the other hand, have been much higher, averaging about 50 percent (see Figure 5.3) and 10%, respectively.

Table 5.10:
Intended Response to Advertising Mail by Class
(Percentage of Pieces)

Response	First-Class	Marketing Mail
Yes	10%	10%
Maybe	11%	13%
No	71%	70%
No Answer	7%	7%

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.

Figure 5.7:
Weekly Number of Intended Responses by Income



Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021

Chapter 6: Periodicals

Introduction

This chapter examines volume and types of periodicals mailed to households. Periodical Mail consists of newspapers, magazines, and newsletters regularly sent to households, usually as part of a subscription. This chapter analyzes only periodicals delivered by the Postal Service to households. Newspapers or magazines delivered by a local carrier or purchased at a newsstand or store are not included in Household Diary Study data. Additionally, periodicals examined here are only a portion of the total volume, as some of periodicals are received by non-households, such as doctors' offices and other businesses.

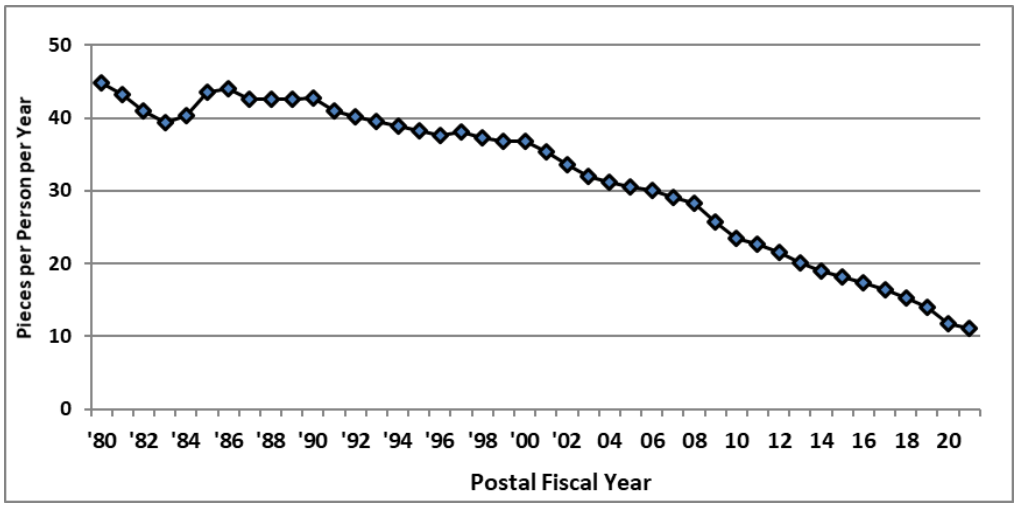
According to GroupM, annual magazine ad spending fell from $76 per person in 2012 to $30 in 2021

The Periodicals Market

Fig. 6.1 illustrates that, starting in the early nineties, the volume of periodicals fell out of pace with population growth. After reaching a peak in 1990 at 10.7 billion pieces, the number of periodicals per person took a downturn that continues to this day.

The emergence of the Internet was the catalyst that accelerated an already sharp downturn in the volume of periodicals, providing a vast array of similar content, which in many cases can be less expensive and more convenient to access than hard copy publications. Starting in 2008, the decline in periodicals was further aggravated by the economic recession, which accelerated the downward trend. More recently, the 2020 pandemic and the economic recession that followed provided further incentives for individuals to replace hard copy publications with electronic content.

Figure 6.1:
Number of Periodicals per Person, 1980-2021
(Annual Pieces per Person)



Source: U.S. Postal Service RPW Reports, U.S. Census Bureau.

Advertising's impact on Periodicals delivered by Mail

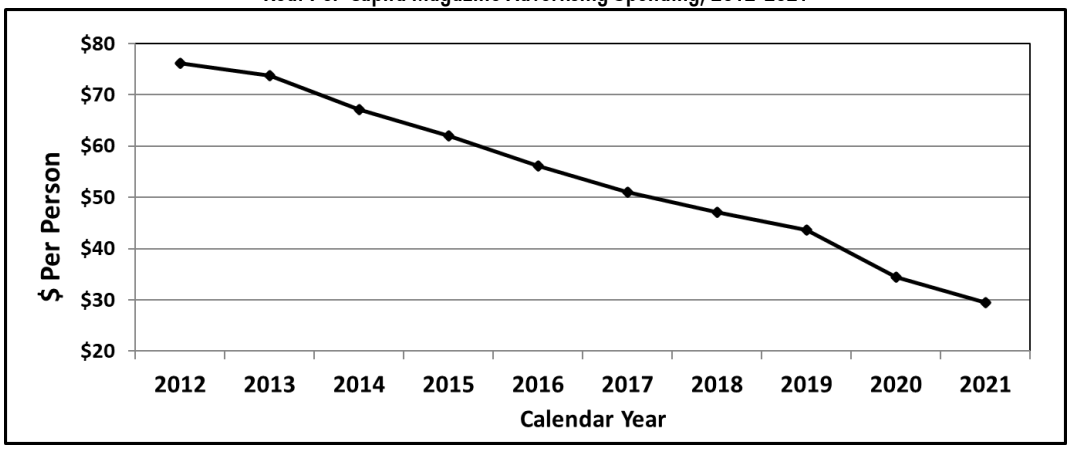
Advertising spending translates into advertising revenue, and the key determinant of periodicals' profitability is advertising revenue.

Advertising is a form of business investment. As with other investments, when the economy takes a turn for the worse, advertising tends to slow. In 2000, total ad spending as a percent of Gross Domestic Product (GDP) rose to historically high levels; however, shortly thereafter, when the high-tech bubble burst, advertising spending crashed. In 2002, albeit at a slower pace, growth in ad spending resumed and, after six years of economic expansion, reached new record highs. However, after the 2008 recession advertising spending suffered its sharpest decline in history, drastically shrinking the revenues and profitability of the magazine industry.

After 2009, total advertising spending returned to positive growth, aided by a recovering economy. Magazine advertising, however, continued to fall reaching its lowest point in 2021. This can be seen in Figure 6.2, where the trend from 2012 to 2021 shows a steady contraction in spending. According to GroupM, magazine ad spending fell from an annual amount of $76 per person in 2012 to $30 in 2021, a 61% plunge over the nine-year period.

GroupM projects that as the economy grows, so will total advertising spending. Growth in advertising spending typically would bode well for magazines. In the past, more magazines in circulation translated into higher volumes for the Postal Service since the mail continues to be their primary distribution channel. The Internet, however, is expected to continue to absorb most advertising budgets, leaving fewer dollars for all other types of media, including periodicals. Furthermore, the convenience of the Internet and the variety of content available online will continue to reduce periodicals' sales and the related postal deliveries.

Figure 6.2:
Real Per-Capita Magazine Advertising Spending, 2012-2021



Source: GroupM, U.S. Census Bureau

Household Periodicals

As shown in Table E.2 of the Executive Summary, periodicals represented 3.3% of total household mail. Table E.2 also shows that periodicals fell 14% over the last 3 years, from 4.2 billion pieces in 2019 to 3.6 billion pieces in 2021.

Table 6.1 provides a more detail view of volumes, with a breakdown by type of periodicals households received. In 2021 the average household received a total of 20 magazines per year, comprising 71% of total periodicals. For reference, this compares to 59% of the periodicals received in 1987, when newspapers were still the predominant source of daily news. Monthly magazines remained the most popular type of subscription, accounting for 65% of total household magazines. Compared to 1987 total magazines shrank 62%, falling from 52 pieces per year in 1987 to 20 pieces in 2021.

More recently, between 2019 and 2021 the number of magazines per household fell 17%

In 2021, newspapers accounted for 21% of household periodicals, compared to 35% in 1987. Compared to 1987 the number of newspapers per household fell 81%, from 31 pieces in 1987 to 6 pieces in 2021. More recently, between 2019 and 2021 the number of newspapers received annually remained unchanged at 6 pieces per household.

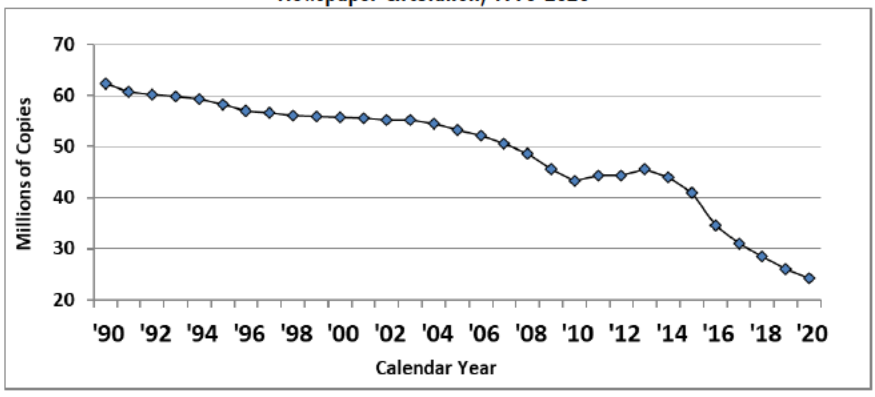
The decline in newspapers captured in the Household Diary Study mirrors the behavior seen in overall newspaper circulation measures. As Figure 6.3 illustrates, newspaper circulation fell 61% from 1990 to 2020 (data are not yet available after 2021). On a per capita basis, the decline was even more pronounced.

Table 6.1:
Periodical Type by Year
(Pieces per Household per year)

Periodical Type	1987	2019	2020	2021
Magazines	**52**	**24**	**21**	**20**
Weekly	16	4	3	3
Monthly	31	16	13	13
Other	5	4	5	4
Newspapers	**31**	**6**	**6**	**6**
Daily	10	2	2	2
Weekly	16	3	3	3
Other	5	1	1	1
Newsletters	**3**	**2**	**2**	**2**
Unclassified	**2**	**1**	**1**	**1**
Total Periodicals	**88**	**33**	**30**	**28**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 1987, 2019, 2020 and 2021.
Note: Totals may not sum due to rounding.

Figure 6.3:
Newspaper Circulation, 1990-2020*



Source: Newspaper Association of America. Data only available through 2020.

Falling circulation was not the only reason for the decline in newspaper deliveries by the Postal Service. With current technology and the availability of alternate delivery systems, national newspapers have moved a large percentage of their publications online. They also continue delivering a portion of their papers directly to prime urban and suburban household customers. These delivery alternatives mean those publications no longer move through the mail.

Periodicals Mail and Household Characteristics

Income, Education, and Age

Table 6.2 illustrates that the number of periodicals received by households increased only when earnings increased from less than $35K to the $35K-$65K range and again when earnings were greater than $100K, However, within the wider income range from 35K to $100K, the number of periodicals remained unchanged.

The relationship between education and the number of periodicals received was similar to the one observed between income and periodicals. The number of periodicals increased only when education increased from less than High School to High School graduate and from some college to college graduate. There were no changes in the number of periodicals when education was between High School-graduate and some college.

Cohorts 55 and older received four times more periodicals than cohorts under 35

Table 6.3 shows that the number of periodicals received by households increased with the age of heads of household. For example, heads of household within the age range of 35 to 54 received 0.3 periodicals per week compared to 0.2 pieces for those younger than 35. There were no changes in the number of periodicals between the ages of 35 and 55, but for ages 55 and older the number of periodicals increases from 0.3 to 0.8 periodicals per week.

Table 6.2:
Periodicals by Income and Education
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Income *(Thousands)*	Educational Attainment of Head of Household				Average
	Less than High School	High School Graduate	Some College or Technical School	College Graduate	
Under $35	0.2	0.5	0.3	0.3	**0.3**
$35 to $65	0.5	0.5	0.5	0.5	**0.5**
$65 to $100	0.4	0.4	0.5	0.6	**0.5**
Over $100	0.4	0.4	0.6	0.7	**0.6**
Average	**0.3**	**0.5**	**0.5**	**0.6**	**0.5**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.

Table 6.3:
Periodicals by Income and Age
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Income *(Thousands)*	Age of Head of Household			Average
	Under 35	35 to 54	Over 55	
Under $35	0.2	0.2	0.5	**0.3**
$35 to $65	0.2	0.2	0.8	**0.5**
$65 to $100	0.3	0.3	0.8	**0.5**
Over $100	0.3	0.5	1.0	**0.6**
Average	**0.2**	**0.3**	**0.8**	**0.5**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.

Household Size

Table 6.4 and Table 6.5 show that as households increased in size from one to two persons, the number of periodicals increased 75%. Households with more than two persons did not show a clear relationship with periodicals, possibly because they represented a smaller portion of the population which resulted in a smaller survey sample.

Table 6.4:
Periodicals by Size of Household
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Size	
One person	.4
Two	.7
Three	.5
Four	.5
Five or more	.3
Average	**.5**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.

Internet Access

In Table 6.6 we see that households with Internet access received 29% fewer periodicals through the mail than those without access. This can be partly explained by the large selections of periodical content available on the Internet, often less expensive and more convenient to access than hard copy periodicals. In addition, the widespread use of e-readers, which require online access to download reading materials, likely contributed to the decline in periodicals.

In households with two adults, the number of periodicals increased 50 percent compared to one-adult households. The presence of additional adults beyond two has no distinguishable impact.

Table 6.5:
Periodicals by Number of Adults in Household
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Number of Adults	
One	.4
Two	.6
Three or more	.5
Average	**.5**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.

Table 6.6:
Periodicals by Type of Internet Access
(Pieces per Household per Week)

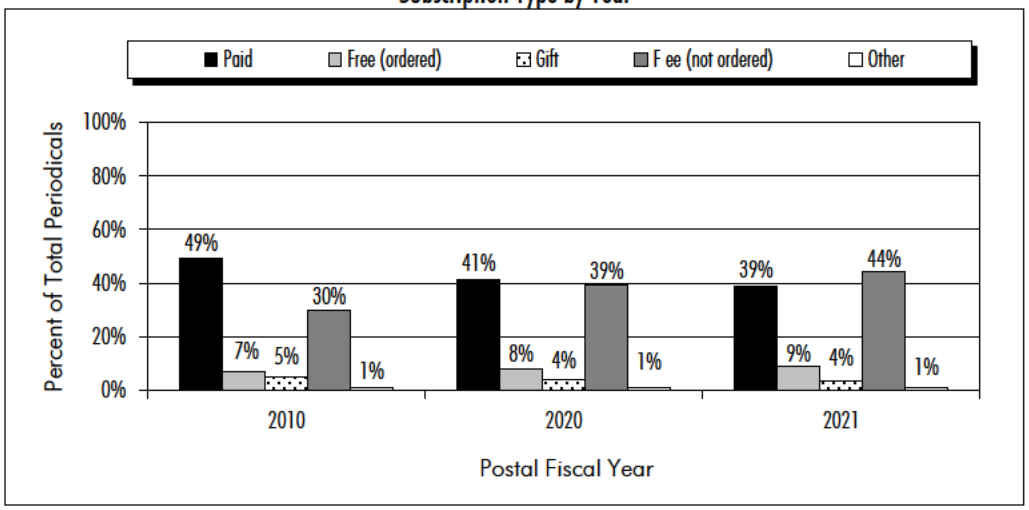
Type of Internet Access	
Broadband	.5
Dial-up	.4
None	.7
Others	.3
Average	**.5**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.

Subscription Type

Figure 6.4 provides an overview of subscription types for periodicals received by mail in FYs 2021, 2020, and 2010. As shown, the distribution of subscription types remained relatively stable from 2020 to 2021 but the mix changed significantly when compared to 2010. In 2021 households ordered and paid for 39% of periodicals received. An additional 47% of periodicals were free — either ordered by the household or delivered without a freestanding order, such as a benefit of membership in a professional, fraternal, or religious organization. Comparing 2021 to 2010, we see a substantial reduction in the percentage of paid subscription and an offsetting increase in the percentage of free periodical that is likely related to households' substitution of hard copy subscriptions with similar online materials.

Figure 6.4:
Subscription Type by Year



Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2010, 2020, and 2021.
Note: Percentages do not add to 100 due to the exclusion of periodicals not classified by subscription type.

Examining periodical volumes by sender type, Table 6.7 shows that households received most periodicals (74%) from commercial organizations. The rest were received from several member organizations. Member organizations are professional affiliations; charitable, religious, and veterans' organizations, educational groups, and unions. When combined, member organizations, account for the remaining 26% of periodicals households received in the mail.

Table 6.7:
Periodicals by Sender Type

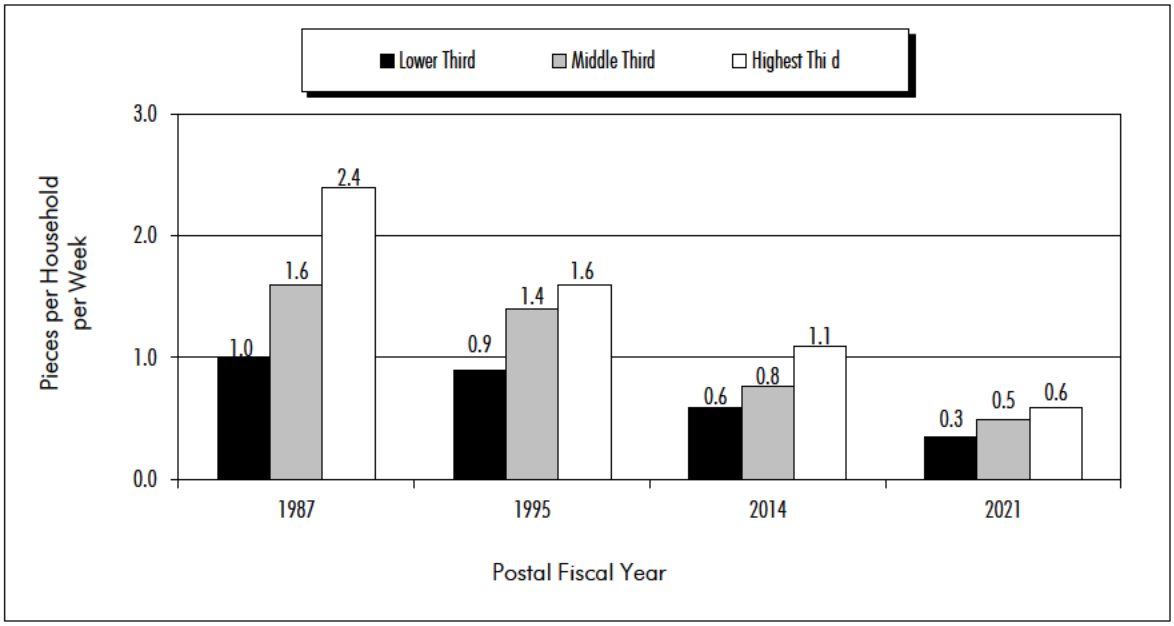
Sender Type	Annual Pieces per Household	Percent of Periodicals Received by HH
Commercial Organization	20.8	74%
Professional Organization	2.7	10%
Religious Organization	1.1	4%
Educational Organization	1.7	6%
Union	.5	2%
Charitable Organization	.5	2%
Veterans' Organization	.3	1%
Unclassified	.4	2%
Total	28.0	100%

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.

Volume Drivers

A number of factors influence the number of periodicals households receive. Several of these variables are demographic, while others are more behavioral in nature. Income seems to strongly influence volume, as a large percentage of periodicals are received through a paid subscription. Accordingly, we would expect that higher-income households to subscribe to more magazines and newspapers than lower income earners. Figure 6.5 presents a long-term view of the relationship between households' income and the number of periodicals received. As shown, although volumes fell significantly since 1987 (when the Household Diary Study first started), the distribution across income groups remained very similar.

Figure 6.5:
Number of Periodicals Received per Week by Households by Income Group



Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 1987, 1995, 2014, and 2021.

Chapter 7: Packages

Introduction

This chapter discusses packages sent and received by households. Packages can be mailed via the U.S. Postal Service at a variety of rates, such as Priority Mail, First-Class Mail, and Media Mail. Documents can be sent as First-Class Mail, Priority Mail, or Express Mail.

The Package Market

The package delivery market is an important segment of the economy. There are three major components of the package market:

- Overnight air,
- Two- and three-day air, and
- Ground.

The U.S. Postal Service provides services in all segments: Priority Mail Express in the overnight segment, Priority and First-Class Mail in the two- and three-day segment, and Parcel Select and Package Services in the ground segment.

Postal Service Package Volume

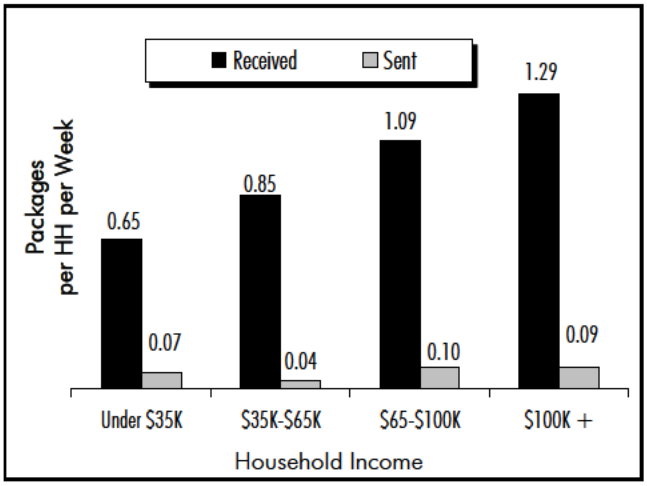
Compared to other types of mail, such as letters or ads, the number of packages captured in the Household Diary Study survey is small, as most households do not receive packages regularly on a daily or weekly basis as they do with the mail. The interpretation of the results should be conducted with this in mind.

Packages and Household Characteristics

Income, Education, and Age

Survey findings show that high-income households received significantly more packages than their less affluent counterparts (see Fig. 7.1). In fact, households in the highest income bracket received twice as many packages as those earning less than $35,000. The age of heads of households was another factor influencing the number of packages received.

Figure 7.1:
Packages Sent and Received by Household Income
(Pieces per Household per Week)



Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.
Base: Packages Sent and Received by Households and Delivered by U.S. Postal Service.

As shown in Table 7.1, heads of household between 35 and 54 years of age received more packages than either the younger or older age cohorts. The reason for this result was likely due to the higher average income earned by the 35 to 54 cohort. Looking at Table 7.2, the number of packages sent was lowest for households under 35 but there were no other significant changes at ages 35 and over.

Table 7.1:
Postal Service Received Packages by Income and Age
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Income *(Thousands)*	Age of Head of Household			Average
	Under 35	35 to 54	Over 55	
Under $35	0.52	0.84	0.63	**0.65**
$35 to $65	0.76	0.99	0.81	**0.85**
$65 to $100	1.29	1.22	0.90	**1.09**
Over $100	1.15	1.43	1.16	**1.29**
Average	**0.87**	**1.16**	**0.87**	**0.97**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.

Table 7.2:
Postal Service Sent Packages by Income and Age
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Income *(Thousands)*	Age of head of Household			Average
	Under 35	35 to 54	Over 55	
Under $35	0.00	0.15	0.07	**0.07**
$35 to $65	0.02	0.05	0.04	**0.04**
$65 to $100	0.10	0.08	0.11	**0.10**
Over $100	0.16	0.08	0.09	**0.09**
Average	**0.06**	**0.08**	**0.08**	**0.07**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.

Tables 7.3 and 7.4 illustrate the impact of education on the number of packages received and sent by households. Except for heads of household with High School diplomas, results show a direct relationship between education and the number of packages received. High School graduates who did not pursue a college education received a greater number of packages than heads of households with some college education. This aberration was probably due to income differences between the two education cohorts. That is, High School graduates are typically more likely to have full time jobs, earn higher incomes, spend more, and receive more packages than those who are pursuing a college education. The survey found that the relationship between packages sent and education was very similar to the one observed for packages received (Table 7.4).

Table 7.3:
Postal Service Received Packages by Income and Education
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Income *(Thousands)*	Education of Head of Household				Average
	Less than High School	High School Graduate	Some College or Technical School	College Graduate	
Under $35	0.61	0.73	0.53	0.72	**0.65**
$35 to $65	0.87	0.75	0.77	0.98	**0.85**
$65 to $100	1.26	1.13	1.14	1.03	**1.09**
Over $100	0.91	1.75	1.10	1.28	**1.29**
Average	**0.74**	**0.95**	**0.86**	**1.08**	**0.97**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.

Table 7.4:
Postal Service Sent Packages by Income and Education
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Income *(Thousands)*	Education of Head of Household				Average
	Less than High School	High School Graduate	Some College or Technical School	College Graduate	
Under $35	0.00	0.16	0.02	0.05	**0.07**
$35 to $65	0.08	0.01	0.04	0.06	**0.04**
$65 to $100	0.00	0.08	0.13	0.09	**0.10**
Over $100	0.00	0.12	0.04	0.11	**0.09**
Average	**0.04**	**0.08**	**0.06**	**0.09**	**0.07**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.

Household Size

As would be expected, Table 7.5 shows that two-person households received and sent significantly more packages than one-person households. It also shows that, in most cases, larger family households, with more than two members, received and sent more packages than households with fewer members. In Table 7.6 we see that households with two or more adults received more packages than those with one adult. For packages sent, households with two adults sent more than twice as many packages as one-adult households; however, that relationship did not hold for households with three or more adults, as they reported sending fewer packages than those with two adults.

Table 7.5:
Postal Service Received and Sent Packages
by Size of Household
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Size	Received	Sent
One person	0.55	0.03
Two	0.98	0.07
Three	1.14	0.10
Four	1.34	0.07
Five or more	1.20	0.16
Average	**0.97**	**0.07**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.

Table 7.6:
Postal Service Received and Sent Packages
by Number of Adults in Household
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Number of Adults	Received	Sent
One	0.59	0.04
Two	1.05	0.09
Three or more	1.25	0.07
Average	**0.97**	**0.07**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.

Internet Access

The number of packages received by households in 2021 was found to be strongly influenced by the level of Internet access available. In Table 7.7, households with Broadband access sent 60% more and received twice as many packages as households without access. Relatedly, Table 7.8 shows that online-shoppers received and sent more than twice as many packages as households that did not shop online.

> Households with Internet access received more than twice as many packages as households without access.

By enabling households to shop online from their homes, the Internet has emerged as the primary driver behind the strong growth in packages delivered by the Postal Service.

Table 7.7:
Received and Sent Packages
by Household Internet Access
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Type of Internet Access	Received	Sent
Broadband	1.00	0.08
Dial-up	0.67	0.02
None	0.40	0.05
Others	0.98	0.60
Average	**0.97**	**0.07**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.

Table 7.8:
Received and Sent Packages
by Household Online Shopping Behavior
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Shopping Online?	Received	Sent
Yes	1.02	0.07
No	0.40	0.02

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2021.

Household Package Contents

As shown in Table 7.9, more than one-quarter of packages received by households (27%) contained clothing items. Household products, pharmaceuticals, and cosmetics were the next most frequent contents, with shares of 13%, 13%, and 7%, respectively.

Most packages sent by households also contained primarily clothing items (31%). Other frequent contents included music videos (14%) and household products (12%). These items are often part of the high volume of packages sent during the holiday season.

Table 7.9:
Contents of Postal Service Sent and Received Packages

Contents	Volume (Millions of Pieces)					
	2019		2020		2021	
	Sent	Received	Sent	Received	Sent	Received
Clothing/Footwear/Shoes	131	1,296	135	1,666	158	1,779
Household/Kitchen/Lawn and garden products	18	514	23	814	62	865
Health/Medical/Dental/Vision products	12	658	21	762	8	830
Cosmetics/Beauty products/Toiletries	3	364	12	508	2	461
Book(s)	14	336	22	432	5	425
Toys	15	184	56	214	12	387
Food Products	2	194	1	287	4	329
Electronic equipment	13	229	28	333	24	280
Music/Video	86	241	85	229	70	234
Computer hardware, software, or accessories	3	146	4	161	17	181
Travel products or information	1	65	2	34	3	53
Photos/Film	0	35	1	41	0	52
Checkbooks	0	13	0	19	1	15
Other Contents	58	866	109	1,029	150	1,094
Total Packages	**345**	**4,698**	**489**	**5,915**	**505**	**6,528**

Table 7.9:
Contents of Postal Service Sent and Received Packages (cont.)

Contents	Percent of Pieces					
	2019		2020		2021	
	Sent	Received	Sent	Received	Sent	Received
Clothing/Footwear/Shoes	38%	28%	28%	28%	31%	27%
Household/Kitchen/Lawn and garden products	5%	11%	5%	14%	12%	13%
Health/Medical/Dental/Vision products	3%	14%	4%	13%	2%	13%
Cosmetics/Beauty products/Toiletries	1%	8%	2%	9%	0%	7%
Book(s)	4%	7%	4%	7%	1%	7%
Toys	4%	4%	11%	4%	2%	6%
Food Products	1%	4%	0%	5%	1%	5%
Electronic equipment	4%	5%	6%	6%	5%	4%
Music/Video	25%	5%	17%	4%	14%	4%
Computer hardware, software, or accessories	1%	3%	1%	3%	3%	3%
Travel products or information	0%	1%	0%	1%	1%	1%
Photos/Film	0%	1%	0%	1%	0%	1%
Checkbooks	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%
Other Contents	17%	18%	22%	17%	30%	17%
Total Packages	**100%**	**100%**	**100%**	**100%**	**100%**	**100%**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2019, 2020, and 2021.
Notes:
Contents questions are multiple response; as such, total packages do not equal the sum for each column.
Does not include contents for which no answer was given (DK/RF).
Music/Video packages include 0.2 billion pieces of CD/DVDs sent and received, reported in First-Class Mail letters in Tables E.1, 1.5, and 1.6

Appendix A: Annual Trends

Table A8-1
First Class Mail Received by Type
Pieces in Millions
Years 2010 - 2021 (Diary Data)

	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021
Correspondence												
Personal	4,855	4,301	4,266	3,895	3,603	3,249	3,157	3,136	3,061	2,803	2,690	2,944
Greeting Cards	3,278	3,083	3,069	2,767	2,562	2,251	2,243	2,265	2,320	1,967	1,904	2,094
Letter from Friend or Relative	837	701	693	652	592	588	493	515	436	464	499	489
Other Personal	740	517	505	477	449	410	421	356	305	372	288	360
Business/Government	9,234	10,586	10,691	10,243	10,644	10,650	10,889	10,866	10,735	10,297	10,301	10,418
Notice/ Announcement/ Business Invitation	4,297	4,403	4,748	4,518	4,905	5,116	5,051	5,049	4,767	4,546	4,492	4,376
Tax-Related (Docs, information, forms)	526	1,001	991	998	1,062	983	1,174	1,093	1,156	1,159	1,221	1,399
Insurance	2,001	2,602	2,443	2,426	2,571	2,401	2,353	2,442	2,509	2,565	2,222	2,330
Other Bus/Gov	2,410	2,580	2,509	2,301	2,106	2,150	2,310	2,282	2,302	2,026	2,366	2,313
Social	1,905	1,394	1,355	1,359	1,161	1,105	1,098	1,012	979	1,003	1,014	872
Notice/ Announcement/ Business Invitation	1,351	752	773	723	645	608	535	486	512	511	436	385
Other Social	554	642	582	635	516	497	563	526	467	492	579	487
Total	15,995	16,281	16,311	15,497	15,408	15,004	15,144	15,015	14,775	14,103	14,005	14,234
Transactions												
Bills	11,274	11,347	10,824	10,815	10,412	10,219	9,852	9,116	8,761	8,033	7,540	7,009
Financial Statements	5,418	4,655	4,744	4,285	4,514	4,204	3,994	4,051	3,931	3,741	3,871	3,582
Credit Card Statement/Bill	4,091	3,834	4,023	3,454	3,690	3,623	3,742	3,514	3,765	3,334	3,053	2,784
Request for donation	660	755	687	652	609	596	524	500	547	482	515	522
Payment/Check/Credit	1,194	1,009	993	1,055	998	1,039	895	894	740	745	807	920
Other	626	1,307	1,230	1,252	1,131	1,200	1,276	1,139	1,152	896	942	1,004
Total	23,263	22,906	22,501	21,512	21,355	20,881	20,283	19,214	18,896	17,231	16,728	15,821
Advertising (Ads Only)	6,115	5,448	5,021	4,240	3,925	3,593	3,826	3,712	3,504	3,973	3,470	3,640
CD/DVD/Video Games	942	1,040	543	466	374	312	217	212	170	134	102	108
DK/RF[1]	3,748	2,598	2,828	2,426	1,768	1,610	1,811	1,641	1,613	1,559	1,423	1,259
Total First-Class Received	50,063	48,272	47,204	44,142	42,830	41,400	41,280	39,794	38,958	36,999	35,729	35,062

[1] Purpose of Correspondence and Transaction mail was not reported

Table A8-2
Shares of First Class Mail Received by Type
Years 2010 - 2021 (Diary Data)

	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021
Correspondence												
Personal	10%	9%	9%	9%	8%	8%	8%	8%	8%	8%	8%	8%
Greeting Cards	7%	6%	7%	6%	6%	5%	5%	6%	6%	5%	5%	6%
Letter from Friend or Relative	2%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%
Other Personal	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%
Business/Government	18%	22%	23%	23%	25%	26%	26%	27%	28%	28%	29%	30%
Notice/ Announcement/ Business Invitation	9%	9%	10%	10%	11%	12%	12%	13%	12%	12%	13%	12%
Tax-Related (Docs, information, forms)	1%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	4%
Insurance	4%	5%	5%	5%	6%	6%	6%	6%	6%	7%	6%	7%
Other Bus/Gov	5%	5%	5%	5%	5%	5%	6%	6%	6%	5%	7%	7%
Social	4%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	2%
Notice/ Announcement/ Business Invitation	3%	2%	2%	2%	2%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%
Other Social	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	2%	1%
Total	32%	34%	35%	35%	36%	36%	37%	38%	38%	38%	39%	41%
Transactions												
Bills	23%	24%	23%	24%	24%	25%	24%	23%	22%	22%	21%	20%
Financial Statements	11%	10%	10%	10%	11%	10%	10%	10%	10%	10%	11%	10%
Credit Card Statement/Bill	8%	8%	9%	8%	9%	9%	9%	9%	10%	9%	9%	8%
Request for donation	1%	2%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%
Payment/Check/Credit	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	3%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	3%
Other	1%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	2%	3%	3%
Total	46%	47%	48%	49%	50%	50%	49%	48%	49%	47%	47%	45%
Advertising (Ads Only)	12%	11%	11%	10%	9%	9%	9%	9%	9%	11%	10%	10%
CD/DVD/Video Games	2%	2%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	0%	0%	0%	0%
DK/RF	7%	5%	6%	5%	4%	4%	4%	4%	4%	4%	4%	4%
Total First-Class Received	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%

Table A8-3
First Class Mail Sent by type
Pieces in Millions
Years 2010 - 2021 (Diary Data)

	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021
Correspondence												
Personal	4,234	3,547	3,631	3,647	3,160	3,274	2,810	2,471	2,540	2,346	2,400	2,472
Greeting Cards	2,834	2,572	2,705	2,652	2,261	2,263	2,138	1,816	1,850	1,718	1,700	1,792
Letter to Friend or Relative	798	636	667	675	561	678	461	409	468	423	575	423
Other Personal	602	340	259	320	338	332	211	246	221	206	125	257
Business/Government	1,094	1,209	1,195	1,106	1,067	1,185	1,080	963	771	816	782	786
Social	263	209	183	163	176	148	157	121	130	158	165	180
Total	5,591	4,965	5,009	4,916	4,403	4,607	4,047	3,555	3,441	3,319	3,346	3,438
Transactions												
Bill Payment	5,632	5,517	5,098	4,513	4,470	4,383	3,753	3,341	3,100	2,784	2,467	2,432
Orders/Rebate request	279	359	321	247	249	224	189	190	157	143	169	132
Donations	345	355	391	330	332	288	286	260	251	247	304	278
Total	6,257	6,231	5,810	5,089	5,051	4,894	4,228	3,791	3,508	3,174	2,940	2,842
CD/DVD/Video Games	700	758	380	360	318	218	174	168	130	80	63	61
DK/RF[1]	208	112	134	126	119	139	143	128	189	95	121	113
Total First-Class Sent	12,755	12,066	11,333	10,492	9,891	9,859	8,592	7,641	7,268	6,668	6,470	6,454

[1] Combination of Correspondence and Transactions (Purpose is unknown)

Table A8-4
Shares of First Class Mail Sent by type
Years 2010 - 2021 (Diary Data)

	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021
Correspondence												
Personal	33%	29%	32%	35%	32%	33%	33%	32%	35%	35%	37%	38%
Greeting Cards	22%	21%	24%	25%	23%	23%	25%	24%	25%	26%	26%	28%
Letter to Friend or Relative	6%	5%	6%	6%	6%	7%	5%	5%	6%	6%	9%	7%
Other Personal	5%	3%	2%	3%	3%	3%	2%	3%	3%	3%	2%	4%
Business/Government	9%	10%	11%	11%	11%	12%	13%	13%	11%	12%	12%	12%
Social	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	3%	3%
Total	44%	41%	44%	47%	45%	47%	47%	47%	47%	50%	52%	53%
Transactions												
Bill Payment	44%	46%	45%	43%	45%	44%	44%	44%	43%	42%	38%	38%
Orders	2%	3%	3%	2%	3%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	3%	2%
Donations	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	4%	5%	4%
Total	49%	52%	51%	49%	51%	50%	49%	50%	48%	48%	45%	44%
CD/DVD/Video Games	5%	6%	3%	3%	3%	2%	2%	2%	2%	1%	1%	1%
DK/RF	2%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	2%	2%	3%	1%	2%	2%
Total First-Class Sent	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%

Table A8-5a
Bills and Statements Received
Pieces in Millions by Sender Type
Years 2010 - 2021 (Diary Data)

Payee	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021
Financial												
Credit Card	4,091	3,834	4,023	3,454	3,690	3,623	3,742	3,532	3,760	3,349	3,051	2,755
Bank, S&L, Credit Union	4,216	3,703	3,517	3,474	3,531	3,264	3,015	2,960	2,821	2,596	2,537	2,347
Insurance Company	2,459	1,668	1,661	1,725	1,719	1,740	1,667	1,704	1,498	1,362	1,437	1,293
Real Estate/Mortgage	376	317	313	390	374	318	397	356	342	306	382	298
Other Financial	1,578	1,543	1,654	1,331	1,401	1,426	1,353	1,280	1,253	1,273	1,282	1,138
Total Financial	12,719	11,064	11,168	10,376	10,716	10,370	10,175	9,832	9,674	8,886	8,689	7,831
Merchants												
Department Store	129	32	63	59	54	49	38	62	34	18	9	37
Publisher	300	327	290	275	202	210	158	146	163	107	119	95
Mail Order Company	139	101	88	71	77	94	65	49	34	16	10	43
Other Merchants	221	163	171	164	148	136	164	141	164	145	89	101
Total Merchants	790	623	612	569	482	488	424	399	395	287	227	276
Services												
Telephone /Cable Company	2,287	2,436	2,367	2,134	2,050	1,821	1,730	1,634	1,493	1,353	1,232	974
Utility Company	2,444	2,494	2,329	2,416	2,304	2,433	2,335	2,384	2,268	2,141	2,082	1,854
Medical and Other Professional	2,299	2,069	1,936	1,947	2,026	1,846	1,953	1,575	1,692	1,561	1,318	1,476
Other Service	393	404	402	387	352	369	376	313	372	326	403	306
Total Service	7,423	7,403	7,035	6,884	6,731	6,469	6,395	5,906	5,826	5,381	5,035	4,611
Manufacturers	59	51	26	21	47	46	27	26	18	24	28	59
Government	671	501	530	520	470	493	386	389	401	407	385	488
Social	173	159	191	159	127	136	149	100	113	87	80	75
Other/Don't Know/Refused	38	35	29	25	45	43	32	29	31	38	21	35
Total – All Industries	21,874	19,836	19,591	18,554	18,617	18,046	17,589	16,681	16,457	15,109	14,464	13,375

Table A8-6
Shares of Bills Paid by Method
Years 2010 - 2021 (Recruitment Data)

Method	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021
Mail	47%	44%	40%	37%	34%	31%	27%	30%	27%	23%	21%	19%
Internet using a Computer	29%	31%	31%	33%	35%	34%	34%	31%	31%	32%	30%	31%
Internet using Mobile Phone	0%	0%	2%	2%	3%	4%	7%	8%	10%	12%	14%	14%
Internet using Other Device	0%	0%	1%	2%	3%	6%	5%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%
Auto Deduction from Bank	13%	13%	14%	14%	14%	14%	15%	15%	15%	17%	18%	19%
In Person	5%	5%	5%	5%	4%	4%	4%	4%	4%	3%	3%	2%
Credit Card	3%	3%	4%	4%	4%	4%	5%	5%	6%	6%	7%	8%
Telephone	2%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	4%	4%	4%	3%	3%
Total	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%
Total Electronic [1]	48%	51%	55%	59%	62%	65%	69%	66%	69%	73%	76%	79%

[1] Includes bills paid by Internet, Auto Deduction from Bank Account, Credit Card, and Telephone

Table A8-7
Shares of Households using Method of Paying Bills
Years 2010 - 2021 (Recruitment Data)

Method	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021
Mail	84%	79%	78%	74%	71%	69%	68%	63%	59%	56%	55%	51%
Internet using a Computer	51%	54%	55%	59%	61%	61%	63%	56%	55%	58%	58%	59%
Internet using Mobile Phone	N/A	N/A	7%	11%	11%	15%	23%	22%	26%	31%	35%	37%
Internet using Other Device	N/A	N/A	2%	5%	7%	12%	12%	8%	8%	8%	9%	9%
Auto Deduction from Bank Account	52%	50%	55%	55%	54%	54%	61%	52%	54%	57%	60%	62%
In Person	29%	28%	31%	27%	24%	24%	25%	22%	23%	19%	18%	14%
Credit Card	19%	18%	21%	22%	20%	21%	27%	23%	25%	27%	30%	32%
Telephone	13%	16%	18%	18%	16%	17%	19%	18%	18%	16%	16%	14%

Table A8-8
Type of Payments made by Mail
Pieces in Millions by Payee Type
Years 2010 - 2021 (Diary Data)

Payee	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021
Financial												
Credit Card	1,185	1,111	1,085	861	889	871	791	718	674	632	526	510
Bank, S&L, Credit Union	399	376	333	236	271	319	257	180	198	170	114	130
Insurance Company	486	478	407	389	410	383	343	304	291	259	252	237
Real Estate/Mortgage	228	219	168	182	157	175	129	153	98	81	113	67
Other Financial	37	26	27	36	31	35	43	26	18	21	13	24
Total Financial	2,336	2,210	2,020	1,704	1,758	1,783	1,562	1,380	1,280	1,163	1,018	967
Merchants												
Department Store	105	66	67	57	59	59	55	50	12	22	13	21
Publisher	151	157	159	179	112	104	83	72	68	77	87	47
Mail Order Company	82	52	50	52	52	47	53	47	35	12	10	19
Other Merchants	91	95	115	75	90	56	62	60	55	53	53	65
Total Merchants	429	369	391	362	313	266	253	229	170	164	162	152
Services												
Telephone /Cable Company	880	884	777	653	593	544	470	401	393	316	322	240
Utility Company	952	920	912	818	780	785	633	627	539	520	421	449
Medical and Other Professional	543	537	520	476	542	520	421	339	360	226	228	254
Other Service	203	247	212	192	189	190	171	156	163	166	140	145
Total Service	2,577	2,588	2,421	2,139	2,104	2,039	1,695	1,523	1,456	1,228	1,110	1,088
Manufacturers	7	9	10	6	8	9	12	10	5	8	8	10
Government	238	140	141	122	136	127	116	110	92	100	80	111
Social	0	106	71	97	63	65	54	60	55	68	39	46
Other/Don't Know/Refused	46	96	45	84	90	93	60	28	43	53	49	59
Total – All Industries	5,632	5,517	5,098	4,513	4,470	4,383	3,753	3,341	3,100	2,784	2,467	2,432

Table A8-9
Type of Payments made by Mail
Percent of Bill Payments by Payee Type
Years 2010 - 2021 (Diary Data)

Payee	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021
Financial												
Credit Card	21%	20%	21%	19%	20%	20%	21%	21%	22%	23%	21%	21%
Bank, S&L, Credit Union	7%	7%	7%	5%	6%	7%	7%	5%	6%	6%	5%	5%
Insurance Company	9%	9%	8%	9%	9%	9%	9%	9%	9%	9%	10%	10%
Real Estate/Mortgage	4%	4%	3%	4%	4%	4%	3%	5%	3%	3%	5%	3%
Other Financial	1%	0%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%
Total Financial	41%	40%	40%	38%	39%	41%	42%	41%	41%	42%	41%	40%
Merchants												
Department Store	2%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	2%	0%	1%	1%	1%
Publisher	3%	3%	3%	4%	3%	2%	2%	2%	2%	3%	4%	2%
Mail Order Company	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	0%	0%	1%
Other Merchants	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	1%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	3%
Total Merchants	8%	7%	8%	8%	7%	6%	7%	7%	5%	6%	7%	6%
Services												
Telephone /Cable Company	16%	16%	15%	14%	13%	12%	13%	12%	13%	11%	13%	10%
Utility Company	17%	17%	18%	18%	17%	18%	17%	19%	17%	19%	17%	18%
Medical and Other Professional	10%	10%	10%	11%	12%	12%	11%	10%	12%	8%	9%	10%
Other Service	4%	4%	4%	4%	4%	4%	5%	5%	5%	6%	6%	6%
Total Service	46%	47%	47%	47%	47%	47%	45%	46%	47%	44%	45%	45%
Manufacturers	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%
Government	4%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	4%	3%	5%
Social	0%	2%	1%	2%	1%	1%	1%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%
Other/Don't Know/Refused	1%	2%	1%	2%	2%	2%	2%	1%	1%	2%	2%	2%
Total – All Industries	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%

Table A8-10
Share of Households by Internet Access type
Years 2010 - 2021 (Recruitment Data)

Type of Access	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021
None	21%	18%	17%	13%	13%	11%	10%	10%	8%	7%	6%	6%
Total Internet Access	78%	81%	83%	86%	87%	88%	89%	89%	90%	93%	94%	94%
Dial-up	6%	3%	3%	2%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	0%	1%	1%
Cable Modem	34%	38%	41%	44%	85%	86%	88%	88%	89%	91%	92%	92%
Other Broadband	10%	14%	14%	17%								
DSL	25%	23%	23%	20%								
Other/ Did Not Specify Connection	4%	3%	2%	3%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	2%	2%
DK/RF/Missing	0%	1%	0%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	0%	0%	0%
Total	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%

Note: All types of Broadband services are combined beginning in 2014

Table A8-11
Number of Purchases Made over the Internet over the past month
Percent of Households
Years 2010 - 2021 (Recruitment Data)

	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021
All Households												
None	52%	46%	45%	40%	37%	36%	34%	29%	24%	20%	17%	13%
1	8%	8%	9%	9%	8%	8%	8%	6%	6%	6%	5%	3%
2	10%	12%	10%	11%	11%	11%	11%	10%	10%	10%	8%	6%
3-5	17%	20%	20%	22%	25%	25%	24%	30%	27%	27%	27%	24%
6-10	8%	9%	10%	11%	12%	14%	14%	16%	20%	20%	23%	26%
More than 10	5%	5%	6%	7%	7%	8%	9%	9%	14%	16%	21%	28%
Total	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%
Households that Made 1+ purchases												
1	16%	15%	16%	15%	13%	12%	12%	9%	8%	8%	6%	3%
2	21%	22%	18%	18%	18%	17%	16%	14%	13%	12%	9%	7%
3-5	36%	37%	36%	37%	39%	38%	37%	42%	35%	34%	32%	28%
6-10	16%	16%	18%	18%	19%	21%	21%	23%	26%	25%	27%	30%
More than 10	10%	10%	12%	12%	11%	12%	14%	13%	18%	20%	26%	32%
Total	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%

Table A8-12
First Class and Marketing Mail Advertising
Pieces in Millions
Years 2010 - 2021 (Diary Data)

	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021
First-Class Mail Advertising	12,793	12,710	11,437	9,709	8,987	8,370	8,292	7,795	7,594	7,475	6,279	6,714
Advertising Only	6,115	5,448	5,021	4,240	3,925	3,593	3,826	3,712	3,504	3,973	3,470	3,640
Advertising Enclosed	6,678	7,262	6,416	5,469	5,062	4,776	4,466	4,083	4,090	3,503	2,809	3,074
Marketing Mail Ads	72,934	77,747	73,874	74,365	71,788	71,631	71,754	69,075	67,681	65,686	54,867	59,127
Total Advertising Mail	85,727	90,457	85,311	84,074	80,775	80,001	80,046	76,871	75,275	73,161	61,146	65,841
First-Class Mail Advertising Shares of Total Ads	15%	14%	13%	12%	11%	10%	10%	10%	10%	10%	10%	10%

Table A8-13A
First Class and Marketing Mail Advertising By Sender Type
Pieces in Millions
Years 2010 - 2021 (Diary Data)

	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021
First-Class Mail Advertising [1]												
Financial	4,632	4,651	4,231	3,366	3,394	3,378	3,214	3,146	3,174	3,086	2,675	2,867
Merchants	2,422	2,172	2,186	1,832	1,817	1,594	1,517	1,385	1,391	1,403	1,142	1,082
Services	4,472	4,767	4,068	3,496	2,931	2,668	2,712	2,579	2,271	2,196	1,723	1,845
Manufacturers	262	212	165	190	148	153	202	174	115	178	142	223
Government	296	289	219	264	210	138	169	145	161	157	195	217
Social	611	587	549	538	458	421	438	342	450	434	373	387
Other	98	31	20	24	28	17	41	25	32	22	34	94
Total	12,793	12,710	11,437	9,709	8,987	8,370	8,292	7,795	7,594	7,475	6,284	6,714
Marketing Mail Advertising												
Financial	14,809	18,472	15,404	15,775	15,437	15,687	17,177	16,567	16,269	16,658	12,651	14,457
Merchants	24,990	25,427	24,241	23,092	23,281	22,034	21,687	20,819	19,701	17,137	13,672	13,535
Services	10,798	11,324	10,813	11,641	11,365	11,874	11,902	11,391	11,107	11,011	8,899	10,300
Manufacturers	1,560	1,638	1,579	1,642	971	1,250	1,333	1,260	1,032	1,173	858	1,268
Government	1,046	976	1,068	992	892	921	951	908	1,018	1,089	1,428	1,358
Social	12,367	12,739	13,503	13,984	12,799	12,689	11,988	11,665	12,232	12,534	11,980	12,664
From Multiple Organizations	6,484	6,678	6,704	6,591	6,590	6,815	6,183	6,100	5,839	5,638	4,997	4,988
Other	880	494	563	647	453	361	534	366	483	447	383	558
Total	72,934	77,747	73,874	74,365	71,788	71,631	71,754	69,075	67,681	65,686	54,867	59,127
Total Advertising Mail												
Financial	19,441	23,123	19,634	19,141	18,831	19,065	20,391	19,713	19,442	19,743	15,326	17,324
Merchants	27,411	27,599	26,427	24,924	25,098	23,628	23,203	22,204	21,093	18,539	14,814	14,617
Services	15,270	16,092	14,881	15,137	14,296	14,542	14,613	13,970	13,378	13,208	10,622	12,145
Manufacturers	1,822	1,850	1,744	1,832	1,119	1,403	1,535	1,434	1,146	1,351	1,000	1,491
Government	1,342	1,265	1,287	1,257	1,102	1,059	1,120	1,053	1,179	1,245	1,623	1,575
Social	12,978	13,325	14,051	14,522	13,258	13,110	12,426	12,007	12,682	12,968	12,353	13,050
From Multiple Organizations	6,484	6,678	6,704	6,591	6,590	6,815	6,183	6,100	5,839	5,638	4,997	4,988
Other	979	525	583	671	481	378	574	391	514	470	416	651
Total	85,727	90,457	85,311	84,074	80,775	80,001	80,046	76,871	75,275	73,161	61,150	65,841

[1] Includes Secondary Advertising

Table A8-13A2
First Class Advertising ONLY (no secondary) and Marketing Mail By Sender Type
Pieces in Millions
Years 2010 - 2021 (Diary Data)

	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021
First-Class Mail Advertising [1]												
Financial	1,655	1,517	1,411	1,160	1,121	1,163	1,195	1,311	1,222	1,534	1,394	1,562
Merchants	2,028	1,777	1,703	1,411	1,493	1,222	1,153	1,063	1,099	1,148	957	896
Services	1,966	1,601	1,503	1,204	988	951	1,078	1,068	915	996	825	767
Manufacturers	245	183	133	150	123	106	183	141	95	149	128	208
Government	172	138	64	150	56	26	51	36	39	33	55	49
Social	0	215	191	157	134	119	150	86	129	108	87	110
Other	48	17	15	8	9	7	17	7	4	5	23	49
Total	6,115	5,448	5,021	4,240	3,925	3,593	3,826	3,712	3,504	3,973	3,470	3,640
Marketing Mail Advertising												
Financial	14,809	18,472	15,404	15,775	15,437	15,687	17,177	16,567	16,269	16,658	12,651	14,457
Merchants	24,990	25,427	24,241	23,092	23,281	22,034	21,687	20,819	19,701	17,137	13,672	13,535
Services	10,798	11,324	10,813	11,641	11,365	11,874	11,902	11,391	11,107	11,011	8,899	10,300
Manufacturers	1,560	1,638	1,579	1,642	971	1,250	1,333	1,260	1,032	1,173	858	1,268
Government	1,046	976	1,068	992	892	921	951	908	1,018	1,089	1,428	1,358
Social	12,367	12,739	13,503	13,984	12,799	12,689	11,988	11,665	12,232	12,534	11,980	12,664
From Multiple Organizations	6,484	6,678	6,704	6,591	6,590	6,815	6,183	6,100	5,839	5,638	4,997	4,988
Other	880	494	563	647	453	361	534	366	483	447	383	558
Total	72,934	77,747	73,874	74,365	71,788	71,631	71,754	69,075	67,681	65,686	54,867	59,127
Total Advertising Mail												
Financial	16,464	19,989	16,815	16,935	16,558	16,849	18,371	17,877	17,491	18,192	14,045	16,019
Merchants	27,018	27,204	25,944	24,503	24,774	23,256	22,840	21,883	20,801	18,285	14,629	14,431
Services	12,764	12,925	12,316	12,845	12,353	12,825	12,980	12,459	12,022	12,007	9,724	11,067
Manufacturers	1,805	1,821	1,713	1,792	1,094	1,356	1,516	1,401	1,127	1,321	986	1,476
Government	1,219	1,114	1,132	1,143	948	948	1,002	944	1,057	1,122	1,483	1,406
Social	12,367	12,954	13,693	14,140	12,933	12,807	12,138	11,752	12,361	12,642	12,066	12,773
From Multiple Organizations	6,484	6,678	6,704	6,591	6,590	6,815	6,183	6,100	5,839	5,638	4,997	4,988
Other	929	511	578	655	462	368	550	372	487	452	406	606
Total	79,049	83,195	78,895	78,605	75,713	75,225	75,580	72,788	71,185	69,659	58,337	62,767

[1] Excludes Secondary Advertising

Table A8-14
First Class and Marketing Mail Advertising By Sender Type
Percent of Pieces
Years 2010 - 2021 (Diary Data)

	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021
First-Class Mail Advertising [1]												
Financial	36%	37%	37%	35%	38%	40%	39%	40%	42%	41%	43%	43%
Merchants	19%	17%	19%	19%	20%	19%	18%	18%	18%	19%	18%	16%
Services	35%	38%	36%	36%	33%	32%	33%	33%	30%	29%	27%	27%
Manufacturers	2%	2%	1%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	3%
Government	2%	2%	2%	3%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	3%	3%
Social	5%	5%	5%	6%	5%	5%	5%	4%	6%	6%	6%	6%
Other	1%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	1%	1%
Total	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%
Marketing Mail Advertising												
Financial	20%	24%	21%	21%	22%	22%	24%	24%	24%	25%	23%	24%
Merchants	34%	33%	33%	31%	32%	31%	30%	30%	29%	26%	25%	23%
Services	15%	15%	15%	16%	16%	17%	17%	16%	16%	17%	16%	17%
Manufacturers	2%	2%	2%	2%	1%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%
Government	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	2%	2%	3%	2%
Social	17%	16%	18%	19%	18%	18%	17%	17%	18%	19%	22%	21%
From Multiple Organizations	9%	9%	9%	9%	9%	10%	9%	9%	9%	9%	9%	8%
Other	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%
Total	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%
Total Advertising Mail												
Financial	23%	26%	23%	23%	23%	24%	25%	26%	26%	27%	25%	26%
Merchants	32%	31%	31%	30%	31%	30%	29%	29%	28%	25%	24%	22%
Services	18%	18%	17%	18%	18%	18%	18%	18%	18%	18%	17%	18%
Manufacturers	2%	2%	2%	2%	1%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%
Government	2%	1%	2%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	2%	2%	3%	2%
Social	15%	15%	16%	17%	16%	16%	16%	16%	17%	18%	20%	20%
From Multiple Organizations	8%	7%	8%	8%	8%	9%	8%	8%	8%	8%	8%	8%
Other	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	0%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%
Total	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%

[1] Includes Secondary Advertising

Table A8-15
Treatment Of Advertising Material By Household Income
Percent of Households
Years 2010 - 2021 (Recruitment Data)

	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021
Usually Read - Total	20%	22%	22%	20%	20%	19%	18%	16%	16%	14%	15%	14%
Under $25K	44%	44%	42%	40%	42%	41%	41%	37%	32%	30%	24%	26%
$25 - $ 49.9	26%	22%	23%	24%	26%	26%	25%	31%	30%	31%	33%	31%
$50 - $64.9	11%	10%	12%	13%	10%	12%	10%	10%	11%	11%	11%	11%
$65 +	19%	24%	24%	23%	22%	21%	24%	22%	27%	27%	32%	32%
Usually Scan - Total	27%	26%	25%	21%	21%	22%	22%	22%	24%	22%	23%	22%
Under 25K	26%	24%	22%	23%	22%	25%	23%	21%	18%	17%	14%	14%
$25 - $ 49.9	26%	21%	21%	24%	28%	23%	23%	22%	26%	24%	24%	25%
$50 - $64.9	14%	12%	13%	13%	14%	12%	13%	13%	11%	14%	11%	11%
$65 +	35%	43%	44%	40%	37%	40%	41%	44%	45%	44%	51%	50%
Read Some - Total	35%	32%	34%	36%	37%	36%	35%	36%	34%	37%	36%	35%
Under 25K	24%	22%	22%	21%	17%	19%	18%	18%	14%	15%	14%	11%
$25 - $ 49.9	23%	21%	22%	23%	25%	23%	23%	22%	25%	22%	21%	22%
$50 - $64.9	14%	12%	14%	13%	14%	13%	13%	12%	13%	14%	14%	12%
$65 +	40%	46%	42%	43%	45%	45%	46%	48%	49%	49%	51%	55%
Usually Don't Read - Total	18%	21%	20%	23%	21%	23%	25%	25%	27%	27%	26%	29%
Under 25K	28%	25%	29%	25%	19%	21%	18%	19%	15%	14%	12%	12%
$25 - $ 49.9	20%	22%	19%	19%	20%	23%	20%	21%	23%	19%	19%	17%
$50 - $64.9	13%	13%	12%	10%	12%	12%	14%	10%	12%	13%	9%	11%
$65 +	39%	41%	41%	46%	48%	44%	49%	51%	49%	54%	60%	61%

Appendix B: Methodology

Study Design and Methodology

The U.S. Postal Service Household Diary Study (HDS), conducted by NuStats on behalf of the Finance and Strategy group, is a continuously fielded study that measures household mail volumes, mail usage, and attitudes about the mail and advertising.

The HDS uses a two-stage survey design: Stage 1 is an online and interviewer-mediated household recruitment interview. Stage 2 is a self-completion mail diary [Appendix C contains the survey instruments]. The diary can be completed on paper or online. The HDS uses a multi-mode approach to minimize response bias, to improve data accuracy through efficient data checking and household re-contacts, and to provide immediate telephone assistance to participants during their diary week.

Household Recruitment Interview

The **household recruitment interview** collects information on head of households' demographics, recall of mail sent and received, adoption and use of communications technologies, bill payment behavior, and attitudes towards advertising.

Mail Diary

The **mail diary** covers a seven-day period (Monday to Sunday) and collects information on the number of mail pieces received and sent, industry source, mail characteristics, and attitudes regarding mail received.

Sample Design

This section describes the household selection process for participation in the HDS. A sample is the representative subset of the survey population used to gain information about the entire population. The population of inference for the HDS is all U.S. households. The probability design ensures each household has an equal chance of selection.

The sample design allows projections of results to all U.S. households. The Postal Service provided an address sample that NuStats matched for known telephone listings. Invitation letters are mailed to all sampled households with information about how to participate. Generally, the study was conducted using telephone and online sampling for household selection and screening, followed by diaries and/or instructional materials mailed to eligible households and completed by each household unit either by paper, or by internet. Households without telephones were contacted via U.S. Mail. The sample design involves a systematic sample stratified by strata (or urban/rural location) and Census regions, ensuring even coverage across the United States.

A master national sample was specified and drawn by in-house sampling statisticians. The Postal Service drew the household probability sample from the national address database following NuStats specifications. The master list, sorted by ZIP code, was used to draw a systematic stratified sample, which was then tagged with variables indicating each housing unit's geographic location in terms of Census region and stratum.

Sample was drawn for each of the four quarters based on known proportions of households within a Census region and urban or rural location. Census regions are defined by state. Urban and rural location is defined by county and metropolitan status as defined by the U.S. Census Bureau. The strata are defined by county as follows:

- **Stratum 1:** Counties that are part of the 30 largest metropolitan areas in the United States, as defined by the 2020 US Census.
- **Stratum 2:** Counties that are part of metropolitan areas but are not in Stratum 1.
- **Stratum 3:** Counties that are not part of a metropolitan area.

Quarterly sample frames were then derived based on the amount of sample needed for each quarter, and sample was allocated to region and strata cells based on known proportions as indicated by Census 2020 count of households.

The sample was continuously "fielded" throughout all 52 weeks of the year. Sample was released in a manner designed to recruit equal sample sizes for each diary week, resulting in a sample file of at least 5,200 households. Table B.1 shows the distribution of recruited and completed households.

Table B.1:
Sample by Postal Quarter

Quarter	Required Sample	Recruited Households	Completed Households
Quarter 1	1,300	2,126	1,297
Quarter 2	1,300	2,339	1,412
Quarter 3	1,300	2,348	1,410
Quarter 4	1,300	2,502	1,538
Total	**5,200**	**9,315**	**5,657**

Data Collection Method

The study uses a two-stage design in which households are recruited to participate in the diary study by choosing to use a telephone interview or an online survey (Stage 1) and recruited households complete a seven-day diary of mail received and sent (Stage 2) either by paper or online.

Stage 1: Household Recruitment Interview

The main function of the household recruitment interview is to recruit households to participate in the diary study. In addition, the interview collects information on household and person demographics, recall of mail sent and received, adoption and use of communication technologies, bill payment behavior, and attitudes towards advertising.

Households completed the recruitment interview via computer-assisted telephone interviewing (CATI) technology or by using an online survey. The FY 2021 household interview consisted of 7,902 online surveys and 1,413 phone interviews completed with an adult member (age 18 or older) in the household. Table B.2 below shows the distribution of recruited households by recruitment type.

Table B.2:
Sample by Recruitment Type

Recruitment Interview	Completed	Sample Percent
Phone	1,413	15.2%
Web	7,902	84.8%
Total	**9,315**	**100%**

These respondents represented a cross-section of U.S. households by geography. The household interview contained 130 data items and took an average of 30 minutes to administer. The flow of the interview included the following elements:

- **Introduction.** Each interview began with an introduction and purpose of the interview. The interviewer also verified the respondent's address.
- **Technology adoption and use.** Questions were asked about ownership and use of personal computers, Internet, and other electronic communication.
- **Mail volume recall.** The respondent was asked to summarize how many bills, statements, and packages all members of the household have sent in a particular time period.
- **Bill payments.** Bill payment volumes, methods, and timing were explored in depth.
- **Periodicals.** A summary of magazine and newspaper volumes received by the household were collected.
- **Advertising.** Descriptions of advertising received by the household as well as attitudes about the advertising, and orders placed because of it, were elicited.
- **Use of postal services.** The use of post offices, post office boxes, and private mailing services was explored.
- **Online shopping.** Respondents were asked about their online shopping habits, including questions about shipping methods.
- **Financial accounts and credit cards.** Respondents were asked to summarize the total accounts and credit cards held by the household.
- **Household and person demographics.** Demographic items included gender, age, marital status, employment status, educational attainment, race/ethnicity, household income, household wage earners, home ownership, residence tenure, and dwelling type.

The completion rate for the FY 2021 study (defined as the proportion of respondents who completed the diary portion relative to all recruited respondents) was 60.7 percent compared to 67.8 percent in FY 2020. Most recruitment refusals took place prior to hearing who NuStats was and why the firm was calling. Refusal households that were later re-contacted cited time constraints and privacy concerns as reasons for not participating.

Stage 2: Mail Diary Package

Recruited households were sent the website for the online diary, instructions, and a toll-free "help" telephone number. If they chose the diary on paper, they were sent seven mail diaries. The night before the beginning of an assigned diary week, NuStats made reminder calls to households to confirm receipt of the diary package and to answer any questions. If the diary package was not received by this time, NuStats re-confirmed the address, assigned a new diary week, and re-sent the diary package.

The diary package contains a Certificate of Appreciation, Instruction Booklet, and a photo-based "Quick Start" sheet. The Instruction Booklet provided information about the study, answers to frequently asked questions, instructions for filling out the diary, guidelines for sorting mail, and examples of mail markings. The paper diary instrument was composed of two parts:

- **The Question sheets.** The Question sheets are color-coded by mail classification (First-Class Mail received, First-Class Mail sent, Marketing Mail, Nonprofit, etc.). Information collected about each mail classification included: type of mail piece (i.e., envelope, postcard, catalog, etc.), mail classification, mail type, sender type, information about advertising enclosed, and receiver reaction or responses to the mail piece.
- **Seven answer booklets,** each specific to a day of the week. Each booklet was arranged by mail classification and color-coded to correspond to the question sheets.

The online diary guided Respondents through the questions and easily recorded each day's mail all in one website. Households were instructed to enclose pertinent information from each mail piece received to enable NuStats editors to verify or clarify quantity and classes of mail recorded in the diaries. Respondents participating online were instructed to upload photographs of their mail. NuStats used a three-stage editing process to check the accuracy of the diary information recorded by each household. First, returned diary packages were culled for those that represented a reasonable attempt to complete the diary. Second, the diary information recorded for each day were checked to ensure sufficient and logical answers, as well as to verify recorded information against the mail markings returned in the package. The diaries were then scanned using Optical Character Recognition (OCR) software. In stage three, a verifier re-checked the diary information recorded in the OCR software for each day. This second edit functions as a quality control check to ensure data accuracy.

Overall, about one percent of returned diaries did not pass the edit checking process.

Of the 9,315 households recruited to receive a diary package 5,657 actually returned acceptable completed diaries (defined as containing data suitable for analysis) to NuStats, for a completion rate of 60.7 percent.

Data Management

Data management entails processing the information resulting from the Household Interview and Mail Diaries, making it available for analysis, storing it, and documenting it. Household interviews were conducted using both web and CATI technology. Questionnaire and relevant data checks were programmed into a master questionnaire that was used in the web and phone survey. Recorded data was extracted from the web and CATI software into a database management file.

Diary information was recorded through web and paper. Returned paper diary information was recorded (entered) through optical scanning technology. The diary data, once scanned using Teleform software, was captured in a database management file. Similarly, web diary information are stored in a web server and later on captured in a database management file.

After completion of data collection, editing and entry tasks, the survey data were contained in 9 data files. One data file contained the Household Interview data. The Mail Diary data were in 8 files—one for each mail classification (First-Class Mail received, First-Class Mail sent, etc.). These files were all developed in SAS-PC.

The file variables were identified by variable name. For each file variable, the File Information contains:

- Label, which is a brief description of the variable;
- Measurement level, which specifies the level of measurement as scale (numeric data on an interval or ratio scale), ordinal, or nominal. Nominal and ordinal data can be either string (alphanumeric) or numeric;
- Value formats, which identify the response codes; and
- Column width and alignment.

Several SAS programming operations were necessary to put the Mail Diary data in the desired form for analysis. The structure for these programs was contained in a separate File Information document that accompanied the data delivery.

Various edit routines were used to check the consistency of the reported data and to identify reporting or entry errors. Routine edit checks were conducted to examine questionnaire responses for reasonableness and consistency across items. Routine checks included such items as:

- Response code range checks;
- Checks for proper data skips and patterns of answering questions consistent with prior answers;
- Checks for realistic responses (e.g., number of online purchases possible in one month); and
- Checks for high frequency of item non-response (missing data from question refusals).

When conducting these checks, data were compared against the actual survey forms. NuStats identified extreme values that were impossible or unlikely, and corrected inconsistent data when possible.

Some extreme/inconsistent data values unable to be corrected or verified were edited to missing values.

In addition, NuStats performed in-depth customized data checks to ensure data within each record of the Household Interview were logically consistent. For example, a respondent should have reported paying bills online only if he/she also reported having Internet access.

Raw variables, derived variables, and analytical programs were documented in a data documentation binder that accompanied the data delivery. Any information that could be directly or indirectly used to identify individual respondents, such as respondent names, addresses, or telephone numbers, were removed to protect respondent confidentiality and privacy. Such information is stored in a locked archival file.

Sample Demographic Profile (All Counts Unweighted), Government Fiscal Year 2021

Table B.3:
Annual Household Income by Recruitment/Retrieval Status

Annual Household Income	Recruited Households		Total	Sample Percent	Population Percent
	Retrieved	Not Retrieved			
$0 - $24,999	305	308	613	5.4%	18.1%
$25,000 - $34,999	315	238	553	5.6%	8.1%
$35,000 - $49,999	458	314	772	8.1%	11.6%
$50,000 - $64,999	548	267	815	9.7%	10.5%
$65,000 - $79,999	516	321	837	9.1%	8.8%
$80,000 - $99,999	587	324	911	10.4%	9.4%
$100,000 or more	1,792	1,103	2,895	31.7%	33.5%
Don't Know	104	103	207	1.8%	N/A
Refused	1,032	680	1,712	18.2%	N/A
Total	**5,657**	**3,658**	**9,315**	**100.0%**	**100.0%**

Notes:
Sample Percent based only on retrieved households that provided a response to the Household Income question.
Population percent based on U.S. Census Bureau, Current Population Survey Annual Demographic File (March 2021).

Table B.4:
Number of Adults in Household by Recruitment/Retrieval Status

Number of Adults in Household	Recruited Households		Total	Sample Percent	Population Percent
	Retrieved	Not Retrieved			
One	1,188	851	2,039	21.0%	33.1%
Two	2,730	1,415	4,145	48.3%	50.5%
Three	736	585	1,321	13.0%	11.1%
Four	607	485	1,092	10.7%	4.0%
Five or More	396	322	718	7.0%	1.3%
Total	**5,657**	**3,658**	**9,315**	**100.0%**	**100.0%**

Notes:
Sample Percent based only on retrieved households.
Population percent based on U.S. Census Bureau, Current Population Survey Annual Demographic File (March 2021).

Table B.5:
Geographic Region by Recruitment/Retrieval Status

Geographic Region	Recruited Households		Total	Sample Percent	Population Percent
	Retrieved	Not Retrieved			
Northeast	899	606	1,505	15.9%	17.6%
Midwest	1,486	770	2,256	26.3%	21.7%
South	1,954	1,480	3,434	34.5%	38.3%
West	1,318	802	2,120	23.3%	22.3%
Total	**5,657**	**3,658**	**9,315**	**100.0%**	**100.0%**

Notes:
Sample Percent based only on retrieved households.
Population percent based on 2020 Decennial Census P.L. 94-171 Redistricting Data Summary Files

Table B.6:
Urban/Rural Location by Recruitment/Retrieval Status

Urban/Rural Location	Recruited Households		Total	Sample Percent	Population Percent
	Retrieved	Not Retrieved			
30 Largest Metro Areas	2,613	1,726	4,339	46.2%	44.3%
Other Metro Areas	2,450	1,503	3,953	43.3%	41.4%
Non-Metropolitan Areas	594	429	1,023	10.5%	14.3%
Total	**5,657**	**3,658**	**9,315**	**100.0%**	**100.0%**

Notes:
Sample Percent based only on retrieved households.
Population percent based on 2020 Decennial Census P.L. 94-171 Redistricting Data Summary Files

Table B.7:
Age of Head of Household by Recruitment/Retrieval Status

Age of Head of Household	Recruited Households		Total	Sample Percent	Population Percent
	Retrieved	Not Retrieved			
18 - 24	47	73	120	0.8%	4.1%
25 - 44	1,164	1,089	2,253	20.6%	32.9%
45 - 64	2,044	1,286	3,330	36.1%	35.4%
65+	2,271	1,095	3,366	40.1%	27.5%
Refused	131	115	246	2.3%	N/A
Total	**5,657**	**3,658**	**9,315**	100.0%	100.0%

Notes:
Sample Percent based only on retrieved households that provided a valid response.
Population percent based on U.S. Census Bureau, Current Population Survey Annual Demographic File (March 2021).

Table B.8:
Educational Attainment of Head of Household by Recruitment/Retrieval Status

Educational Attainment of Head of Household	Recruited Households		Total	Sample Percent	Population Percent
	Retrieved	Not Retrieved			
8th grade or less	42	46	88	0.7%	2.8%
Some high school	73	89	162	1.3%	5.2%
High school graduate	738	639	1,377	13.0%	25.7%
Some college	926	710	1,636	16.4%	16.7%
Technical school graduate	336	230	566	5.9%	4.6%
College graduate	1,876	1,108	2,984	33.2%	29.9%
Postgraduate work	1,549	711	2,260	27.4%	14.9%
Refused	117	125	242	2.1%	N/A
Total	**5,657**	**3,658**	**9,315**	100.0%	100.0%

Notes:
Sample Percent based only on retrieved households that provided a valid response.
Population percent based on U.S. Census Bureau, Current Population Survey Annual Demographic File (March 2021).

Data Weighting and Expansion

This section explains the methodology used for creating sampling and expansion weights for the FY 2021 Household Diary Study.

The FY 2021 HDS uses both weighting and expansion factors to 1) adjust the sample data to match population parameters and 2) expand mail volumes exhibited in the diary sample to all U.S. households.

Weighting Procedures, FY 2021 Recruitment Data

Sampling weights were produced separately for the households that participated in the recruitment phase of the FY 2021 HDS, and those that completed and returned a diary. There were four main weighting variables: Geography, Education, Age, and Homeownership. FY 2021 recruitment geographic weights were derived from sample households' strata and region:

Strata: As mentioned previously, there are three strata. A household was classified within strata as residing in the top 30 metropolitan areas nationwide, any other metropolitan area, or a non-metropolitan area.[1] Table B.9 provides unweighted sample counts from FY 2021 recruitment data for strata:

Table B.9:
HDS 2021 Recruitment Data: Urban/Rural Location

Urban/ Rural Location	Household	Percent	Cumulative Percent
30 Largest Metro Areas	4,339	46.6%	46.6%
Other Metro Areas	3,953	42.4%	89.0%
Non-Metro Counties	1,023	11.0%	100.0%
Total	**9,315**	100.0%	

[1] Core-Based Statistical Area (CBSA) is defined within the sample according to the official definition used by the U.S. Census Bureau. CBSAs refer collectively to both metropolitan and micropolitan statistical areas. Non-metropolitan areas are counties that do not belong to a metropolitan area. Each sample county was assigned to a stratum according to its metropolitan status.

Regions: Table B.10 provides unweighted sample counts from FY 2021 recruitment data for region. Households were classified by state. There are four mutually exclusive regions as defined by the U.S. Census Bureau (along with respective states):

Four Census Regions:

Northeast: Connecticut, Maine, Massachusetts, New Hampshire, New Jersey, New York, Pennsylvania, Rhode Island, and Vermont.

Midwest: Illinois, Indiana, Iowa, Kansas, Michigan, Minnesota, Missouri, Nebraska, North Dakota, Ohio, South Dakota, and Wisconsin.

South: Alabama, Arkansas, Delaware, District of Columbia, Florida, Georgia, Kentucky, Louisiana, Maryland, Mississippi, North Carolina, Oklahoma, South Carolina, Tennessee, Texas, Virginia, and West Virginia.

West: Arizona, Alaska, California, Colorado, Hawaii, Idaho, Montana, Nevada, New Mexico, Oregon, Utah, Washington, and Wyoming.

Table B.10:
HDS 2021 Recruitment Data: Geographic Region

Geographic Region	Households	Percent	Cumulative Percent
Northeast	1,505	16.2%	16.2%
Midwest	2,256	24.2%	40.4%
South	3,434	36.9%	77.2%
West	2,120	22.8%	100.0%
Total	**9,315**	100.0%	

Strata/Regions: Table B.11 indicates the distribution of households from the FY 2021 recruitment sample within strata and regions.

Population parameters for the intersection of the three strata and four regions were based on 2020 Census counts of households by county. As Table B.12 shows, each county was grouped according to its location within these 12 mutually exclusive and collectively exhaustive geographic categories.

To calculate the weight for each strata/region interval, the population percentage was divided by the sample percentage. Geography weights appear in the last column to the right in Table B.12.

Table B.11:
Distribution of Households within Strata and Region

Geographic Region	Stratum *(Urban/Rural Location)*			Total
	30 Largest Metro Areas	Other Metro Areas	Non-Metro Areas	
Northeast	739	626	140	**1,505**
Midwest	1,066	892	298	**2,256**
South	1,368	1,635	431	**3,434**
West	1,166	800	154	**2,120**
Total	**4,339**	**3,953**	**1,023**	**9,315**

Table B.12:
HDS 2021 Recruitment Data: Construction of Geographic Weight

Stratum	Geographic Region	Households *(Population)*	Percent	Households *(Sample)*	Percent	Weight
30 Largest Metro Areas	Northeast	12,803,973	9.85%	739	7.9%	1.24
	Midwest	8,946,379	6.89%	1,066	11.4%	.60
	South	19,359,300	14.90%	1,368	14.7%	1.01
	West	16,438,363	12.65%	1,166	12.5%	1.01
Other Metro Areas	Northeast	8,204,918	6.31%	626	6.7%	.94
	Midwest	13,113,048	10.09%	892	9.6%	1.05
	South	22,717,858	17.48%	1,635	17.6%	1.00
	West	9,810,542	7.55%	800	8.6%	.88
Non-Metro Areas	Northeast	1,911,527	1.47%	140	1.5%	.98
	Midwest	6,181,691	4.76%	298	3.2%	1.49
	South	7,729,819	5.95%	431	4.6%	1.29
	West	2,714,003	2.09%	154	1.7%	1.26
Totals		**129,931,421**	**100.0%**	**9,315**	**100.0%**	**1.00**

Source: Household Population Estimates based on U.S. Census Bureau, 2020 Census.

Education: In addition to weighting for differences in geography between the sample and the population, an additional weight was created based on differences in the educational attainment of the head of household. For those households in which either more than one person was identified as the head of household or no individual was identified as the head of household, one was chosen based on the following sequence of criteria: 1) oldest male or 2) oldest female (if no male exists). For cases in which two candidates for the head of the household were of the same age, the respondent on the phone was chosen.

Known population parameters were based on weighted proportions derived from the U.S. Census Bureau's Current Population Survey annual demographic file for March 2021. For cases in which the head of household refused to provide his/her education level, an educational level was imputed based on the average educational level of like cases. There were 242 such cases in 2021; mean levels of educational attainment were based on geography (strata and regions), as well as age and income level, if provided.

Table B.13:
HDS 2021 Recruitment Data: Construction of Educational Attainment Weight

Educational Attainment	Households *(Population)*	Percent	Households *(Sample)*	Percent	Weight
Less than high school diploma	10,454,153	8.0%	250	2.7%	3.00
High school graduate	33,436,335	25.7%	1,377	14.8%	1.74
Some college	21,740,022	16.7%	1,643	17.6%	0.95
Technical school graduate	5,968,080	4.6%	742	8.0%	0.58
College graduate	38,912,316	29.9%	3,043	32.7%	0.92
Postgraduate work	19,420,515	14.9%	2,260	24.3%	0.62
Totals	129,931,421	100.0%	9,315	100.0%	1.00

Note: Education responses include imputed Don't Know/Refused answers.

Age: Additional weight was also created based on differences in the age of the head of household. Known population parameters were based on weighted proportions derived from the U.S. Census Bureau's Current Population Survey annual demographic file for March 2021. For cases in which the head of household refused to provide his/her age, an age level was imputed based on the average age level of like cases. There were 246 such cases in 2021; mean levels of age were based on geography (strata and regions), as well as education level, if provided.

Table B.14:
HDS 2021 Recruitment Data: Construction of Age Weight

Educational Attainment	Households *(Population)*	Percent	Households *(Sample)*	Percent	Weight
18-24	5,348,377	4.1%	120	1.3%	3.20
25-34	20,674,817	15.9%	869	9.3%	1.71
35-44	22,127,477	17.0%	1,391	14.9%	1.14
45-54	21,687,448	16.7%	1,458	15.7%	1.07
55-64	24,363,256	18.8%	2,086	22.4%	0.84
65-74	20,527,872	15.8%	2,145	23.0%	0.69
75+	15,202,174	11.7%	1,246	13.4%	0.87
Total	129,931,421	100.0%	9,315	100.0%	1.00

Note: Age responses include imputed Don't Know/Refused answers.

Homeownership: In addition to weighing for differences in income, education and geography between the sample and the population, data were weighed to account for homeownership rates for U.S. Households. For those households in which homeownership was unknown, one was imputed based on the average income level and geography of like cases. There were 269 such cases in 2021; mean levels of income attainment were based on geography (strata and regions). Known population parameters were based on weighted proportions derived from the U.S. Census Bureau's Current Population Survey quarterly Housing Vacancies and Homeownership file for November 2021. The average Homeownership rate in 2021 is 65.6 percent.

Weighting Procedures, FY 2021 Diary Data

As mentioned above, 9,315 households participated in the recruitment phase of the FY 2021 HDS, and 5,657 households completed usable diaries. Balancing weights for the FY 2021 HDS diary data were developed by applying the same approach used for recruitment data. An additional age weight was derived based on the age of the head of household using the following categories: 18–24, 25–34, 35–44, 45–54, 55–64, 65–74, and over 75 years old.

Other adjustments to weights used in the diary data included a quarterly adjustment, which accounted for variances in sampling across postal quarters.

All component weights were multiplied together and normalized to ensure that the total number of weighted cases equals the number of unweighted cases.

A final adjustment in the form of expansion factors was made to expand the sample to the level of total households in the United States at the time of data collection, which was 129.9 million. The number of households in the United States was divided into the number of households that participated in the diary portion of the survey. The resultant factor was applied to each household in the survey. The expansion factor was multiplied by the sampling weight and then multiplied by 52 (the number of calendar weeks in one year) to derive nationwide annual volume estimates from the sample data.

Expansion Factor
129931420.81/ 5,657 = 22,968.3

Component Weight:

$$\omega = \frac{Ps / Pt}{Ss / St},$$

Where Ps = population count in cohort and
Pt = total population count
Ss = sample count in cohort
St = total sample count

Appendix C: Survey Instruments

Appendix C1: Recruitment Questionnaire

Recruitment Questionnaire – FY2021

Acronym Dictionary
DK = Don't Know
RF = Refusal
NA = Not applicable

1. **[LETTR]** The U.S. Postal Service is conducting a study to better understand the type and amount of mail and packages households like yours receive and send. The information will be used to make better decisions about postage rates and staffing needs to ensure an efficient national mail system and keep costs at a minimum. We recently sent a letter explaining the study and to let you know we would contact you. Did you receive our letter?

1 Yes

2 No

2. **[VADDW]** First, we'd like to verify your name and mailing address. The research study is based on mailing addresses. To qualify for the study, your address has to match the address we have in our records. However, apartment numbers can change so if your street address is correct but the apartment number is not, please edit the apartment number in the field below. Is your address...

ADDRESS: <MADDR>
APT: <MSUIT>
CITY: <MCITY> STATE: <MSTAT> ZIP: <MZIP1> <MZIP2>

1 YES => Lang
2 No, entire address is wrong => INT10 CODE AS QN
3 No, Apt/Suit # is wrong [CAN BE ADJUSTED] => SKIP TO MSUI2 => Lang
9 Not applicable/Rather not say

3. **[INT07]** IF VADDW=9 Refused,

I understand not wanting to give out your address, but to participate in the survey and be eligible to receive 100 First-Class or $40, I'll need to verify your mailing address. If you have any questions, please call 1-888-441-8777. Thank you, have a nice evening/day. CODE AS RA (REFUSED ADDRESS), AND TERMINATE.

4. **[MSUI2]** What is the new apartment or suite number? NOTE: Leave blank if you no longer have an apartment number or suite number. =>LANG

5. **[LANG]** Please select the language you prefer to complete the survey in: Por favor elija el idioma que prefiere usar para completar la encuesta:

English (Inglés)..... 1
Spanish (Español) 2

6. **[INT]** [WHEN STRATA/REGION QUOTAS CLOSE:] Thank you for your time, I'm sorry if we've inconvenienced you, but we have filled the quota for the region in which you live. For this survey, the USPS has randomly selected households based on their mailing address. If you have any questions, please call 1-888-441-8777. Have a nice evening/day."

"Exit Survey" -> Code as OQ

7. **[HISPANIC]** Would you describe the head of your household as Hispanic or Latino? (A person of Cuban, Mexican, Puerto Rican, South or Central American, or other Spanish culture or origin, regardless of race.)

1..... Yes => **CONTINUE**
2..... No => **CONTINUE**

8. **[INT05] [ACTIVATE AND DEACTIVATED AT EACH END OF QTR WHEN ONLY 1 ASSN WEEK REMAINING]:** Your household was selected to participate in the diary study the week of <Last ASSN>. If your household cannot participate during the specified time, please exit the survey and thank you for your participation. If you can participate during this time, press Continue.

Continue - >

Exit Survey -> Code as QA

9. Web **[ASSNW]** We'd like for you to answer detailed questions about the mail and packages your household sends and receives for 7 days. You will receive your choice of either 100 Forever Stamps or a $40 check. You can expect your gift to arrive in about 10 - 12 weeks after we receive your completed information.

We want to confirm that you understand we are asking you to record your household's mail and packages for one week, the week you select from the list below. Is that a good week for you?.

You have the option to report your information in daily diaries that we will mail to you, OR by reporting your mail online using a mobile device or computer.

If this assignment week is not a good week for your household to participate, please email hotline-usps@nustats.com or call the survey hotline at 1-888-441-8777 11a - 9 pm Central Time. You will have the option to select a different assignment week.

[IF HISPANIC=1] In addition to getting 100 Forever Stamps or a $40 check your household is eligible to receive a $10 Amazon gift card or a WalMart gift card if you complete all phases of the project.

How much time does it take?

How long it takes depends on how much mail or packages you receive. The first day of your diary-recording week will take the longest as you become more familiar with the survey. After that, on average, it should only take about 3-5 minutes for each piece of mail **or package**. To help you, we have a USPS hotline available to provide you with step-by-step instructions if needed, and to answer any questions you may have. That toll free number is 1-888-441-8777. You may also want to check out the study web site at https://uspsmailsurvey.com/usps.

10. **[RECV]** Do you receive mail at your home address, including cluster boxes near your home?

1..... Yes => **CONTINUE**
2..... No => **CONTINUE**
8..... Unsure => **CONTINUE**
9..... Not applicable/Rather not say => **CONTINUE**

11. **[HMBOX]** Where is your mailbox located?

1..... Door slot
2..... Mailbox installed on a porch or near your front door
3..... Curbside single/double mailbox (not part of a cluster or group of mailboxes)
4..... Central mailbox cluster inside an apartment, condominium or other building
5……Central mailbox cluster outside in your neighborhood
[IF HMBOX=1-5, CONTINUE TO POBOX]
6..... Picked up mail from a post office box or box at a mailing center **-> [IF 6, THANK AND TERMINATE, AND MARK IT QM (INT04)]**
8..... Unsure**-> [IF 8, THANK AND TERMINATE, AND MARK IT QM (INT04)]**
9……Not applicable/Rather not say **=> [IF 9, THANK AND TERMINATE, AND MARK IT QM (INT04)]**

12. **[INT04]** Thank you very much for your time. I'm sorry if we inconvenienced you, but we need households that receive their mail at their home address. Have a nice evening/day. Goodbye.

QM……. DOES NOT RECEIVE MAIL AT HOME ADDRESS => GO TO END

13. **[Q210]** How many days a week do you check/collect your mail from your mailbox? [RANGE 1-7]
[PROGRAMMER: CHANGE FORMAT TO OPEN ENDED NUMBER]
0----------Never
8…….DK
9…….RF

14. **[Q211]** What motivates you to check your mailbox? Mark all that apply. [PROGRAMMER NOTE: MULTIPLE RESPONSE]

1…….To keep mail from piling up
2 …….Habitual/part of my routine
5…….To check for bills
6…….To check for financial statements
3……..To check for personal letters/cards from friends or family

4……. To check for professional correspondence (work, school, medical appointment notice, etc.)
7…….To check for coupons
8…….To check for catalogs
9…….To look at advertising material
10……Expecting a magazine, newsletter or other periodical
97……Other, please specify [O_Q211]
98……DK
99……RF

15. **[Q211A]** Of those you selected, what is the main reason that motivates you to check your mailbox? [PROGRAMMER: DISPLAY ONLY THE ANSWERS SELECTED IN Q211 AS THE ANSWER CHOICES IN Q211A, AND ONLY ALLOW THEM SELECT ONE ANSWER.]

1…….To keep mail from piling up
2 …….Habitual/part of my routine
5…….To check for bills
6…….To check for financial statements
3……..To check for personal letters/cards from friends or family
4……. To check for professional correspondence (work, school, medical appointment notice, etc.)
7…….To check for coupons
8…….To check for catalogs
9…….To look at advertising material
10……Expecting a magazine, newsletter or other periodical
97…… Other, please specify [**O_Q211**]
98……DK
99……RF

16. **[POBOX].**Does your household rent a PO Box at either the Post Office or a private mailing service, like Mailboxes Etc., Office Max, or Pak Mail?

1..... PO Box at USPS
2..... Box at private mailing service
3..... Neither- My household does not have a PO Box or a box at a private company.
4..... Both
7..... Other, Specify
8.....Unsure
9..... Not applicable/Rather not say

17. **[Q14B]** How many times in an average month do household members go inside a U.S. Post Office to the service counter? [RANGE: 0-60]

00..... None
98..... Unsure
99..... Not applicable/Rather not say

a. **[INT14B]** If you are not sure, please provide your best estimate of how many. How many times in an average month do household members go inside a U.S. Post Office to the service counter? VERIFY RESPONSE IF MORE THAN 30, RANGE: 0-60

00 . NONE
98 . DK
99 . RF

18. **[Q12]** How many times in an average month do household members go to a U.S. Post Office but not to the service counter? We mean an outside drop off box, going to your PO Box, or using an automated machine. [RANGE: 0-60]

98..... Unsure
99..... Not applicable/Rather not say

a. **[INT12]** If you are not sure, please provide your best estimate of how many. How many times in an average month do household members go to a U.S. Post Office but not to the service counter? We mean an outside drop off box, going to your PO Box, or using an automated machine. [RANGE: 0-60]

98 . Unsure
99 . Not applicable/Rather not say

19. **[Q13]** How many times in an average month do household members go to a private mailing service? For example, Mailboxes Etc. Office Max, or Pak Mail [RANGE: 0-30]

00..... None => **GO TO Q50**
98..... Unsure => **GO TO INT13**
99..... Not applicable/Rather not say => **GO TO Q50**

a. **[INT13]** If you are not sure, please provide your best estimate of how many. How many times in an average month do household members go to a private mailing service? For example, Mailboxes Etc. Office Max, or Pak Mail [RANGE: 0-30]

00 . None => **GO TO Q50**
98 Unsure => GO TO Q50
99 Not applicable/Rather not say => GO TO Q50

[**IF Q13=0,99 OR (Q13=98 AND INT13=0,98,99) THEN**

20. **[Q14]** Why does your household use a mailing service rather than the post office? MULTIPLE RESPONSE, ALLOW UP TO ALL ANSWERS

01..... Hours-longer/later
02..... Location
03..... Offers pick up service
04..... Cheaper
05..... Faster/overnight delivery
06..... Offers drop off service
07..... Packages it up
08..... Service-better/more efficient/friendly
09..... More reliable/seems safer
11 ..... Uses only in special circumstances
12 ..... For extra services (copying, faxes, mail boxes, etc.)
13 ..... Shorter wait time/lines, less crowded
14 ..... Recipient requested specific mailing service be used

16..... Accepts odd-shaped/oversized packages
18..... On-line tracking service
20..... Uses only for job/work-related packages
21..... To use UPS or FedEx, etc.
22 …… Sending back using the service that company used to ship it
97 .....Other, specify
98 .....Unsure
99 .....Rather not say

21. **[Q50]** Currently, the law does not allow anyone other than a U.S. Postal employee to place mail in your mailbox. How would you feel about changing the law to allow anyone to place mail or other items in your mailbox? Do you… .

1..... Prefer it
2..... Oppose it
3..... Not care one way or the other
8 ..... Unsure
9 ..... Rather not say

22. **[NQ21]** How many packages were delivered to your household by the Postal Service in the last 3 months? [Range 0-300]

998 ... Unsure
999 ... Not applicable/Rather not say

a. [INTN21] If you are not sure, please provide your best estimate of how many. How many packages were delivered to your household by the **Postal Service** in the last 3 months? [Range 0-300]

998 Unsure
999 Not applicable/Rather not say

23. **[NQ22A]** How many packages did your household send through the Postal Service in the last 3 months?

[Range 0-300]
998 ... Unsure
999 ... Not applicable/Rather not say

a. **[INTN22A]** If you are not sure, please provide your best estimate of how many. How many packages did your household send through the **Postal Service** in the last 3 months?

[Range 0-300]
98 . Unsure
99 . Not applicable/Rather not say

[PROGRAMMER NOTE: ADD BACK BUT AS A STAND-ALONE QUESTION WITHOUT SKIPS]

24. **[Q9R]** Which of the following methods have household members used in the last six months to mail packages, not letter mail? Do not include work-related packages. Note: If you used Click N Ship, or shipped a Household package from a work location, please indicate the method used to ship your package from the list below. Mark all that apply

[PROGRAMMER NOTE: mark all that apply except for choice 5, 98, and 99]

0..... Put the package in a blue USPS Mailbox
1..... Took Package inside a US Post Office to the service counter
4..... Left the package for my mail carrier for pick up
6..... Used an Automated Postal Center.
10..... UPS, UPS store, UPS pickup/drop off
11..... FedEx, FedEx store, FedEx pickup/drop off
2..... Took it to a private mailing service, like Mailboxes Etc. Office Max, or Pak Mail
7..... Other, Specify [O_Q9R]
5..... None. I have not mailed packages in the last six months [NOTE: THIS WILL BE LEFT HERE AS A RESPONSE OPTION BECAUSE IF THEY ANSWER DK/RF IN NQ22A WE DON'T KNOW IF IT'S TRULY DK/RF, OR THEY MEANT 0.]
98..... Unsure
99 Not applicable/Rather not say

25. **[Q219**] When mailing household packages, do you prefer to use the US Postal Service, UPS, FedEx, or a Private mailing service?

1 USPS -> **Go to Q220**
2 UPS -> **Go to Q226**
3 FedEx -> **Go to Q226**
4 Private Mailing Service -> **Go to Q226**
7 Other service [Specify] [O_Q219] -> Go to **Q226**
8 Unsure, No Prefernce, More than one preferred -> GO TO Q219A
9 Rather not say -> GO TO Q219A

26. [**Q219A**] [ONLY ASK IF THEY ANSWERED Q219=8,9] When mailing household packages, do you most often use the US Postal Service, UPS, FedEx, or a Private mailing service?

1 USPS -> **Go to Q220**
2 UPS-> **Go to Q226**
3 FedEx-> **Go to Q226**
4 Private Mailing Service-> **Go to Q226**
7 Other service [Specify] [O_Q219A] -> Go to **Q226**
8 Unsure, Not applicable, More than one → SKIP TO Q209
9 Rather not say → SKIP TO Q209

27. **[Q220]** _$Recall (RECALL=" We'd like to know the reasons why you prefer using USPS to mail household packages instead of another carrier. ", CONDITION="NOT Q219=2,3,4,7,8,9") _$Recall (RECALL=" We'd like to know the reasons why you often use USPS to mail household packages instead of another carrier. ", CONDITION="Q219=8,9")

Mark all that apply to your household

PROGRAMMER NOTE: MULTIPLE RESPONSE, ALLOW ALL ANSWERS

01 Hours-longer/later
02 Convenient Location

04 Cheaper
05 Faster delivery
08 The service is better/more efficient/friendly
09 More reliable/seems safer
13 Shorter wait time
03 Offers a pick-up service
06 Offers a drop-off service
07 They pack up the item for me
18 Online tracking
97..... Are there any other reasons? [SPECIFY]
98..... Unsure
99..... Rather not say

28. **[Q220A]**

_$Recall (RECALL="Of those you selected, what is the **main** reason for using USPS to mail household packages instead of another carrier?", CONDITION="NOT Q219=2,3,54,78,9")

_$Recall (RECALL="Of those you selected, what is the **main** reason for using USPS to mail household packages instead of another carrier?", ", CONDITION="Q219=8,9")

[PROGRAMMER: DISPLAY ONLY THE ANSWERS SELECTED IN [**Q220**] AS THE ANSWER CHOICES IN [Q220A] AND ONLY ALLOW 1 ANSWER.]

01 Hours-longer/later
02 Convenient Location
04 Cheaper
05 Faster delivery
08 The service is better/more efficient/friendly
09 More reliable/seems safer
13 Shorter wait time
03 Offers a pick-up service
06 Offers a drop-off service
07 They pack up the item for me
18 Online tracking
97..... Are there any other reasons? [SPECIFY]
98..... Unsure
99 Rather not say

29. **[Q226]**

_$Recall (RECALL=" We'd like to know the reasons why you prefer using [Q219] to mail household packages instead of the U.S. Postal Service.", CONDITION="NOT Q219=1, 8,9")

_$Recall (RECALL=" We'd like to know the reasons why you often use [Q219A] to mail household packages instead of the U.S. Postal Service. ", CONDITION="Q219=1,8,9")

Mark all that apply to your household

PROGRAMMER NOTE: MULTIPLE RESPONSE, ALLOW ALL ANSWERS

01 Hours-longer/later
02 Convenient Location
04 Cheaper
05 Faster delivery
08 The service is better/more efficient/friendly
09 More reliable/seems safer
13 Shorter wait time
03 Offers a pick-up service
06 Offers a drop-off service
07 They pack up the item for me
18 Online tracking
97..... Are there any other reasons? [SPECIFY]
98..... Unsure
99..... Rather not say

30. **[Q226A]**

_$Recall (RECALL="Of those you selected, what is the **main** reason for using [Q219] to mail household packages instead of the U.S. Postal Service?", CONDITION="NOT Q219=1,8,9")

_$Recall (RECALL="Of those you selected, what is the **main** reason for using [Q219A] to mail household packages instead of the U.S. Postal Service?", CONDITION="Q219=8,9")

[PROGRAMMER: DISPLAY ONLY THE ANSWERS SELECTED IN [**Q226**] AS THE ANSWER CHOICES IN [Q226A] AND ONLY ALLOW 1 ANSWER.]

01 Hours-longer/later
02 Convenient Location
04 Cheaper
05 Faster delivery
08 The service is better/more efficient/friendly
09 More reliable/seems safer
13 Shorter wait time
03 Offers a pick-up service
06 Offers a drop-off service
07 They pack up the item for me
18 Online tracking
97..... Are there any other reasons? [SPECIFY]
98..... Unsure
99 Rather not say

31. **[Q209]** Many people are now using the Internet to communicate, pay bills and conduct other household activities that were traditionally done by mail. In this next set of questions, we'll be asking about your household's access to and use of the Internet, including accessing the web through a mobile device. Do any of the adults age 18 or older in your household use the internet at home?

1……Yes
2……No
8……Unsure
9……Rather not say

IF Q209 = 2, SKIP TO Q24

32. **[Q23]** What is the primary type of internet connection used at home by the adults in your household?

4..... DSL, Cable Modem, Other Broadband (fiber optic, satellite), Wireless
2..... Mobile Broadband (such as a Smartphone)
1..... Dial-up modem
10..... None – we don't use the internet at home
8..... Unsure
9..... Rather not say
7..... Other, Specify **[O_Q23]**

IF (Q209=8,9 AND Q23=8,9) OR Q23 = 10, SKIP TO Q24

33. **[Q22]** How many adults age 18 or older in your household connect to the Internet from home? RANGE: 0-9

98..... Unsure
99..... Not applicable/Rather not say

34. **[Q24]** Do any of the adults in your household regularly access the Internet from any other location, such as work or a library?

1..... Yes
2..... No
8..... Unsure
9..... Not applicable/Rather not say

NOTE: SKIP TO Q177F IF

(Q209 = 2 AND Q24=2,8,9) OR (Q209 = 8,9 AND Q23 = 8,9,10 AND Q24 = 2,8,9)

[Q55B] With which of the following devices do adults in your household connect to the Internet for non-work-related purposes?

a. **[Q55B1]** A desktop or laptop computer?
   1 Yes
   2 No
   8 Unsure
   9 Rather not say

b. **[Q55B2]** A mobile phone or smartphone?
   1 Yes
   2 No
   8 Unsure
   9 Rather not say

c. **[Q55B3]** Another Internet device?
   1 Yes
   2 No
   8 Unsure
   9 Rather not say

NOTE: SKIP TO Q177F IF

(Q209 = 2 AND Q24=2,8,9) OR (Q209 = 8,9 AND Q23 = 8,9,10 AND Q24 = 2,8,9)

35. **[Q57A1]** How long have adults in your household been using the Internet at any location?

1..... Less than 1 year
2..... 1 to 2 years
3..... 2 to 5 years
4..... More than 5 years
8..... Unsure
9..... Not applicable/Rather not say

36. **[Q57B1]** During the last month, how often did adults in your household use the Internet for non-work-related purposes at any location? Would you say…

1..... Several times a day
2..... Almost every day
3..... Several times a week
4..... Once a week or less
8..... Unsure
9..... Not applicable/Rather not say

PROGRAMMER NOTE: SKIP TO Q177F IF

(Q209 = 2 AND Q24=2,8,9) OR (Q209 = 8,9 AND Q23 = 8,9,10 AND Q24 = 2,8,9)

37. **[Q57C2]** How many adults in your household are a member of an online social network, such as Twitter, Facebook, or Instagram?

RANGE: 0-9

00..... NONE **SKIP TO Q221**
98..... Unsure **SKIP TO Q221**
99..... Not applicable/Rather not say **SKIP TO Q221**

38. **[Q57C3]** [IF Q57C2=1-9] During the last month, how often did adults in your household access online social network sites?

1 ..... Several times a day
2 Several times a week
3 Once per week or less
4 Not in the last month
5 Other
8 Unsure
9 Not applicable/Rather not say

PROGRAMMER NOTE: SKIP TO Q177F IF (Q209 = 2 AND Q24=2,8,9) OR (Q209 = 8,9 AND Q23 = 8,9,10 AND Q24 = 2,8,9)

39. **[Q221]** In the last month did anyone in your household send any invitations using an invitation design and management website such as Evite or Paperless Post?

1 ..... Yes
2 ..... No
8 ..... Unsure
9 ..... Not applicable/Rather not say

NOTE: SKIP Q55K IF (Q209 = 2 AND Q24=2,8,9) OR (Q209 = 8,9 AND Q23 = 8,9,10 AND Q24 = 2,8,9)

40. **[Q55K]** In the last month, did anyone in your household make any purchases over the Internet?

1..... Yes CONTINUE
2..... No => **GO TO Q177F**
8..... Unsure => **GO TO Q177F**
9..... Not applicable/Rather not say => **GO TO Q177F**

NOTE: SKIP Q55R IF (Q209 = 2 AND Q24=2,8,9) OR (Q209 = 8,9 AND Q23 = 8,9,10 AND Q24 = 2,8,9)

41. **[Q55R]** [IFQ55K=1] In the last month, about how many purchases did your household make over the Internet [RANGE: 0-200]

000..... None **SKIP TO Q177F**

998..... Unsure **SKIP TO INT55R**
999..... Not applicable/Rather not say **SKIP TO Q177F**

a. **[INT55R]** [IFQ55K=1] If you are not sure, please provide your best estimate of how many. In the last month, about how many purchases did your household make over the Internet? [RANGE: 0-200]

000 None **SKIP TO Q177F**
998 Unsure **SKIP TO Q177F**
999 Not applicable/Rather not say **SKIP TO Q177F**

[**IF Q55R=000,999 OR (Q55R=998 AND INT55R=000,998,999) THEN SKIP Q177A**]

42. **[Q177A]** How many of these Internet purchases were shipped and delivered? Do not include internet purchases that were delivered electronically (such as e-tickets, software, or a gift certificate for an online retailer). [RANGE: 0-200] [IF Q177A> Q55R OR Q177A>INT55R → "Answer out of bounds 0- <Q55R OR INT55R>. "

000..... None
998..... Unsure
999..... Not applicable/Rather not say

a. **[INT177A]** [**IF Q55R>0&<998**] If you are not sure, please provide your best estimate of how many. How many of these Internet purchases were shipped and delivered? Do not include internet purchases that were delivered electronically (such as e-tickets, software, or a gift certificate for an online retailer). [RANGE: 0-200]

000 None
998 Unsure
999 Not applicable/Rather not say

PROGRAMMER NOTE: SKIP NQ177B IF
(Q209 = 2 AND Q24=2,8,9) OR (Q209 = 8,9 AND Q23 = 8,9,10 AND Q24 = 2,8,9)
SKIP NQ177B IF Q177A=0,998,999

43. **[**NQ177B**]** Thinking about your most recent Internet purchase that was shipped and/or delivered. Was the purchase shipped to…

1..... Your home address
2..... Your work address
3..... Your school address
4..... Another person's address
5..... Pick up at store / shipped to store
97..... Other. Please specify in the box.
0..... No one in my HH has ever purchased anything on the internet
98..... Unsure
99..... Not applicable/Rather not say

44. **[Q177F]** [**ASK ALL**] Would you feel more secure providing and/or receiving personal information through the Internet or through the U.S. Mail, or is it about the same?

1 ... Feel more secure providing personal information through the Internet
2 ... Feel more secure providing personal information through the US Mail
3 ... It's about the same
8 ... Unsure
9 ... Rather Not Say

45. **[SCRP3]** In the next several questions, we will ask you about the bills and statements your household receives in the mail and online. For these questions, please count credit card statements as bills rather than statements. Press 'Next' to continue

46. **[Q27]** [**ASK ALL**] How many bills does your household receive through the mail each month? For example utilities, cable, & credit card bills? **[***RANGE: 0-80*]

00 . None → **go to Q27C**
98 . Unsure → **go to INT27**
99 . Rather not say → **go to Q27AA**

a. **[INT27]** [**ASK ALL**] If you are not sure, please provide your best estimate of how many. How many bills does your household receive through the mail each month? For example utilities, cable, & credit card bills? **[***RANGE: 0-80*]

00 . None → **go to Q27C**
98 . Unsure → **go to Q27AA**
99 . Rather not say → **go to Q27AA**

[**IF Q27=00 OR (Q27=98 AND INT27=00) THEN SKIP Q27AA**]

47. **[Q27AA]** What are the reasons you receive bills through the mail instead of receiving them by Internet? Mark all that apply. [MULTIPLE RESPONSE, UP TO ALL RESPONSES]

27 No internet access to receive bills online
25 Have not set things up to receive bills online
26 Biller only sends bills by mail (or Biller does not send bills online)
08 Security/Privacy
14 Record Keeping
19 Convenience (Ease of use/Saves time)
20 I have always done it this way
30 I do not receive any bills in the mail
97 Other, Specify
98 Unsure
99 Rather not say

48. **[Q27AAA]** Of those you selected, what is the **main** reason you receive bills through the mail instead of receiving them by Internet? [PROGRAMMER: ALLOW ONE RESPONSE; ONLY DISPLAY OPTIONS SELECTED IN Q27AA]

27 No internet access to receive bills online
25 Have not set things up to receive bills online
26 Biller only sends bills by mail (or Biller does not send bills online)

08 Security/Privacy
14 Record Keeping
19 Convenience (Ease of use/Saves time)
20 I have always done it this way
30 I do not receive any bills in the mail
97 Other, Specify
98 Unsure
99 Rather not say

49. **[Q27C]** [**ASK ALL**] How many statements does your household receive through the mail each month? Please remember not to include credit card statements in this total. **[***RANGE: 0-80*]

00 . None→ **go to Q28**
98 . Unsure→ **go to INT27C**
99 . Rather not say→ **go to Q27DD**

a. **[INT27C]** [**ASK ALL**] If you are not sure, please provide your best estimate of how many. How many statements does your household receive through the mail each month? Please remember not to include credit card statements in this total. **[***RANGE: 0-80*]

00 .....None→ **go to Q28**
98 .....Unsure→ **go to Q27DD**
99 .....Rather not say→ **go to Q27DD**

[**IF Q27C=00 OR (Q27C=98 AND INT27C=00) THEN SKIP Q27DD**]

50. **[Q27DD]** What are the reasons you receive statements through the mail instead of receiving them by Internet? Mark all that apply. [PROGRAMMER ALLOW ALL RESPONSES]

27 No internet access to receive statements online
25 Have not set things up to receive statements online
26 Biller only sends statements by mail (or Biller does not send statements online)
08 Security/Privacy
14 Record Keeping
19 Convenience (Ease of use/Saves time)
20 I have always done it this way
30 I do not receive any statements in the mail
97 Other, Specify
98 Unsure
99 Rather not say

51. **[Q27DDD]** Of those you selected, what is the **main** reason you receive statements through the mail instead of receiving them by Internet? PROGRAMMER ONLY ONE RESPONSE, ONLY DISPLAY OPTIONS SELECTED FROM Q27DD]

27 No internet access to receive statements online
25 Have not set things up to receive statements online

26 Biller only sends statements by mail (or Biller does not send statements online)
08 Security/Privacy
14 Record Keeping
19 Convenience (Ease of use/Saves time)
20 I have always done it this way
30 I do not receive any statements in the mail
97 Other, Specify
98 Unsure
99 Rather not say

NOTE: SKIP TO Q212A **IF (Q209 = 2 AND Q24=2,8,9) OR (Q209 = 8,9 AND Q23 = 8,9,10 AND Q24 = 2,8,9)**

52. **[Q28]** How many bills does your household receive on-line at a website or through e-mail each month? For example utilities, cable, & credit card bills? **[**RANGE: 0-80]

00 None **GO TO Q212A**
98 Unsure **GO TO INT28**
99 Rather not say

a. [INT28] If you're not sure, please provide your best estimate of how many.] RANGE: 0-80
00 None **GO TO Q212A**
98 Unsure
99 Rather not say

53. **[Q28B]**For how many of these <Q28> bills that you receive online at a website or through email do you also receive a bill in the mail? [RANGE: 0-80] [IF Q28B >Q28 OR Q28B > INT28 → "Answer out of bounds 0- <Q28 OR INT28>"

00 None
98 Unsure
99 Rather not say

a. **[INT28B]** If you are not sure, please provide your best estimate of how many. For how many of these <Q28> bills that you receive online at a website or through email do you also receive a bill in the mail? [RANGE: 0-80] [IF Q28B >Q28 → "Your answer cannot be more than <Q28>. Please enter a valid number."

00 .....None
98 .....Unsure
99 .....Rather not say

54. **[Q28D]** [**If Q28** >**0**] What are the reasons you receive bills online at a website or through e-mail? Mark all that apply. [MULTIPLE RESPONSE, UP TO ALL RESPONSES]

27 Biller only provides online bills
02 Received a financial incentive
06 Avoided a financial penalty
07 Environmental
08 Security/Privacy

14 Record Keeping
21 Reduce Clutter
19 Convenience (Ease of use/Saves time)
20 I have always done it this way
30 I do not receive any bills online
97 Other, Specify
98 Unsure
99 Rather not say

55. **[Q28DD]** Of those you selected, what is the **main** reason you receive bills online at a website or through e-mail? [PROGRAMMER: ALLOW ONE RESPONSE, ONLY DISPLAY RESPONSES SELECTED IN Q28D]

27 Biller only provides online bills
02 Received a financial incentive
06 Avoided a financial penalty
07 Environmental
08 Security/Privacy
14 Record Keeping
21 Reduce Clutter
19 Convenience (Ease of use/Saves time)
20 I have always done it this way
30 I do not receive any bills online
97 Other, Specify
98 Unsure
99 Rather not say

56. **[Q212]** Thinking about this time last year, did you receive any bills:

a. By Mail

01 .....Yes
02 .....No
08 .....Unsure
09 .....Rather not say

b. Online at a website or through e-mail (computer, mobile phone, other internet device)

01 .....Yes
02 .....No
08 .....Unsure
09 .....Rather not say

NOTE: SKIP TO Q213A IF (Q209 = 2 AND Q24=2,8,9) OR (Q209 = 8,9 AND Q23 = 8,9,10 AND Q24 = 2,8,9)

57. **[Q28A]** How many statements does your household receive on-line at a website or through e-mail each month? Please remember not to include credit card statements in this total. [RANGE: 0-80]

00..... None **GO TO Q213A**
98 Unsure GO TO INT28A
99 Rather not say

a. **[INT28A]** If you are not sure, please provide your best estimate of how many. How many statements does your household receive on-line at a website or through e-mail each month? Please remember not to include credit card statements in this total. [RANGE: 0-80]

00 ..... None **GO TO Q213A**
98 ..... Unsure
99 ..... Rather not say

58. **[Q28E]**For how many of these <Q28A> statements that you receive online at a website or through email do you also receive a statement in the mail? [RANGE: 0-80] [IF Q28E >Q28A OR Q28E > INT28A → "Your answer cannot be more than <Q28A OR INT28A>." Please provide a valid number.

00..... None
98 Unsure
99 Rather not say

a. **[INT28E]** If you are not sure, please provide your best estimate of how many. For how many of these <Q28A> statements that you receive online at a website or through email do you also receive a statement in the mail? [RANGE: 0-80] IF Q28E >Q28A → "Your answer cannot be more than <Q28A>. Please provide a valid number. [RANGE: 0-80]

00 ..... None
98 ..... Unsure
99 ..... Rather not say

59. [Q28G] [**If Q28A >0**] What are the reasons you receive Statements online at a website or through e-mail? Mark all that apply. [MULTIPLE RESPONSE,- UP TO ALL RESPONSES]

27..... Biller only provides online statements
02..... Received a financial incentive
06..... Avoided a financial penalty
07..... Environmental
08..... Security/Privacy
14..... Record Keeping
21..... Reduce Clutter
19..... Convenience (Ease of use/Saves time)
20…... I have always done it this way
30..... I do not receive any statements online
97..... Other, Specify
98 Unsure
99 Rather not say

60. [Q28GG] Of those you selected, what is the **main** reason you receive Statements online at a website or through e-mail? [PROGRAMMER: ALLOW ONE RESPONSE,- ONLY DISPLAY OPTIONS SELECTED IN Q28G]

27..... Biller only provides online statements
02..... Received a financial incentive
06..... Avoided a financial penalty
07..... Environmental
08..... Security/Privacy

14..... Record Keeping
21..... Reduce Clutter
19..... Convenience (Ease of use/Saves time)
20…... I have always done it this way
30..... I do not receive any statements online
97..... Other, Specify
98 Unsure
99 Rather not say

63. **[Q213]** Thinking about this time last year, did you receive any statements:

a. By Mail

01 .....Yes
02 .....No
08 .....Unsure
09 .....Rather not say

b. Online at a website or through e-mail (computer, mobile phone, other internet device)

01 .....Yes
02 .....No
08 .....Unsure
09 .....Rather not say

64. **[Q29]** About how many total bills does your household pay, by any method, in an average month? [RANGE: 0-80]

98..... Unsure
99 Not applicable/Rather not say

a. **[INT29]** If you are not sure, please provide your best estimate of how many. About how many total bills does your household pay, by any method, in an average month? [RANGE: 0-80]

98 . Unsure
99 . Not applicable/Rather not say

65. **[Q31]** Of these <Q29> household bills, about how many are paid… If you're not sure, please provide your best estimate of how many.

NOTE: SKIP ALL THE INTERNET QUESTIONS (Q31D, Q31H, Q31I) IF (Q209 = 2 AND Q24=2,8,9) OR (Q209 = 8,9 AND Q23 = 8,9,10 AND Q24 = 2,8,9)

a. **[Q31A]** By mail RANGE: 0-80
98 Unsure
99 Not applicable/Rather not say

b. **[Q31D]** By Internet using a desktop computer or laptop? RANGE: 0-40
98 Unsure
99 Not applicable/Rather not say

c. **[Q31H]** By Internet using a mobile phone or smartphone? RANGE: 0-40

98 Unsure
99 Not applicable/Rather not say

d. **[Q31I]** By Internet using another device, such as a tablet? RANGE: 0-40

98 Unsure
99 Not applicable/Rather not say

e. **[Q31B]** In Person RANGE: 0-80

98 Unsure
99 Not applicable/Rather not say

f. **[Q31C]** By telephone call RANGE: 0-20

98 Unsure
99 Not applicable/Rather not say

g. **[Q31F]** By automatic deduction from bank account, or charge to debit card (Do not include online bill pay from a bank) RANGE: 0-20

98 Unsure
99 Not applicable/Rather not say

h. **[Q31G]** By automatic charge to credit card RANGE: 0-20

98 Unsure
99 Not applicable/Rather not say

NOTE: SKIP ALL THE INTERNET QUESTIONS (Q31D1, Q31H1, Q31I1) IF
(Q209 = 2 AND Q24=2,8,9) OR (Q209 = 8,9 AND Q23 = 8,9,10 AND Q24 = 2,8,9)

66. **[Q214]** Thinking about this time last year, did you pay any bills:

a. By Mail

01 .....Yes
02 .....No
08 .....Unsure
09 .....Rather not say

b. By Internet (computer, mobile phone, other internet device)

01 .....Yes
02 .....No
08 .....Unsure
09 .....Rather not say

ONLY ASK Q33A IF RESPONDENT SAID THEY PAY THAT WAY IN Q31A

67. **[Q33A]** What are the reasons you pay bills by mail?. [MULTIPLE RESPONSE –ALLOW ALL]

27 . No internet access to pay electronically
25 . Have not set things up to pay electronically
26 . Biller prefers/requires payment by mail
08 . Security/Privacy
14 . Record Keeping
19 . Convenience (Ease of use/Saves time)
20 . I have always done it this way
97 . Other, Specify
98 Unsure
99 Rather not say

68. **[Q33AA]** Of those you selected, what is the main reason you pay bills by mail? [PROGRAMMING NOTE: DISPLAY ONLY THE ANSWERS SELECTED IN Q33A AS THE ANSWER CHOICES & ONLY ALLOW ONE RESPONSE]

27..... No internet access to pay electronically
25..... Have not set things up to pay electronically
26..... Biller prefers/requires payment by mail
08..... Security/Privacy
14..... Record Keeping
19..... Convenience (Ease of use/Saves time)
20…... I have always done it this way
97..... Other, Specify
98 Unsure
99 Rather not say

ONLY ASK Q34A, Q34A1 IF RESPONDENT SAID THEY PAY THAT WAY In Q31C, Q31F, Q31G, Q31D, Q31H, Q31I, [>0 AND NOT 98,99] Exclude Q31B1>0 "in person"

69. **[Q34A]** What are the reasons you pay bills by electronic methods, such as Online, Automatic deduction from your bank, by phone, or Auto Charge to a Credit Card? [PROGRAMMER NOTE: MULTIPLE RESPONSE,- UP TO ALL RESPONSES] Mark all that apply.

00..... Biller prefers/requires payment electronically
01..... To save postage costs
02..... Convenience (ease of use/saves time)
03..... Received financial incentive
04..... Avoided a financial penalty
05..... Environmental
06..... Reduce paper clutter
08..... Security/Privacy
14……..Record Keeping
20….. I have always done it this way
97..... Other, Specify [O_Q34A]
98..... Unsure
99..... Rather not say

[PROGRAMMER: DISPLAY ONLY THE ANSWERS SELECTED IN Q34A AS THE ANSWER CHOICES IN Q34A1, AND ONLY ALLOW THEM SELECT ONE ANSWER.]

70. **[Q34A1]** Of those you selected, what is the **main** reason you pay bills by electronic methods, such as Online, Automatic deduction from your bank, by phone, or Auto Charge to a Credit Card? [PROGRAMMING NOTE: ONLY ALLOW ONE RESPONSE]

00..... Biller prefers/requires payment electronically
01..... To save postage costs
02..... Convenience (ease of use/saves time)
03..... Received financial incentive
04..... Avoided a financial penalty
05..... Environmental
06..... Reduce paper clutter
08..... Security/Privacy
14……..Record Keeping
20….. I have always done it this way
97..... Other, Specify [O_Q34A1]
98..... Unsure
99..... Rather not say

71. **[Q36]** How many different magazine subscriptions do members of your household receive through the mail? [RANGE: 0-50]

98..... Unsure
99..... Not applicable/Rather not say

a. **[INT36]** If you are not sure, please provide your best estimate of how many. How many different magazine subscriptions do members of your household receive through the mail? [RANGE: 0-50]

98 . Unsure
99 . Not applicable/Rather not say

PROGRAMMER NOTE: SKIP Q37 IF

(Q209 = 2 AND Q24=2,8,9) OR (Q209 = 8,9 AND Q23 = 8,9,10 AND Q24 = 2,8,9)

72. **[Q37]** How many different magazine subscriptions do members of your household receive online? [RANGE: 0-50]

98..... Unsure
99..... Not applicable/Rather not say

a. **[INT37]** If you are not sure, please provide your best estimate of how many. How many different magazine subscriptions do members of your household receive online? [RANGE: 0-50]

98 . Unsure
99 . Not applicable/Rather not say

73. **[Q38]** How many different magazine subscriptions do members of your household receive through another method? [RANGE: 0-15]

98..... Unsure
99..... Not applicable/Rather not say

a. **[INT38]** If you are not sure, please provide your best estimate of how many. How many different magazine subscriptions do members of your household receive through another method? [RANGE: 0-15]

98 . Unsure
99 . Not applicable/Rather not say

74. **[Q40]** How many different newspaper subscriptions do members of your household receive through the U.S. Mail? [RANGE: 0-15]

98..... Unsure
99..... Not applicable/Rather not say

a. **[INT40]** If you are not sure, please provide your best estimate of how many. How many different newspaper subscriptions do members of your household receive through the U.S. Mail? [RANGE: 0-15]

98 . Unsure
99 . Not applicable/Rather not say

PROGRAMMER NOTE: SKIP Q41 IF (Q209 = 2 AND Q24=2,8,9) OR (Q209 = 8,9 AND Q23 = 8,9,10 AND Q24 = 2,8,9)

75. **[Q41]** How many different newspaper subscriptions do members of your household receive online? [RANGE: 0-32]

98..... Unsure
99..... Not applicable/Rather not say

a. **[INT41]** If you are not sure, please provide your best estimate of how many. How many different newspaper subscriptions do members of your household receive online? [RANGE: 0-32]

98 . Unsure
99 . Not applicable/Rather not say

76. **[Q42]** How many different newspaper subscriptions do members of your household receive through another method? [RANGE: 0-32]

98..... Unsure
99..... Not applicable/Rather not say

a. **[INT42]** If you are not sure, please provide your best estimate of how many. How many different newspaper subscriptions do members of your household receive through another method? [RANGE: 0-32]

98 . Unsure
99 . Not applicable/Rather not say

77. **[Q47]** When members of your household receive advertising material through the mail, do they . . .

1..... Usually read it
2..... Usually scan it
3..... Read some, don't read others
4..... Usually don't read it
8..... Unsure
9..... Not applicable/Rather not say

78. **[Q53]** In the last month, did anyone in your household respond to advertising, a catalog or other promotional material in the mail, including credit card solicitations?

1..... Yes
2..... No
8..... Unsure
9..... Not applicable/Rather not say

PROGRAMMER NOTE: SKIP Q222 IF (Q209 = 2 AND Q24=2,8,9) OR (Q209 = 8,9 AND Q23 = 8,9,10 AND Q24 = 2,8,9)

79. **[Q222]** How do you view the usefulness of advertising you receive through the mail compared to advertising you see on the internet, including via e-mail and on social media sites?

1 ... Mail advertising is more useful
2 ... Internet advertising is more useful
3 ... They are equally useful
4 ... Neither is useful
8 ... Unsure
9 ... Not applicable/Rather not say

80. **[Q223]** How do you view the usefulness of advertising you receive through the mail compared to advertising you see on television?

1 ... Mail advertising is more useful
2 ... Television advertising is more useful
3 ... They are equally useful
4 ... Neither is useful
8 ... Unsure
9... Not applicable/Rather not say

PROGRAMMER NOTE: SKIP Q224 IF (Q209 = 2 AND Q24=2,8,9) OR (Q209 = 8,9 AND Q23 = 8,9,10 AND Q24 = 2,8,9)

81. **[SCRP8]**We would like your opinion about political material you receive through the mail and through other media.

82. **[Q224]**How do you view the usefulness of political and election material you receive through the mail compared to political and election material you see on the internet, including via e-mail and on social media sites?

1 ... Political material in the mail is more useful
2 ... Political material on the internet is more useful
3 ... They are equally useful
4 ... Neither is useful
8 ... Unsure
9 ... Not applicable/Rather not say

83. **[Q225]** How do you view the usefulness of political and election material you receive through the mail compared to political and election material you see on television?

1 ... Political material in the mail is more useful
2 ... Political material on Television is more useful
3 ... They are equally useful
4 ... Neither is useful
8... Unsure
9... Not applicable/Rather not say

84. **[Q179]** How many coupons did you and/or members of your household use during the past month that were received through the mail?

[ENTER NUMBER, RANGE 0-100]

98 ..... Unsure

99 ..... Rather not say

a. **[INT179]** If you are not sure, please provide your best estimate of how many. How many coupons did you and/or members of your household use during the past month that were received through the mail? [ENTER NUMBER, RANGE 0-100]

98 Unsure
99 Rather not say

85. **[Q180]** [**SKIP IF (Q209 = 2 AND Q24=2,8,9) OR (Q209 = 8,9 AND Q23 = 8,9,10 AND Q24 = 2,8,9)**

How many coupons did you and/or members of your household use during the past month that were received online on your computer, cell phone, or other internet device?

[ENTER NUMBER RANGE 0-100]
98 ..... Unsure
99 ..... Rather not say

a. **[INT180]** [**SKIP IF (Q209 = 2 AND Q24=2,8,9) OR (Q209 = 8,9 AND Q23 = 8,9,10 AND Q24 = 2,8,9)**

If you are not sure, please provide your best estimate of how many. How many coupons did you and/or members of your household use during the past month that were received online on your computer, cell phone, or other internet device? [ENTER NUMBER RANGE 0-100]

98 Unsure
99 Rather not say

86. **[Q181]** During the past month, how many coupons did you and/or members of your household use that were received by another method – such as newspaper, magazine, door-hanger, or in-store promotion?

[ENTER NUMBER RANGE 0-100]

98 ..... Unsure
99 ..... Rather not say

a. **[INT181]** If you are not sure, please provide your best estimate of how many. During the past month, how many coupons did you and/or members of your household use that were received by another method – such as newspaper, magazine, door-hanger, or in-store promotion? [ENTER NUMBER RANGE 0-100]

98 Unsure
99 Rather not say

87. **[Q60]** The next set of questions are for classification purposes only. The answers allow us to compare your household to other households with similar characteristics. Including yourself, how many people live in your household? [RANGE 1-16]

01..... ONE => **GO TO AGE**
98..... Unsure
99..... Not applicable/Rather not say

88. **[Q65]** How many are 18 years of age or older? [RANGE 1-10]

98..... Unsure
99..... Not applicable/Rather not say

IF Q65 = Q60 BUT NOT 01 or 99, SKIP TO SCRP6

89. **[Q61]** How many of are under age 6? [RANGE 0-9]

98..... Unsure
99..... Not applicable/Rather not say

90. **[Q62]** How many are between the ages of 6 and 12? [RANGE 0-6]

98..... Unsure
99..... Not applicable/Rather not say

91. . **[Q63]** How many are between the ages of 13 and 17? [RANGE 0-5]

98..... Unsure
99..... Not applicable/Rather not say

92. **[SCRP6] ONLY SHOW SCRP6 IF Q65>1** The next questions concern the <Q65> [people/person] in your household, 18 years of age and older. Let's begin with you.

1..... CONTINUE

93. **[AGEO]** What is <your/their> age? [RANGE 18-110]

998 Unsure => GO TO AGE
999 Not applicable/Rather not say => GO TO AGE

Go to AGE if AGEO=998,999, otherwise skip to RESTG

a. [AGE] We understand if you do not want to provide an exact number. Please let us know what age range <YOUR> fall in. Are <YOUR> between...

01 18-21
02 22-24
03 25-34
04 35-44
05 45-54
06 55-64
07 65-69
08 70-74
09 75+
98 Unsure
99 Not applicable/Rather not say

FLAG HH AS YOUNG IF PERSON 1 = 1, 2, OR 3 or Ageo=18-34]

94. **[RESTG]** What is <your/their> gender?

1..... Male
2..... Female
8..... Unsure
9..... Not applicable/Rather not say

95. **[Q68]** What is <your/their> marital status?

1..... Married
2..... Living as married
3..... Single, never been married
4..... Divorced
5..... Separated
6..... Widowed
8..... Unsure
9..... Not applicable/Rather not say

96. **[Q69]** Are <you/they> currently . . .

1..... Employed full-time => GO TO Q79
2..... Employed part-time => GO TO Q79
3..... Retired, or
4..... Not employed
5 ……. Self-employed => GO TO Q79
8..... Unsure
9..... Not applicable/Rather not say

97. **[Q70]** Have <you/they> been employed within the last 12-months?

1..... Yes => GO TO Q79
2..... No IF Q69=3 AND Q70=2 SKIP TO Q79
8..... Unsure
9..... Not applicable/Rather not say

98. **[Q71]** Are <you/they> currently . . .

1..... A student => GO TO Q79
2..... A homemaker => GO TO Q79
3..... Disabled => GO TO Q79
4..... Temporarily laid off => GO TO Q79
5..... Retired => GO TO Q79
6..... Other, specify => GO TO Q79
8..... Unsure => GO TO Q79
9..... Not applicable/Rather not say => GO TO Q79

99. **[Q79]** What is the highest level of education <YOU/THEY> have obtained?

1..... 8th grade or less
2..... Some high school
3..... High school graduate

4..... Some college
5..... Technical school graduate
6..... College graduate
7..... Post graduate work
8..... Unsure
9..... Not applicable/Rather not say

100. **[Q81A]** Are <YOU> of Spanish/Hispanic/Latino origin?

1..... YES
2..... NO
8..... Unsure
9..... Not applicable/Rather not say

FLAG HH AS HISPANIC IF Q81A = 1 FOR PERSON 1

101. **[Q81B]** Which of the following do <you/they> consider <yourself/themselves> household member to be?

1..... White/Caucasian
2..... Black/African American
3..... Asian
4..... American Indian and Alaska Native
5..... Native Hawaiian and Other Pacific Islander
7..... Other, Specify
8..... Unsure
9..... Not applicable/Rather not say

102. **[Q82]** Would <you/they> say <you/they> are one of the heads of the household?

1..... Yes
2..... No
8..... Unsure
9..... Not applicable/Rather not say

[**END OF ROSTER – if more than 1 Adult, go back to RESTG]**

103. **[Q84]** For statistical purposes, was your total household income last year, before taxes and including all household members, above or below $50,000?

We understand if you feel uncomfortable answering this question. However, we only ask about income to ensure all households are equally represented in our survey. Your answer is completely confidential and only used as part of this research study in combination with other households across the country.

1..... Under $50,000 a year > **NQ85**
2..... Over $50,000 a year > **Q86**
8..... Unsure
9..... Not applicable/Rather not say

104. **[NQ85]** [IF UNDER $50K] And which income category best matches your household income...

05..... Under $24,999 a year
06..... $25,000 - $34,999 a year
07..... $35,000 - $49,999 a year
98..... Unsure
99 .....Not applicable/Rather not say

This more specific detail is used to analyze the data and will not be used for any purpose outside this study.

105. **[Q86]** [IF OVER $50K] And which income category best matches your household income...

08..... $50,000 - $64,999 a year
09..... $65,000 - $79,999 a year
10..... $80,000 - $99,999 a year
11..... $100,000 - $119,999 a year
12..... $120,000 - $149,999 a year
13..... $150,000 and over
98..... Unsure
99 Not applicable/Rather not say

This more specific detail is used to analyze the data and will not be used for any purpose outside this study.

[INCOME]: COMPUTED HH INCOME

106. **[Q87]** Do you own or rent your home?

1..... Own
2..... Rent
8..... Unsure
9..... Not applicable/Rather not say

107. **[Q88]** How long have you lived in your present home?

If you have lived there less than one year, please enter "0". [RANGE 0-80]

98..... Unsure
99..... Not applicable/Rather not say

108. **[Q89]** Which of the following best describes your home?

1..... Single family detached home
2..... Apartment or condominium
3..... Mobile home
6..... Duplex or townhouse
8..... Unsure
9..... Not applicable/Rather not say

109. **[CLPHL]** How many mobile or cell phones does your household have? RANGE 0-20

.....
98..... Unsure
99 Not applicable/Rather not say

110. **[PHNLNS]** Do you have a landline telephone in your household? Please do not include cell phones.

1 Yes

2 No

8 Unsure

9 Not applicable/Rather not say

[IF CLPHL <> 0 AND PHNLNS = 2 THEN FLAG AS CELL ONLY HH]

111. **[Q92]** Do you or any member of your household have a business that is operated from home?

1 .....Yes
2 .....No => GO TO Q97
8 .....Unsure => GO TO Q97
9 .....Not applicable/Rather not say => GO TO Q97

112. **[NQ92]** About how many packages does the business receive in an average week? RANGE 0-75

98 .....Unsure
99 .....Not applicable/Rather not say

a. **[INTN92]** If you are not sure, please provide your best estimate of how many. About how many packages does the business receive in an average week? RANGE 0-75

98..Unsure
99..Not applicable/Rather not say

113. **[Q93]** About how many pieces of mail does the business receive in an average week? RANGE 0-75

98 .....Unsure
99 .....Not applicable/Rather not say

a. **[INT93]** If you are not sure, please provide your best estimate. About how many pieces of mail does the business receive each week? RANGE 0-75 VERIFY RESPONSE IF ZERO

98..DK
99..RF

114. **[NQ93]** About how many packages does the business send in an average week? RANGE 0-75

98 .....Unsure
99 .....Not applicable/Rather not say

a. **[INT93]** If you are not sure, please provide your best estimate. About how many pieces of mail does the business receive each week? RANGE 0-75 VERIFY RESPONSE IF ZERO

98..DK
99..RF

115. **[Q94]** About how many pieces of mail does the business send in an average week? RANGE 0-75

98..... Unsure
99..... Not applicable/Rather not say

a. **[INT94]** If you are not sure, please provide your best estimate of how many. About how many pieces of mail does the business send each week? RANGE 0-75 VERIFY RESPONSE IF ZERO

98 . DK
99 . RF

116. **[SCRP7]** Remember, when you do your household diary, we are interested only in household mail and packages, so please do not include business related mail or business related packages in your diary. Click on the NEXT button to continue.

CONTINUE 1 DI

117. **[Q97]** There are just a few more questions.

What is the diary study all about? The second part of this study involves recording your household's mail by using daily diaries, which we will mail to you, OR by going online using a mobile device or computer. You will answer detailed questions about the mail and packages your household sends and receives for 7 days. You will receive your choice of either 100 Forever Stamps or a $40 check. You can expect your gift to arrive roughly 10 to 12 weeks after your information has been returned and/or submitted and processed.

How much time does it take? How long it takes depends on how much mail and **how many** packages you receive. The first day of your diary-recording week will take the longest as you become more familiar with the survey. After that, on average, it should only take about 3-5 minutes for each piece of mail **or package**. To help you, we have a USPS hotline available to provide you with step-by-step instructions if needed, and to answer any questions you may have. That toll free number is 1-888-441-8777. You may also want to check out the study web site at http://uspsmailsurvey.com/usps/.

Which method would you like to use to complete the second part of the study?
Send my diary packet by mail..... 1
I will provide my households mail information online..... 2
. I do not wish to participate in the second part of the study 9 => OLIST

118. **[GIFT]** Which gift would you like to receive for completing the diaries?

2..... 100 Forever Stamps
3..... Forty dollars

IF FLAGGED AS HISPANIC=1 OR YOUNG=1 THEN GO TO GIFT2:

119. [**GIFT2**] Your Household is eligible for an additional incentive for completing the diaries. Which additional gift would you like to receive for completing the diaries

4 $10 Amazon gift card
5 $10 Walmart gift card

120. [IF Q97=2] Next we want to confirm that you understand you will be answering detailed

questions about your household's mail and packages online during your assignment week, which is [recall assnw].

The website address and survey materials will be mailed to you in an instruction packet.

121. [IF Q97=1 (BY MAIL)[**DIARY**] Next, we want to confirm that you understand we'll be mailing you a set of household diaries that you'll complete during your assignment week, which is <ASSN>. In appreciation for completing those diaries, we will send you the gift you requested which takes about 10-12 weeks once we receive your completed diaries.

Continue

122. **[RESPF/RESPL]** So that we may mail the survey materials to you, please tell us your full name? We ask for your name to ensure proper delivery of your survey packet. **Please enter only the first and last name. Please do not enter middle initial, Mr. or Mrs.**

[RFNAM] First Name
[RLNAM] Last Name

NOTE: For processing purposes, it is important that we have only one first and one last name per household. Any additional information will delay processing.

[PROGRAMMING NOTE: RESPF AND RESPL ARE MOVED INTO RFNAM AND RLNAM]

123. **[MATRL]** Would you prefer your survey materials in English or Spanish?

1 .....English
2 .....Spanish

124. **[DIFPH]** A few days after we mail your survey materials, we want to call to make sure you've received them and also to remind you of the dates we need you to track your mail and packages.

125. **[OTHPH]** What is your home phone number? If you do not wish to give us your home phone number, you may enter another number where we might reach you or leave it blank

FORMAT 999-999-9999
[PROGRAMMER: ALLOW OTHPH TO BE LEFT BLANK ->EMAIL)
IF OTHPH PROVIDED, THEN SKIP TO INT99]

126. **[EMAIL] [IF OTHPH is left blank**] Since no phone was entered, maybe it would be easier for us to contact you via email to remind you about your diary dates. Please enter the email address you prefer we use (Example john@email.com): [PROGRAMMER NOTE: ALLOW EMAIL TO BE LEFT BLANK->PHONE1, IF EMAIL NOT BLANK -> INT99]

127. **[PHONE1] [IF EMAIL and OTHPH is left blank**] We understand not wanting to share personal information, like phone numbers and email addresses. It's important that we have a way to reach you to remind you about your diary tracking, and also to answer any questions you have about the study. All information collected in the Household Diary Study is confidential and we do not sell, rent, loan or in any way share personal information with anyone. Please provide the phone number or email address you prefer we use.

1 Provide Phone -> OTHPH
2 Provide email -> EMAIL
9 Will not provide -> INT99

128. **[INT99]** Thank you very much for your participation. The survey packet or instructions will be sent to the mailing address you verified at the beginning of the survey. Our toll free phone number is 1-888-441-8777. Please call us if you have any questions. We greatly appreciate your participation.

129. **[INT03]** Although you do not wish to continue with our survey, we appreciate the time you have given us today. Thank you and goodbye.

RF ..... Refused to do diaries => GO TO END

130. **[INT10]** Thank you very much for your time. I'm sorry if we inconvenienced you, but we need to attempt to contact the household currently using the other mailing address. For this survey, the USPS has randomly selected households based on their mailing address. If you have any questions, please call 1-888-441-8777. Have a nice evening/day.

QN……Not qualified due to address change => GO TO END

131. **[OLIST]** IF REFUSES TO PARTICIPATE In DIARY STUDY: If you participate in the survey, you will be eligible to receive 100 Forever Stamps or $40. Are you certain you do not wish to continue with the diary portion of the survey? Would you please tell us why you do not want to participate in our survey? OPEN END => INT03 code as RF

132. **[INTRO]** Welcome back to the U.S. Postal Service Survey. You began an interview concerning your household's mail and we would like you to complete the survey now.

2=CONTINUE WHERE I LEFT OFF

1=RESTART AT THE BEGINNING

133. **[INT]** ENTER FINAL DISPOSITION. "Thank you for your time, I'm sorry if we've inconvenienced you, but we have filled the quota for the region in which you live. For this survey, the USPS has randomly selected households based on their mailing address. If you have any questions, please call 1-888-441-8777. Have a nice evening/day." **OQ**

134. **[INT99]** SURVEY COMPLETE

CW…….WEB COMPLETE

Appendix C2: Diary Package - Advance Letter – Extra Incentive

UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE

May 20, 2022

«SAMPN»-«REPLICATE»
Postal Resident
«ADDRESS» «HSUIT»
«CITY», «STATE» «ZIP»
«BARSAMP»

The U.S. Postal Service is guided by one principle: we exist to serve our customers. This vision is our commitment to ensuring a vital Postal Service for future generations.

To assist us in meeting that commitment, your household, along with others in your area, has been selected to be included in our 34th annual Household Diary Study for 2021. This is a two-part study where we would like you to answer questions about your household's mail, and to record information about the mail your household sends and receives for a one-week period. Ultimately, your responses will help us make important decisions about performance improvements and investments in new equipment, facilities, programs, and technologies to better serve you.

We will make your participation as convenient as possible in being part of the Household Diary Study:



Online – This is the simplest and most convenient; you can complete the initial questionnaire about your household and the mail you send and receive any time you want by going to: **https://uspsmailsurvey.com/USPSWEB.htm** and enter **PIN #: «SAMPN».**



Phone – Within the next few days, we will call you to answer any questions you might have and conduct the initial interview, or make an appointment to do the interview when convenient to you.

All information collected is strictly confidential in order to protect your privacy.

The second part of the study involves recording information about your household's mail for one week. We will provide your household with diaries in which to record this information, along with easy-to-read instructions on how to complete them. Or you can record your mail information online.

As a thank you for your time and participation, once we have received your completed mail information, you will have a choice of ONE of the following:

- **Forty dollars**
- **100 First-Class stamps**

Your household may also have the opportunity to receive an <u>additional</u> incentive of your choice of either a $10 electronic Amazon.com gift card or a $10 electronic Wal-Mart gift card that will be sent to you upon receipt of your diary packet!

For any questions about the project or to give us the best phone number and time for reaching you, please visit **https://uspsmailsurvey.com/usps** anytime, or call our hotline at **1-888-441-8777** between 11am and 9pm Central Standard time Monday through Friday.

Thank you for joining us in the Household Diary Study!

Sincerely,

John F. Mazzone
Manager, USPS Household Diary Study

Voltee para Español →

475 L'Enfant Plaza SW
Washington DC 20260-0010

20 de mayo de 2022

Residente Postal
«ADDRESS» «HSUIT»
«CITY», «STATE» «ZIP» «SAMPN»-«REPLICATE»

El Servicio Postal de los Estados Unidos se conduce bajo un principio: existimos para servir a nuestros clientes. Esta visión es nuestro compromiso para asegurar un Servicio Postal vital para las futuras generaciones.

Para ayudarnos a alcanzar este compromiso, estamos realizando nuestro 34ª Estudio Domiciliario en Diarios anual. Este es un estudio de dos partes donde quisiéramos que respondieran preguntas sobre el correo de su hogar, y para registrar información sobre el correo que su hogar envía y recibe por un period de una semana. Esta es la razón por la cual su hogar, junto con otros en su área, fue seleccionado para responder preguntas acerca del correo de su hogar y registrar la información acerca de la correspondencia enviada y recibida por su hogar en un período de una semana.

Le proporcionaremos a su hogar unos diarios postales en los cuales podrá registrar esta información, junto con instrucciones de fácil lectura acerca de cómo completarlos. Esta información nos ayudará a entender mejor tendencias actuales en el volumen y tipos de correo que los hogares manejan de forma diaria. Por último, su respuesta nos ayudará a tomar decisiones importantes acerca de mejoras en nuestro desempeño e inversiones en nuevos equipos, instalaciones, programas y tecnologías para servirle mejor.

Como muestra de agradecimiento por su tiempo y participación, una vez que hayamos recibido su información acerca de su correo completado, usted tendrá la opción de recibir <u>uno</u> de los siguientes:

- **Cuarenta dólares**
- **100 Estampillas de primera clase (First-Class)**

Su hogar tambíen puede tener la oportunidad para recibir un incentive adicional de su elección de una tarjeta de regalo electronica de $10 de Amazon.com o una tajeta de relago electronica de $10 de Wal-Mart que se le enviará al recibir sus diarios completados.

Haremos todo lo posible para que su participación se realice de la manera más conveniente para usted. Tiene usted dos opciones para ser parte del Estudio Domiciliario en Diarios:



Internet – Participar por Internet es la opción más fácil y conveniente. En cualquier momento, usted puede completar la primera parte del estudio en la que se le hacen preguntas sobre su hogar y el correo que envía y recibe. Sólo visite **https://uspsmailsurvey.com/usps/spanish** e ingrese el **número de PIN: «SAMPN»**.



Teléfono – Dentro de los próximos días, le llamaremos para contestar cualquier pregunta que tenga e iniciar la primera parte del estudio o programar una hora que sea conveniente para usted.

Toda la información recopilada es estrictamente confidencial para proteger su privacidad.

Si tiene cualquier pregunta sobre el estudio o desea proporcionarnos un número telefónico y la hora más conveniente para comunicarnos con usted, por favor visite **https://uspsmailsurvey.com/usps/study_info-spanish.htm** en cualquier momento, o llame gratis a nuestra línea de asistencia del proyecto al **1-888-441-8777** de lunes a viernes de 11am a 9pm hora central.

¡Agradecemos su participación en el Estudio Domiciliario en Diarios!

Atentamente,

John F. Mazzone
Director, Estudio Domiciliario en Diarios de USPS

Appendix C2: Diary Package - Advance Letter

UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE

May 20, 2022

«SAMPN»-«REPLICATE»
Postal Resident
«ADDRESS» «HSUIT»
«CITY», «STATE» «ZIP»
«BARSAMP»

The U.S. Postal Service is guided by one principle: we exist to serve our customers. This vision is our commitment to ensuring a vital Postal Service for future generations.

To assist us in meeting that commitment, your household, along with others in your area, has been selected to be included in our 34th annual Household Diary Study for 2021. This is a two-part study where we would like you to answer questions about your household's mail, and to record information about the mail your household sends and receives for a one-week period. Ultimately, your responses will help us make important decisions about performance improvements and investments in new equipment, facilities, programs, and technologies to better serve you.

We will make your participation as convenient as possible in being part of the Household Diary Study:



Online – This is the simplest and most convenient; you can complete the initial questionnaire about your household and the mail you send and receive any time you want by going to: **https://uspsmailsurvey.com/USPSWEB.htm** and enter **PIN #: «SAMPN».**



Phone – Within the next few days, we will call you to answer any questions you might have and conduct the initial interview, or make an appointment to do the interview when convenient to you.

All information collected is strictly confidential in order to protect your privacy.

The second part of the study involves recording information about your household's mail for one week. We will provide your household with diaries in which to record this information, along with easy-to-read instructions on how to complete them. Or you can record your mail information online.

As a thank you for your time and participation, once we have received your completed mail information, you will have a choice of ONE of the following:

- **Forty dollars**
- **100 First-Class stamps**

For any questions about the project or to give us the best phone number and time for reaching you, please visit **https://uspsmailsurvey.com/usps** anytime, or call our hotline at **1-888-441-8777** between 11am and 9pm Central Standard time Monday through Friday.

Thank you for joining us in the Household Diary Study!

Sincerely,

John F. Mazzone
Manager, USPS Household Diary Study

Voltee para Español →

475 L'Enfant Plaza SW
Washington DC 20260-0010

20 de mayo de 2022

Residente Postal
«ADDRESS» «HSUIT»
«CITY», «STATE» «ZIP» «SAMPN»-«REPLICATE»

El Servicio Postal de los Estados Unidos se conduce bajo un principio: existimos para servir a nuestros clientes. Esta visión es nuestro compromiso para asegurar un Servicio Postal vital para las futuras generaciones.

Para ayudarnos a alcanzar este compromiso, estamos realizando nuestro 34ª Estudio Domiciliario en Diarios anual. Este es un estudio de dos partes donde quisiéramos que respondieran preguntas sobre el correo de su hogar, y para registrar información sobre el correo que su hogar envía y recibe por un period de una semana. Esta es la razón por la cual su hogar, junto con otros en su área, fue seleccionado para responder preguntas acerca del correo de su hogar y registrar la información acerca de la correspondencia enviada y recibida por su hogar en un período de una semana.

Le proporcionaremos a su hogar unos diarios postales en los cuales podrá registrar esta información, junto con instrucciones de fácil lectura acerca de cómo completarlos. Esta información nos ayudará a entender mejor tendencias actuales en el volumen y tipos de correo que los hogares manejan de forma diaria. Por último, su respuesta nos ayudará a tomar decisiones importantes acerca de mejoras en nuestro desempeño e inversiones en nuevos equipos, instalaciones, programas y tecnologías para servirle mejor.

Como muestra de agradecimiento por su tiempo y participación, una vez que hayamos recibido su información acerca de su correo completado, usted tendrá la opción de recibir <u>uno</u> de los siguientes:

- **Cuarenta dólares**
- **100 Estampillas de primera clase (First-Class)**

Haremos todo lo posible para que su participación se realice de la manera más conveniente para usted. Tiene usted dos opciones para ser parte del Estudio Domiciliario en Diarios:



Internet – Participar por Internet es la opción más fácil y conveniente. En cualquier momento, usted puede completar la primera parte del estudio en la que se le hacen preguntas sobre su hogar y el correo que envía y recibe. Sólo visite **https://uspsmailsurvey.com/usps/spanish** e ingrese el **número de PIN: «SAMPN»**.



Teléfono – Dentro de los próximos días, le llamaremos para contestar cualquier pregunta que tenga e iniciar la primera parte del estudio o programar una hora que sea conveniente para usted.

Toda la información recopilada es estrictamente confidencial para proteger su privacidad.

Si tiene cualquier pregunta sobre el estudio o desea proporcionarnos un número telefónico y la hora más conveniente para comunicarnos con usted, por favor visite **https://uspsmailsurvey.com/usps/study_info-spanish.htm** en cualquier momento, o llame gratis a nuestra línea de asistencia del proyecto al **1-888-441-8777** de lunes a viernes de 11 am a 5pm hora central.

¡Agradecemos su participación en el Estudio Domiciliario en Diarios!

Atentamente,

John F. Mazzone
Director, Estudio Domiciliario en Diarios de USPS

Appendix C2: Paper Diary– Diary Package Cover Letter

USPS Household Diary Study

Dear «LASTNAME» Family,

What is the Household Diary Study?

The Household Diary Study is a national research effort sponsored by the U.S. Postal Service. The information collected from households like yours will be used to help us design systems to use our resources most effectively, develop strategies for making wise decisions, and monitor the effects of electronic technology on regular mail service. Ultimately, the data will help us find ways of keeping the cost of service at a minimum.

The study is conducted on our behalf by NuStats, a professional research firm in Buda, Texas. NuStats ensures all information collected is strictly confidential and is used for our research purposes only. The information from your household will be used only in combination with data from other participating households.

What are we asking of you?

Answer questions about all the mail and packages your household receives and sends for seven days. We are only interested in the mail you send and receive for the week of **«TDAYS».**

There two ways to participate: (Please choose ONE way to enter in your mail information.)

- **You can enter your information in this package that is provided for you**. *(Each item is numbered in the top right-hand corner.)*
  - **Read Steps 1-7 in the Instruction Booklet** *(1)* **first** – this is important because it explains how to correctly fill out the Answer Booklets and provides visual examples.
  - **Review the Photo Quick Start** *(2)*.
  - **Answer questions from the Question Booklet** *(3)* **by recording the codes in the Answer Booklets**. Do this for all the mail and packages your household receives and sends each day.
  - **Return all completed Answer Booklets** *(4a-4g)* **in the Daily Envelopes** *(5a-5g)*, **Mail Pieces, and the Gift Selection Form** *(6)*, **stated on the "I'm done…." Postcard** *(7)*, **in the postage-paid Priority Mail envelope** *(8)* – drop in any public U.S. Postal Service mailbox or post office.

- **Or you can go online (by mobile device or computer) at:**
  - **https://uspshhdiary.com** and enter in the pin number to get started. ***(Internet Explorer is not supported for our survey. Please use another internet browser.)***
  - If you have any questions regarding the diaries or the study, you can visit the **USPS Diary Study** survey Website at: **https://uspsmailsurvey.com/usps**.
  - ***Place your Mail Pieces in the Daily Envelopes*** *(5)* **with the Gift Selection Form** *(6)* **and return using the postage-paid Priority Mail envelope** *(8) and drop in any public U.S. Postal Service mailbox or post office.*

If you have any questions about how to complete the survey, call the USPS Hotline at **1-888-441-USPS (8777)** available 11am-9pm CST (Monday-Friday). You can also email us at: **hotline-usps@nustats.com.**

I would like to thank you again for your participation and willingness to do the research that will help us improve our performance at your local post office.

Sincerely,

John F. Mazzone

John F. Mazzone
Manager, USPS Household Diary Study
(Please allow 10-12 weeks for processing of your gift.)

UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE®

Appendix C2: Web Diary – Diary Package Cover Letter

USPS Household Diary Study

Dear «LASTNAME» Family,

What is the Household Diary Study?

The Household Diary Study is a national research effort sponsored by the U.S. Postal Service. The information collected from households like yours will be used to help us design systems to use our resources most effectively, develop strategies for making wise decisions, and monitor the effects of electronic technology on regular mail service. Ultimately, the data will help us find ways of keeping the cost of service at a minimum.

The study is conducted on our behalf by NuStats, a professional research firm in Buda, Texas. NuStats ensures all information collected is strictly confidential and is used for our research purposes only. The information from your household will be used only in combination with data from other participating households.

What are we asking of you?

Answer questions about all the mail and packages your household receives and sends for seven days. We are only interested in the mail you send and receive for the week of **«TDAYS»**.

- **You have chosen to complete your diaries online (by mobile or computer). Please log in to:**
  - **https://uspshhdiary.com** and enter in the pin number **«SAMPN»** to get started.
  - **For instructions and details on how to begin please visit the Survey Website: https://uspsmailsurvey.com/usps**. This is an important step to learn about reporting your mail.
  - **Place your Mail Pieces in the Daily Envelopes** *(5)* **and return using the postage-paid Priority Mail envelope** *(8)* and drop in any public U.S. Postal Service mailbox or post office.

If you have any questions regarding the study or how to complete the survey, call the USPS Hotline at **1-888-441-USPS (8777)** available 11am-9pm CST (Monday-Friday). You can also visit the **USPS Diary Study** survey Website at: https://uspsmailsurvey.com/usps or email us at: hotline-usps@nustats.com.

I would like to thank you again for your participation and willingness to do the research that will help us improve our performance.

Sincerely,

John F. Mazzone
Manager, USPS Household Diary Study
(Please allow 10-12 weeks for processing of your gift.)

UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE®

Appendix C2: Diary Package – Instruction Booklet

UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE.

1

Instruction Booklet

PLEASE READ THIS FIRST!

Includes instructions for completing the Answer Booklets and examples of postage and mail markings for each type of mail, behind the color-coded tabs

Common Terms & Questions

Here are definitions of some of the terms that we use throughout the Household Diary materials and the most frequently asked question.

Common Terms

- **Mail Pieces** are the different pieces of mail that you receive and send – letters, bills, postcards, magazines, advertisements, packages, etc.
- **Mail Type** is the category of mail that we ask you to sort your mail into. *(See the list of 6 mail types on page 1 of this booklet.)*
- **Postage** is how the piece of mail was paid for when it was sent. There are three different types of postage: Stamps, Meter, or Permit. *(See the visual examples under the color-coded tabs for each mail type.)*
- **Mail Markings** are markings that are printed on a mail piece either by the U.S. Postal Service or the mailing house. These markings indicate the postage paid and the type of mail. The Postage and Mail Markings are typically located in:
  a) the top right-hand corner of the mail piece,
  b) above or below the address, or
  c) inside the window of an envelope.

What is the difference between First-Class Mail and Presorted Standard or Marketing Mail?

These are the two most common mail types. Here are some ways to help distinguish between them:

- **First-Class Mail** has a variety of markings. Pieces are often marked 'First-Class' or 'Presorted First-Class,' especially when they don't have stamps. Most mail with a stamp, such as a Forever Stamp, is First-Class. Include mail with a stamp in First-Class unless it is marked 'Presorted Standard' or 'Nonprofit.'
  (See pages 5-8 in this booklet for descriptions & more visual examples.)

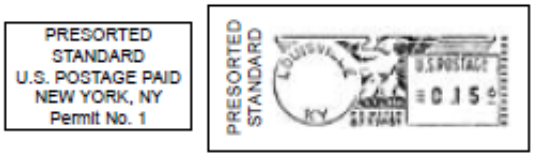
- **Presorted Standard or Marketing** Mail pieces are always marked "Presorted Standard," or "PRSRT STD," or "Standard," or "STD," or "MKTG," or "PRST MKTG" usually in the upper-right corner of the mail pieces close to the stamp or meter strip. *(See pages 9-13 in this booklet for descriptions & more visual examples.)*

Examples

Presorted First-Class Mail Markings



Presorted Standard or Marketing Mail Markings



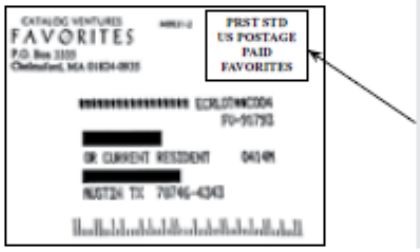
How to fill out the Answer Booklets.

1 Sort your daily mail into groups by mail type.

The first step is to sort your mail each day into groups of mail types by looking at the postage and other markings on your mail (we call these "mail markings"). All the mail you receive can be classified as one of the following 6 types*:

1. **First-Class / Presorted First-Class Mail** (Purple pages)
2. **Presorted Standard or Marketing Mail (PRSRT STD or PRSRT MKTG)** (Blue pages)
3. **Nonprofit Organization Mail** (Gray pages)
4. **Packages & Expedited Materials** (Green pages)
5. **Magazines, Newspapers, or Other Periodicals** (Yellow pages)
6. **Unaddressed Mail** – Delivered by US Postal Service only (Pink pages)

To Sort: Look at the Postage & Mail Markings



Postage & Mail Markings can be located in the top right-hand corner of your mail piece.

*To help you sort your mail, see the examples of postage and mail markings under the colored tab associated with each mail type.

We are only interested in your household mail and packages:

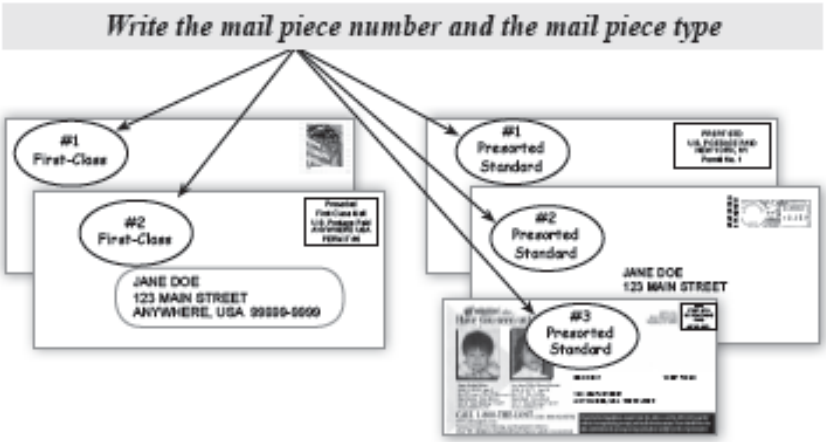
- Please DO include household mail or packages that you send or receive at another location, for instance at work.
- DO NOT include any mail sent to your PO Box.
- Please DO NOT include any mail received or sent for a business, club, or association operated from your home.

Special Circumstances

- If you did not receive or send any mail or packages, or if there was no mail service one day during your assigned week, put an "X" in the box labeled "Did Not Receive or Send any Mail/Packages Today" on page 1 of the Answer Booklet for that day.
- If household members will be away from home on any day(s) during the diary week, record all mail received in the daily answer booklet for the day on which you return.
- If you forget to pick up your mail for a day, record all mail received on the next day.
- You may not receive mail on Sunday, but you may receive packages and/or send mail out.

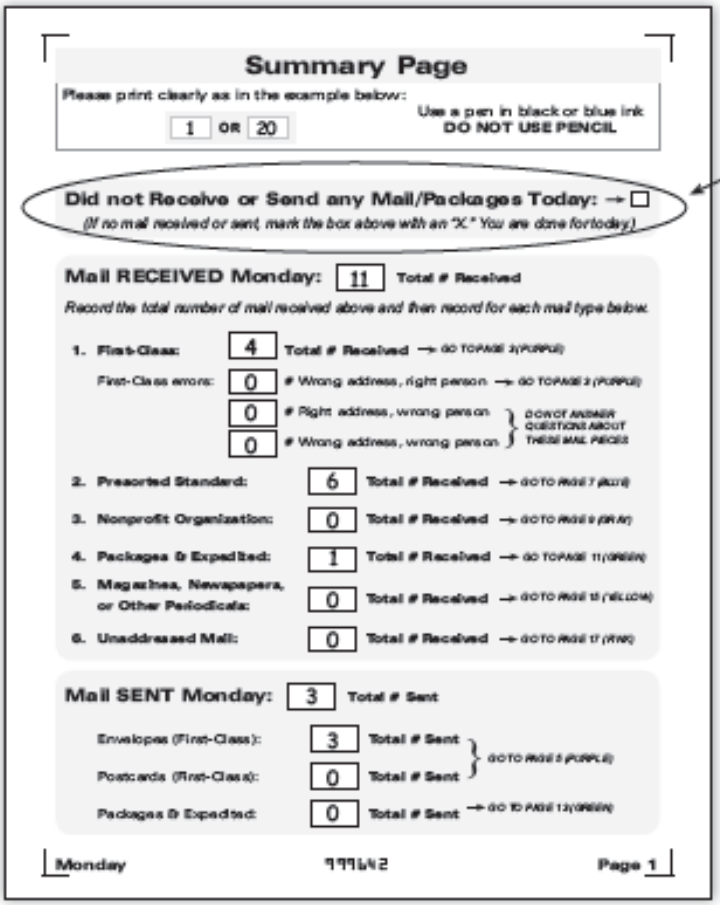
2 Number and label the mail pieces within each mail type.

Once your mail is sorted for that day, write the mail type on each piece of mail and then number the mail pieces within each mail type. For example, the top First-Class mail piece is #1, the next is #2, and so on until you have numbered all First-Class Mail for that day. Next, number all the other types of mail (Presorted Standard, Nonprofit, Packages, etc.) beginning again with #1, and then #2, and so on for each different mail type.



3 Complete the Summary Page (page 1) in the Answer Booklet for each day.

On this page, record the total number of mail pieces of each type that all members of your household received and sent that day. *(See Summary Page example below.)*



Summary Page

Please print clearly as in the example below: 1 OR 20 — Use a pen in black or blue ink. DO NOT USE PENCIL

Did not Receive or Send any Mail/Packages Today: → ☐
(If no mail received or sent, mark the box above with an "X." You are done for today.)

Mail RECEIVED Monday: 11 **Total # Received**

Record the total number of mail received above and then record for each mail type below.

1. **First-Class:** 4 **Total # Received** → GO TO PAGE 3 (PURPLE)
   First-Class errors: 0 # Wrong address, right person → GO TO PAGE 3 (PURPLE)
   0 # Right address, wrong person
   0 # Wrong address, wrong person
   } DO NOT ANSWER QUESTIONS ABOUT THESE MAIL PIECES
2. **Presorted Standard:** 6 **Total # Received** → GO TO PAGE 7 (BLUE)
3. **Nonprofit Organization:** 0 **Total # Received** → GO TO PAGE 9 (GRAY)
4. **Packages & Expedited:** 1 **Total # Received** → GO TO PAGE 11 (GREEN)
5. **Magazines, Newspapers, or Other Periodicals:** 0 **Total # Received** → GO TO PAGE 15 (YELLOW)
6. **Unaddressed Mail:** 0 **Total # Received** → GO TO PAGE 17 (PINK)

Mail SENT Monday: 3 **Total # Sent**

Envelopes (First-Class): 3 **Total # Sent**
Postcards (First-Class): 0 **Total # Sent**
} GO TO PAGE 5 (PURPLE)
Packages & Expedited: 0 **Total # Sent** → GO TO PAGE 13 (GREEN)

Monday 99962 Page 1

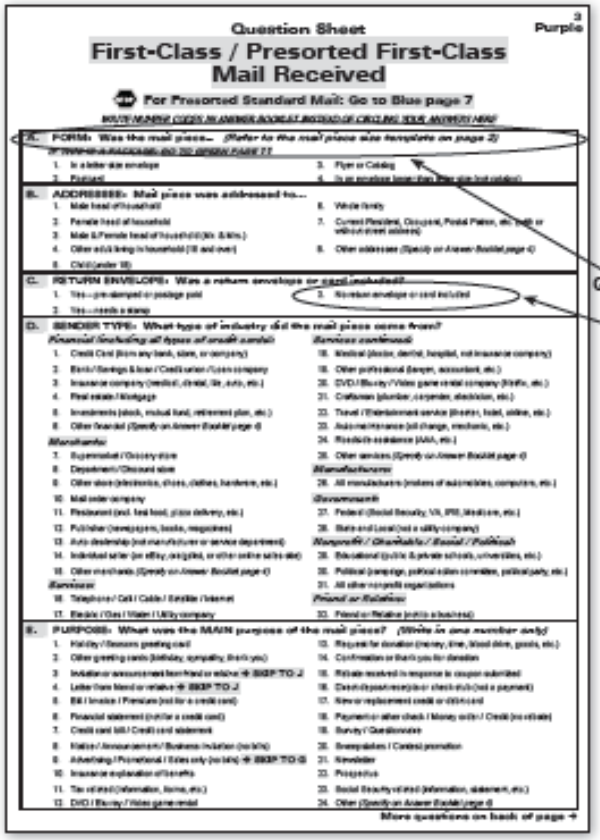
If you did not receive or send any mail or packages, or if there was no mail service one day during your assigned week:
Put an "X" in the box labeled "Did not Receive or Send any Mail/Packages Today" on the summary page for that day.

4 Open both the Question Booklet and the Answer Booklet for that day to the colored pages for the type of mail piece you have.

You will use a different Answer Booklet for each day of the week, but you use the same Question Booklet each day. Read the questions from the Question sheet (in the Question Booklet) and find the correct answers (number codes), then write them on the Answer sheet in the Answer Booklet. There are colored pages for each mail type: First-Class Mail is purple, Presorted Standard or Marketing Mail is blue, etc. You can record up to 12 mail pieces for each mail type. **Remember, the postage on the mail piece determines which colored Question and Answer sheets to use.**

1. In the Answer Booklet for that day, write in the answer on the Answer Sheet using the correct number code found in the Question Booklet.
2. Starting with mail piece #1, Question A, write the codes under column #1. Using the Question Booklet, continue down the page to Question B.
3. After you are finished answering questions for mail piece #1, continue on to the questions for mail piece #2 in column #2. Continue in this way for each mail piece within each type.

Question Sheet (in Question Booklet)


Question Sheet

Purple

First-Class / Presorted First-Class Mail Received

For Presorted Standard Mail: Go to Blue page 7

A. FORM: Was the mail piece... (Refer to the mail piece size template on page 2)

1. In a letter size envelope
2. Flat-size
3. Flyer or Catalog
4. In an envelope larger than letter size (not oblong)

B. ADDRESSED: Mail piece was addressed to...

1. Male head of household
2. Female head of household
3. Male &/Female head of household (Mr. & Mrs.)
4. Other adult living in household (18 and over)
5. Child (under 18)
6. Whole family
7. Current Resident, Occupant, Postal Patron, etc. (with or without street address)
8. Other addressee (Specify on Answer Booklet page 4)

C. RETURN ENVELOPE: Was a return envelope or card included?

1. Yes – pre-stamped or postage paid
2. Yes – needs a stamp
3. No return envelope or card included

D. SENDER TYPE: What type of industry did the mail piece come from?

Financial (including all types of credit cards)

1. Credit Card (from any bank, store, or company)
2. Bank / Savings & loan / Credit union / Loan company
3. Insurance company (medical, dental, life, auto, etc.)
4. Real estate / Mortgage
5. Investments (stock, mutual fund, retirement plan, etc.)
6. Other financial (Specify on Answer Booklet page 4)

Merchandise

7. Supermarket / Grocery store
8. Department / Discount store
9. Other store (electronics, shoes, clothes, hardware, etc.)
10. Mail order company
11. Restaurant (incl. fast food, pizza delivery, etc.)
12. Publisher (newspapers, books, magazines)
13. Auto dealership (not manufacturer or service department)
14. Individual seller (ex eBay, craigslist, or other online sales site)
15. Other merchants (Specify on Answer Booklet page 4)

Services

16. Telephone / Cell / Cable / Satellite / Internet
17. Electric / Gas / Water / Utility company

Services continued

18. Medical (doctor, dentist, hospital, not insurance company)
19. Other professional (lawyer, accountant, etc.)
20. DVD / Blu-ray / Video game rental company (Netflix, etc.)
21. Craftsman (plumber, carpenter, electrician, etc.)
22. Travel / Entertainment service (theater, hotel, airline, etc.)
23. Auto maintenance (oil change, mechanic, etc.)
24. Roadside assistance (AAA, etc.)
25. Other services (Specify on Answer Booklet page 4)

Manufacturers

26. All manufacturers (makers of automobiles, computers, etc.)

Government

27. Federal (Social Security, VA, IRS, Medicare, etc.)
28. State and Local (not a utility company)

Nonprofit / Charitable / Social / Political

29. Educational (public & private schools, universities, etc.)
30. Political (campaign, political action committee, political party, etc.)
31. All other nonprofit organizations

Friend or Relative

32. Friend or Relative (not in a business)

E. PURPOSE: What was the MAIN purpose of the mail piece? (Write in one number only)

1. Holiday / Seasons greeting card
2. Other greeting cards (birthday, sympathy, thank you)
3. Invitation or announcement from friend or relative → SKIP TO J
4. Letter from friend or relative → SKIP TO J
5. Bill / Invoice / Premium (not for a credit card)
6. Financial statement (not for a credit card)
7. Credit card bill / Credit card statement
8. Notice / Announcement / Business invitation (no bills)
9. Advertising / Promotional / Sales only (no bills) → SKIP TO G
10. Insurance explanation of benefits
11. Tax or bill (information, forms, etc.)
12. DVD / Blu-ray / Video game rental
13. Request for donation (money, time, blood drive, goods, etc.)
14. Confirmation or thank you for donation
15. Rebate received in response to coupon submitted
16. Check (payment/proof or check stub (not a payment))
17. New or replacement credit or debit card
18. Payment or other check / Money order / Credit (no rebate)
19. Survey / Questionnaire
20. Sweepstakes / Contest promotion
21. Newsletter
22. Prospectus
23. Social Security or bill (information, statement, etc.)
24. Other (Specify on Answer Booklet page 4)

More questions on back of page →

Answer Sheet (in Answer Booklet)

Mail Piece #1

Mail Piece #2

Question

Code

Answer Sheet

Purple

First-Class / Presorted First-Class Mail Received

Answer questions about each mail piece down the columns. There are columns for up to 12 pieces of mail.

Questions are in the Question Booklet.	Mail Piece #1	Mail Piece #2	Mail Piece #3	Mail Piece #4	Mail Piece #5	Mail Piece #6	Mail Piece #7	Mail Piece #8	Mail Piece #9	Mail Piece #10	Mail Piece #11	Mail Piece #12
A. FORM	2	1	2	1	1							
B. ADDRESSEE	1	2	1	3	3							
C. RETURN ENVELOPE	3	3	3	2	3							
D. SENDER TYPE	10	32	16	1	27							
E. PURPOSE	9	4	9	7	6							
F. ADVERTISING				1	2							
G. READING	2		1	3								
H. REACTION	3		1	1								
I. RESPONSE	2		1	3								
J. CLASS OK to choose up to 4 codes. (Example/example 2)	1	3	2	1	1	9						
	4		5	4	4							

Monday 87771¼ Page 3

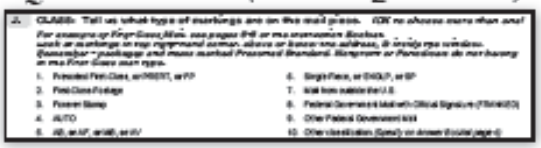
For questions where it is "OK to choose more than one," you can record up to four codes.

Mail Markings are important.

Tell us which mail markings are on the mail piece by answering the "Class" question at the end of each Question sheet (e.g., Question J for First-Class Mail).

To accurately answer this question, you need to record all the mail markings that are on each mail piece – these markings are placed on the mail piece either by the U.S. Postal Service or by a mailing house.

Question J - Class (First-Class Question sheet)



5 Please send us your mail pieces.

We only need the envelope your mail came in, not the contents (unless it's something you don't need).
Please DO NOT CUT OUT the individual mail markings.

- **Remember to label each mail piece with the number and mail type you assigned it in the Answer Booklet** so we are able to match it to your responses.
- **If the mail piece is a catalog, magazine, flyer, or newspaper, just send the page with the mailing label and the postage.** We don't need the entire catalog or newspaper, etc.

Why do we need your mail pieces?

If we have your mail markings for each piece, we can double check that everything is correct. Each packet goes through an editing process that verifies that the mail pieces were recorded under the correct mail type (First-Class, Presorted Standard or Marketing Mail, etc.) and that all the questions were answered. The entire mail piece (i.e., the envelope) provides us with additional survey information, such as sender type.

All information collected is strictly confidential and is used for research purposes only.

6 Place your completed Answer Booklets and mail pieces in the envelopes marked Monday through Sunday.

Your completed Answer Booklets and mail pieces labeled with the mail type and mail piece number should be placed in the corresponding daily envelope.

7 Place the daily envelopes in the postage-paid Priority Mail envelope.

The daily envelopes with your completed Answer Booklets and mail pieces should be sent to NuStats in the postage-paid Priority Mail envelope.

First-Class / Presorted First-Class Mail Received and Sent (Purple)

All First-Class Mail may not say "First-Class" on the envelope or postcard. It is important to look at the postage and mail markings on each mail piece to determine if it is First-Class or not. Use the following to help you determine if your mail piece should be recorded under this type:

- Include letter size envelopes marked "**First-Class**" or "**Presorted First-Class**."
- Include large envelopes marked "**First-Class**." Check the mail markings carefully; some large envelopes may be marked Presorted Standard or Expedited.
- Most First-Class Mail from businesses are marked "**First-Class**" or "**Presorted First-Class,**" especially when they have a metered strip and NOT a stamp.
- Most mail with a stamp is First-Class. Include mail with a stamp in First-Class unless it is marked 'Presorted Standard' or 'Nonprofit.'
- Most letter size envelopes will have a "**Forever Stamp**" or a metered strip. Some postage may also be in the form of a stamp with a specific price. If it is "**Presorted First-Class,**" it may have less postage but it will be marked as "**Presorted First-Class**."
- Some postcards are larger in size than a typical scenic postcard. However, if it is larger than the postcard dimensions (see page 2 of the Question Booklet), then it is considered a flyer.
- Include magazines, catalogs, newsletters, or other periodicals that are marked "**First-Class**."

Examples of First-Class Mail postage and markings begin on the next page.

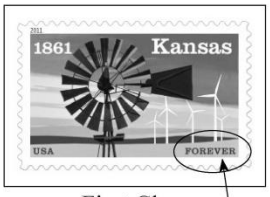
First-Class Mail Examples

Note: Examples may not reflect most recent postage prices as they change frequently

First-Class or Forever Stamp

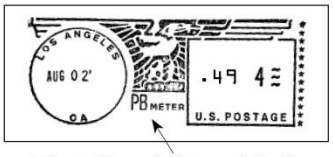


First-Class Stamp with Price (not Forever)



First-Class Forever Stamp

Look for "Forever" somewhere on the stamp.



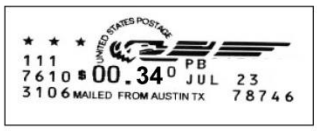
First-Class Metered Strip



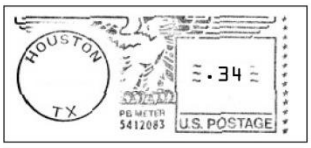
First-Class Permit



First-Class Postcard Stamp

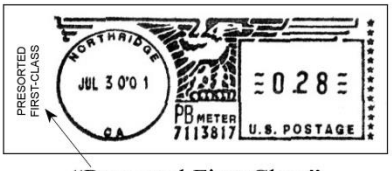


Metered Postcard

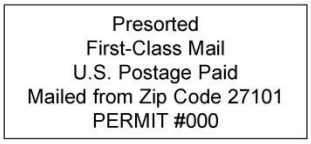


Metered Postcard

Presorted First-Class, PRSRT, or FP



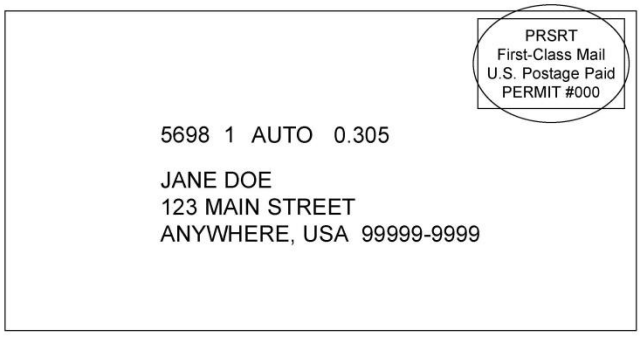
"Presorted First-Class" Metered Strip



"Presorted First-Class" Permit



"Presorted First-Class" Stamp

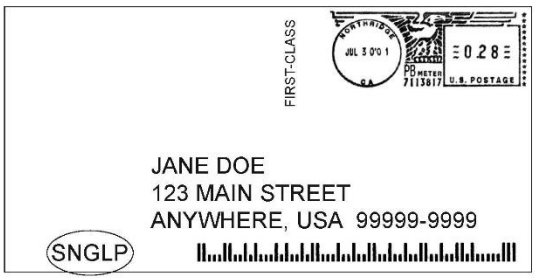


Look for "Presorted First-Class" on a Permit, a Stamp, or a Metered Strip

Hint: Find closest match

First-Class Mail Examples

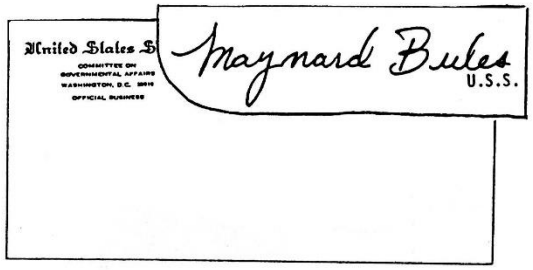
Single Piece, SP, SNGLP



Mail from outside the U.S.



Federal Government Mail (Franked)



"Official Government Signature" (Franked)

Other Federal Government Mail



Marked "Official Mail" or Government Permit Number

Note: Many additional mail markings may appear above or below the address, inside the window of an envelope, or near the postage on a mail piece.

Hint: Find closest match

Presorted Standard or Marketing Mail (Blue)

Use the following to help you determine if your mail piece should be recorded under this type:

- Include mail that is marked "**Presorted Standard**," or "**PRSRT STD**," or "**Standard**," or "**STD,**" or "**MKTG**," or "**PRST MKTG**" whether it is a letter, postcard, large envelope, magazine, catalog, circular, or flyer, etc.
- Most **catalogs** are sent Presorted Standard. However, check to make sure it is marked "Presorted Standard," or "PRSRT STD," or "Standard," or "STD," or "MKTG," or "PRST MKTG." Catalogs that are in envelopes marked "Bound Printed Matter" or items marked "Media Mail" or "Library Mail" should be recorded under "Packages & Expedited Materials" (Green pages).

Advertising often comes as a group of flyers, circulars, coupons, or other pieces that are not in an envelope.* These types of advertisements can be delivered in two different ways:

1. Your address may be printed on a **detached label card** that is delivered with separate advertising pieces that are grouped or folded together.

   If you get a detached label card, please record it under "**Presorted Standard or Marketing Mail**," and then record the group of advertising pieces as **ONE** mail piece (regardless of how many flyers or circulars, etc.) under "**Unaddressed Mail**" on the Pink pages.



2. Your address may be printed directly on the group of advertising pieces.

   Please record the whole group as **ONE** mail piece under "**Presorted Standard or Marketing Mail**." Record code #7 for Question B and code #2 for Question C.



*Usually from more than one company or advertiser

Examples of Presorted Standard or Marketing mail markings begin on the next page.

Presorted Standard or Marketing Mail Examples

Presorted Standard, or PRSRT STD, or Marketing, or MKTG



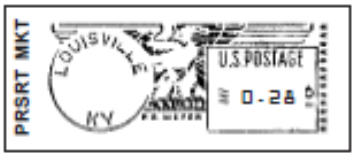
"Presorted Standard"
on Metered Strip



"PRSRT STD"
on Metered Strip



"Standard"
on Metered Strip



"PRSRT MKT"
on Metered Strip



"Presorted Std"
on Stamp

PRESORTED STANDARD
U.S. POSTAGE PAID
NEW YORK, NY
Permit No. 1

"Presorted Standard"
on Permit

PRSRT STD
U.S. POSTAGE
PAID
NEW YORK, NY
Permit No. 1

"PRSRT STD"
on Permit

PRESORTED MKTG
U.S. POSTAGE PAID
NEW YORK, NY
Permit No. 1

"PRESORTED MKTG"
on Permit

PRSRT MKT
U.S. POSTAGE
PAID
NEW YORK, NY
Permit No. 1

"PRSRT MKT"
on Permit

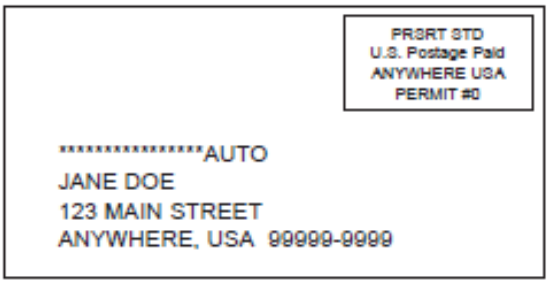
Hint: Find closest match

Presorted Standard or Marketing Mail Examples

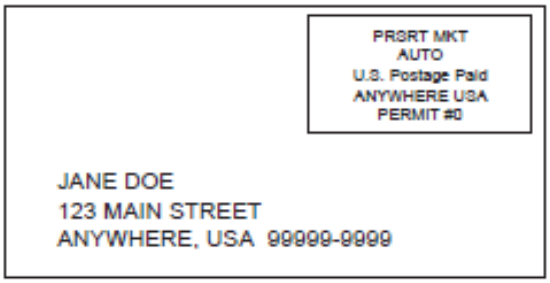
Note: Many of the markings may appear with any of the permit types (i.e., AUTO may appear with a Presorted Standard, or PRSRT STD, or Marketing, or MKTG permit or meter strip).

Also, AUTO, Carrier Route Presort, or CAR-RT SORT may appear in the permit area in the top right-hand corner of the mail piece.

AUTO

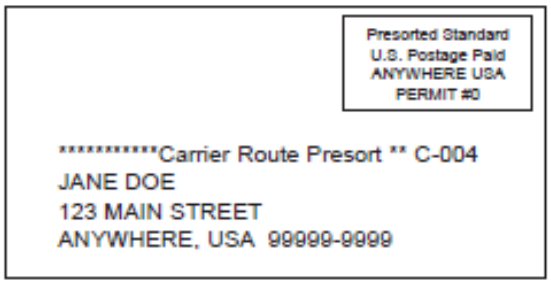


"AUTO" above address

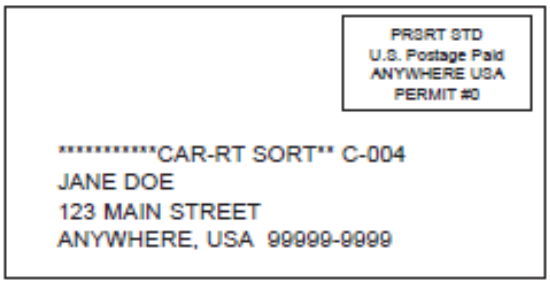


"AUTO" inside permit

Carrier Route Presort, or CAR-RT SORT



"Carrier Route Presort"



"CAR-RT SORT"

Hint: Find closest match

Presorted Standard or Marketing Mail Examples

Note: Many of the markings may appear with any of the permit types (i.e., ECR may appear with a Presorted Standard, or PRSRT STD, or Marketing, or MKTG permit or meter strip).

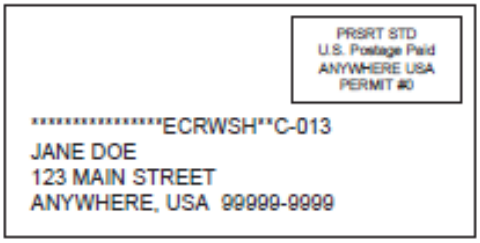
ECR with LOT, WSS, or WSH



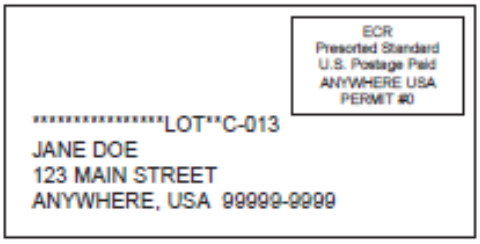
"ECRLOT" above address



"ECRWSS" above address



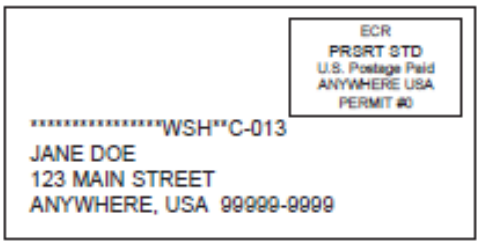
"ECRWSH" above address



"ECR" on Permit *and* "LOT" above address



"ECR" on Permit *and* "WSS" above address

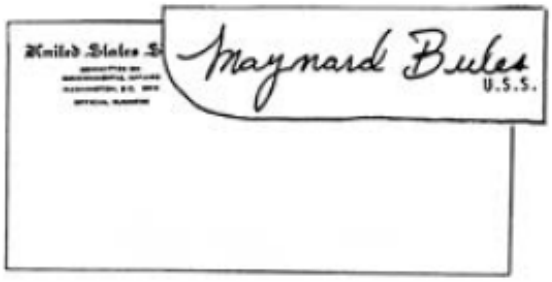


"ECR" on Permit *and* "WSH" above address

Hint: Find closest match

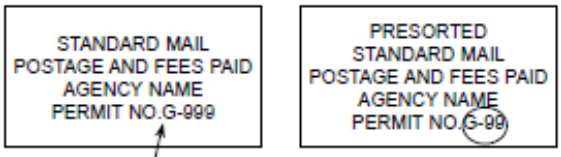
Presorted Standard or Marketing Mail Examples

Federal Government Mail (Franked)



"Official Government Signature" (Franked)

Other Federal Government Mail



Government Permit Number

Hint: Find closest match

Nonprofit Organization Mail (Gray)

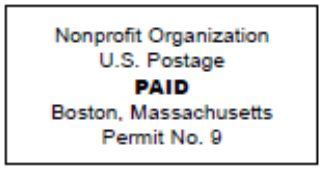
Use the following to help you determine if your mail piece should be recorded under this type:

- All Nonprofit Mail must be marked "**Nonprofit Organization**," "**Nonprofit Org.**," or "**Nonprofit**."
- A few examples of Nonprofit Organizations are charities, schools, hospitals, churches, etc.
- Nonprofit Organization Mail may include requests for donations of money, your time, or other items, or they may be asking you to purchase an item or service.

Examples of Nonprofit postage & mail markings begin on the next page.

Nonprofit Organization Mail Examples

Nonprofit Organization, Nonprofit Org., or Nonprofit



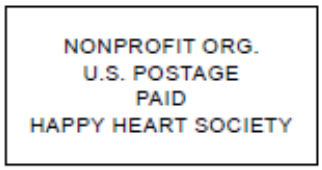
"Nonprofit Organization" on Permit



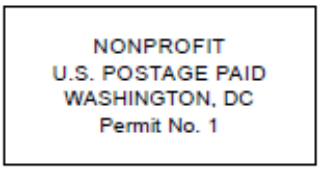
"Nonprofit Org." on Metered Strip



"Nonprofit Org." on Stamp



"Nonprofit Org." on Permit

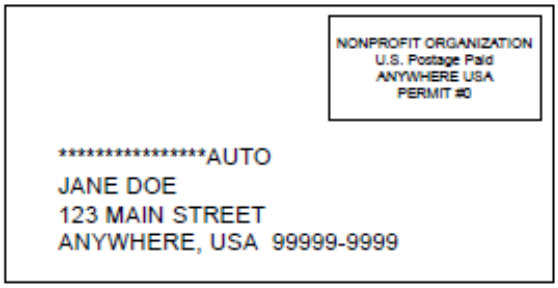


"Nonprofit" on Permit

Note: Many of the markings may appear with any of the permit types (i.e., AUTO may appear with a Nonprofit Organization, Nonprofit Org., or Nonprofit permit or meter strip.)

Also, AUTO may appear in the permit area in the top right-hand corner of the mail piece.

AUTO



"AUTO" above address

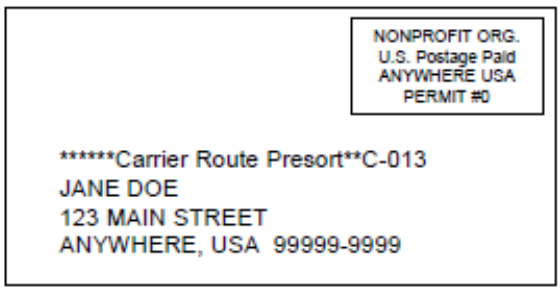
Hint: Find closest match

Nonprofit Organization Mail Examples

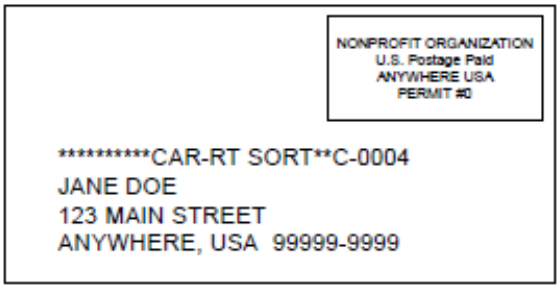
Note: Many of the markings may appear with any of the permit types (i.e., CAR-RT SORT may appear with a Nonprofit Organization, Nonprofit Org., or Nonprofit permit or meter strip).

Also, Carrier Route Presort or CAR-RT SORT may appear in the permit area in the top right-hand corner of the mail piece.

Carrier Route Presort or CAR-RT SORT



"Carrier Route Presort" above address



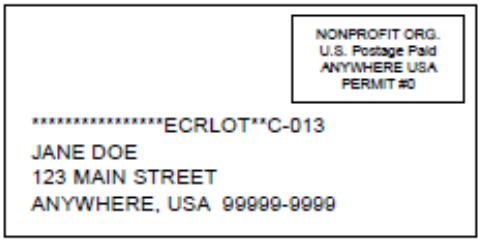
"CAR-RT SORT" above address

Hint: Find closest match

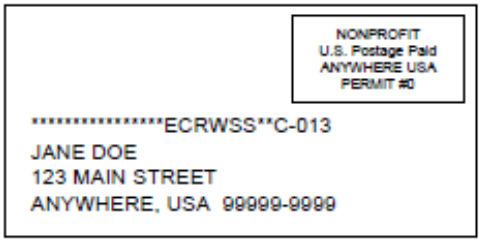
Nonprofit Organization Mail Examples

Note: Many of the markings may appear with any of the permit types (i.e., ECR may appear with a Nonprofit Organization, Nonprofit Org., or Nonprofit permit or meter strip).

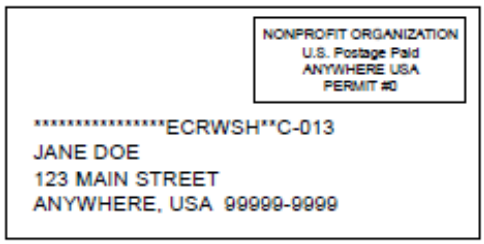
ECR with LOT, WSS, or WSH



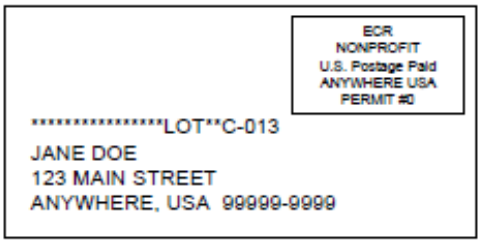
"ECRLOT" above address



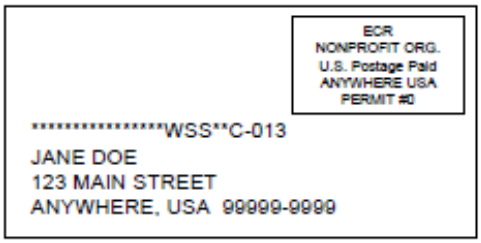
"ECRWSS" above address



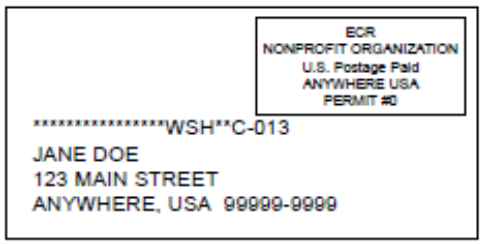
"ECRWSH" above address



"ECR" on Permit *and* "LOT" above address



"ECR" on Permit *and* "WSS" above address



"ECR" on Permit *and* "WSH" above address

Hint: Find closest match

Packages & Expedited Materials Received & Sent (Green)

Use the following to help you determine if your mail piece should be recorded under this type:

Packages and Parcels:

- Include ALL packages or boxes received or sent via the U.S. Postal Service (USPS) as well as packages delivered by any other organization, such as the United Parcel Service (UPS), FedEx, etc. Be careful to distinguish between packages delivered by the U.S. Postal Service (USPS) whose markings include an Eagle, and those delivered by the United Parcel Service (UPS) whose markings have a shield.

- Include catalogs that are marked "**Bound Printed Matter**" or "**PRSRT BPM**", or other packages marked "**Parcel Select**", "**PS Lightweight**", "**Media Mail**", or "**First-Class**".

- Record all personal packages received and sent at home and other locations such as work, or at the U.S. Post Office, etc.

- Do not include packages sent and received on behalf of a household members place of employment or a business.

Packages from Amazon:

- You may receive packages ordered from Amazon.com, but please be sure to look closely at the shipping label, as most times they are marked with U.S. Postal Service postage, such as Parcel Select or PS Lightweight, or marked with another carrier's shipping label such as FedEx. In these cases Amazon was not the delivery company. In some cases, Amazon does use their own shipping label and postage.

Expedited Letters, Packages, and Boxes:

- Include letters, packages, and boxes that were delivered by any expedited mail carrier (**see examples on the next page**), which include the U.S. Postal Service (USPS), United Parcel Service (UPS), or FedEx.

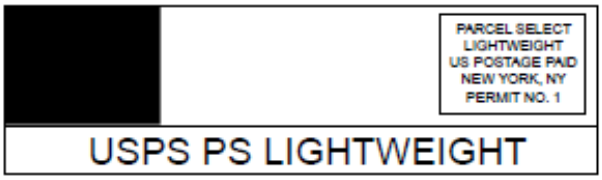
- You may see terms such as Priority Mail Express, Priority Mail, Overnight, 2-day, 3-day, Next Day Air, 2nd Day Air, etc.

Package & Expedited Examples

Priority Mail Express

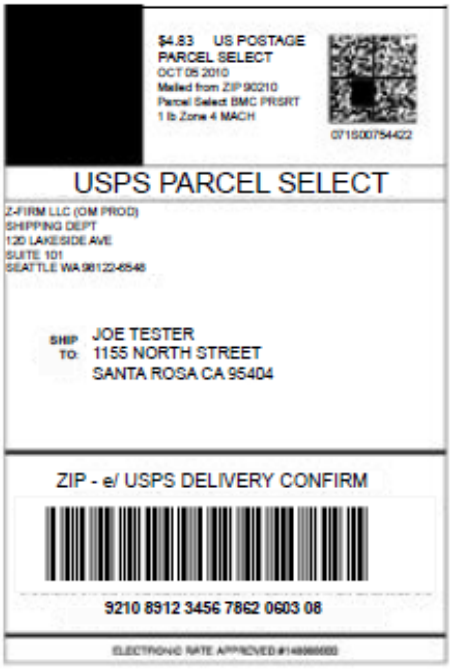


PS Lightweight



Marked "PS Lightweight"
or "Parcel Select Lightweight"

Parcel Select

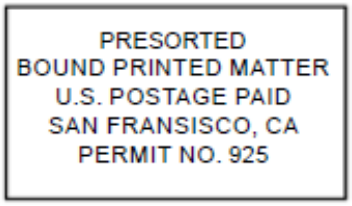


Marked "Parcel Select"

Priority Mail



Bound Printed Matter



Marked "BPM" or "Bound Printed Matter"





Magazines, Newspapers, or Other Periodicals (Yellow)

Use the following to help you determine if a Magazine, Newspaper, or other Periodical should be recorded under this type. Examples include:

- Daily newspapers (Wall Street Journal, New York Post, Los Angeles Times, Washington Post, etc.)
- Weekly magazines/newspaper (Time, People, Entertainment Weekly, US Weekly, The Economist, The New York Times, etc.)
- Other magazines/newspaper (Reader's Digest, AARP Bulletin, AARP Magazine, USA Today, etc.)
- Monthly magazine (Rolling Stone, In Style, Guideposts, Food & Wine, Country Living, etc.)
- Alumni or fraternal magazines and newspapers or other publications that household members may subscribe to
- Include magazines, newspapers, envelopes, and other periodicals marked "**Periodicals Postage Paid**."
- **Only** include magazines, newspapers, other periodicals, and envelopes that are delivered by the U.S. Postal Service (USPS) and that are **NOT** marked First-Class, Presorted Standard, Nonprofit Organization, or Bound Printed Matter (Packages & Expedited). If they are marked with any of these other postage types, record them under the section for that mail type.

Do not include the following items under this section:

- Newspapers delivered by your local news carrier. (Do not include these in the diary study.)
- Magazines and newspapers you bought at the store or a newsstand. (Do not include these in the diary study.)
- **DO NOT** include Catalogs in the Magazines, Newspapers, or Other Periodicals section. Catalogs are either Presorted Standard (to be recorded in the Presorted Standard or Marketing Mail Received section) or Bound Printed Matter (to be recorded in the Packages & Expedited Materials section).

Unaddressed Mail
(Pink)

Use the following to help you determine if your mail piece should be recorded under this type:

- Only include mail delivered by the U.S. Postal Service (USPS). **Do not include** advertising material that has been left at your door, or material hung on your doorknob or left on your car.

- Include mail pieces that don't have any postage or an address label. If a mail piece is labeled "Occupant" or "Resident," do not include it in this section because it most likely is marked "PRST STD" or "Presorted Standard," or "Presorted Marketing," or "MKTG."

- Typically, Unaddressed Mail will only be weekly advertising flyers/circulars that are folded or grouped together and do not have an address label or postage on each piece. Simply record the whole group as ONE mail piece. They are usually accompanied by a detached label card marked "PRST STD" or "Presorted Standard," or "PRST MKTG."

(Please refer to page 9 in this booklet for additional information on recording unaddressed mail that comes along with a detached label card.)

Appendix C2: Diary Package – Photo Quick Start

PHOTO QUICK START







Postage & Mail Markings can be:

- in the top right-hand corner,
- above or below the address, or
- inside the window of an envelope.



Use the Postage & Mail Markings on your mail to help you sort! Be sure to record all packages your household receives and sends.

1 Sort your mail each day into the 6 types of mail listed on page 1 of the **Instruction Booklet.**

2 Label and number each mail piece within the 6 types of mail. (Photo shows First-Class only).



3 Open the **Answer Booklet** for Monday (or first mail day) to page 1 - Summary Page.

Record the total number of mail pieces you received that day for each mail type.



4 Open the **Question Booklet** to page 3 - First-Class Mail Received.

If you didn't receive any First-Class Mail that day, skip to page 5: First-Class Mail Sent, or page 7: Presorted Standard Mail, or other pages for mail types you did receive.



5 Write your answers to the questions from the Question Booklet in the **Answer Booklet**.

Be sure to record mail for each mail type you receive (Monday-Sunday) on the color-coded pages for that mail type.

Questions? **Visit the project web page: https://uspsmailsurvey.com/usps/, call our USPS Hotline at: 1-888-441-USPS (8777), or e-mail your question to USPS@nustats.com**

Appendix C2: Diary Package – Question Booklet

UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE.

3

Question Booklet

Use with Answer Booklets (Monday-Sunday)

Questions? Call our toll-free hotline at:

1-888-441-USPS (8777)

Available 11am - 5pm Central Standard Time (Mon - Fri)

OR

e-mail your question to:

USPS@nustats.com

OR

visit the project web page at:

https://uspsmailsurvey.com/usps/

Table of Contents

	Color	Page
Example	White	1
Mail Piece Size Template	White	2
Question Sheets:		
First-Class / Presorted First-Class Mail Received	Purple	3
First-Class Mail Sent	Purple	5
Presorted Standard or Marketing Mail Received	Blue	7
Nonprofit Organization Mail Received	Gray	9
Packages & Expedited Materials Received	Green	11
Packages & Expedited Materials Sent	Green	13
Magazines, Newspapers, or Other Periodicals	Yellow	15
Unaddressed Mail Received	Pink	17

Example

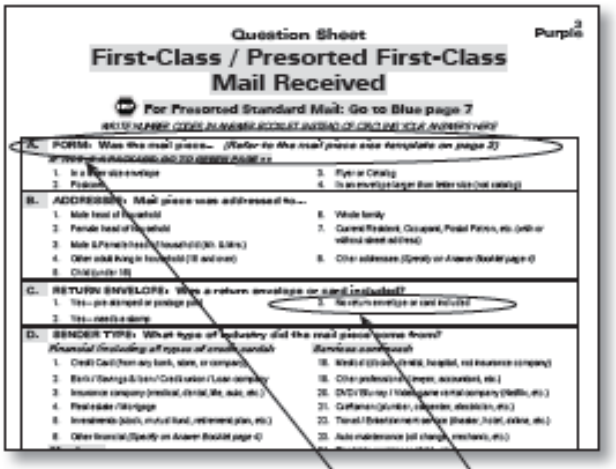
Once you've sorted and numbered your mail pieces, you are ready to begin recording information. Remember to use the postage and the mail markings on the mail piece to help you determine the mail type ***(see page 1 of the Instruction Booklet for how to sort and number your mail)***.

You need both this Question Booklet and the Answer Booklet. Open both this Question Booklet and the Answer Booklet to the color-coded pages for the type of mail you have (e.g., purple pages are First-Class Mail, blue pages are Standard or Marketing Mail, etc.).

Each question sheet contains both questions (letters A, B, C, etc.) and answer codes (numbers 1, 2, 3, etc.). **Don't record your answers in this Question Booklet; instead, use the corresponding daily Answer Booklet.** Record the number that best matches your response.

Answer the questions about each mail piece down the answer sheet. For example, if you receive four (4) First-Class mail pieces on Monday, you will record answers to all questions about mail piece #1 in the first column, and about mail piece #2 in the second column, mail piece #3 in the third column, and #4 in the fourth column.

Question Sheet (in Question Booklet)

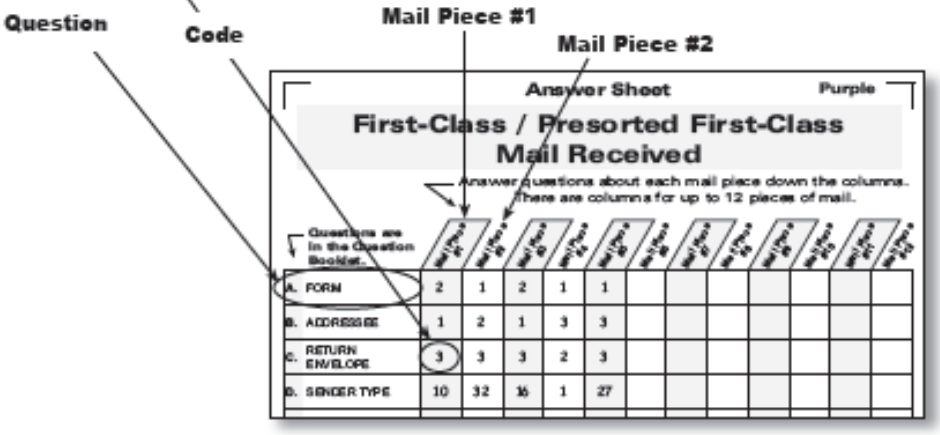


When completing your Answer Booklet, please print clearly as in the example:

1 OR 20

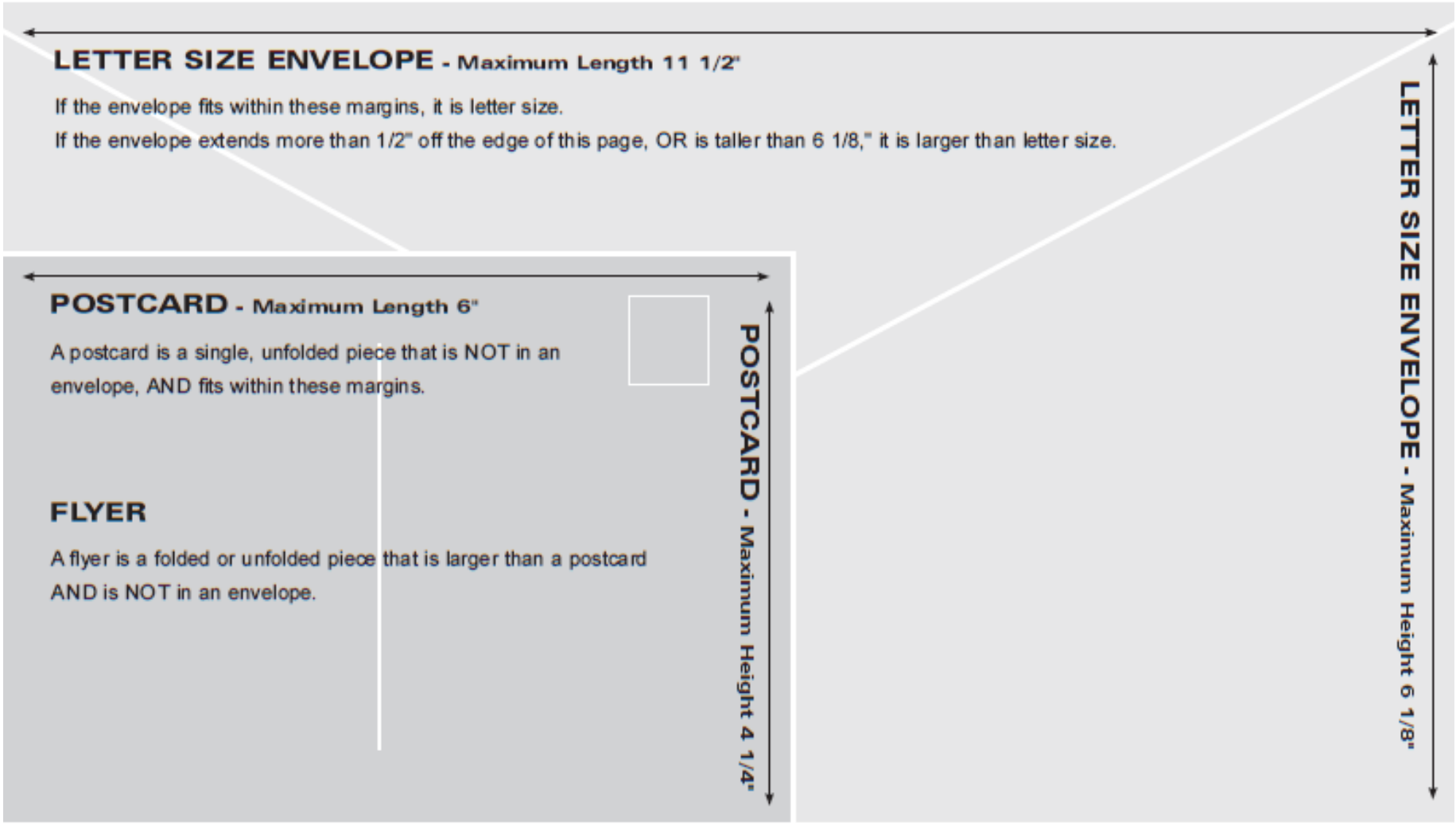
Use a pen in black or blue ink
DO NOT USE PENCIL

Answer Sheet (in Answer Booklet)



Mail Piece Size Template

Use the guide below to help you determine the size of your mail piece. This will help answer the FORM question.



Question Sheet

First-Class / Presorted First-Class Mail Received



For Presorted Standard or Marketing Mail: Go to Blue page 7

WRITE NUMBER CODES IN ANSWER BOOKLET INSTEAD OF CIRCLING YOUR ANSWERS HERE

A. FORM: Was the mail piece... ***(Refer to the mail piece size template on page 2)***

IF THIS IS A PACKAGE: GO TO GREEN PAGE 11

1. In a letter size envelope
2. Postcard
3. Flyer or Catalog
4. In an envelope larger than letter size (not catalog)

B. ADDRESSEE: Mail piece was addressed to...

1. Male head of household
2. Female head of household
3. More than one head of household
4. Other adult living in household (18 and over)
5. Child (under 18)
6. Whole family
7. Current Resident, Occupant, Postal Patron, etc. (with or without street address)
8. Other addressee *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 4)*

C. RETURN ENVELOPE: Was a return envelope or card included?

1. Yes – pre-stamped or postage paid
2. Yes – needs a stamp
3. No return envelope or card included

D. SENDER TYPE: What type of industry did the mail piece come from?

Financial (including all types of credit cards):

1. Credit Card (from any bank, store, or company)
2. Bank / Savings & loan / Credit union / Loan company
3. Insurance company (medical, dental, life, auto, etc.)
4. Real estate / Mortgage
5. Investments (stock, mutual fund, retirement plan, etc.)
6. Other financial *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 4)*

Merchants:

7. Supermarket / Grocery store
8. Department / Discount store
9. Other store (electronics, shoes, clothes, hardware, drug store / pharmacy etc.) (*Specify store type on Answer Booklet page 4*)
10. Mail order company (Lands End, Blair, L.L. Bean, etc.)
11. Restaurant (incl. fast food, pizza delivery, etc.)
12. Publisher (newspapers, books, magazines)
13. Auto dealership (not manufacturer or service department)
14. Individual seller (on eBay, craigslist, or other online sales site)
15. Other merchants *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 4)*

Services:

16. Telephone / Cell / Cable / Satellite / Internet
17. Electric / Gas / Water / Utility company

Services continued:

18. Medical (doctor, dentist, hospital, not insurance company)
19. Other professional (lawyer, accountant, etc.)
20. DVD / Blu-ray / Video game rental company (Netflix, etc.)
21. Craftsman (plumber, carpenter, electrician, etc.)
22. Travel / Entertainment service (theater, hotel, airline, etc.)
23. Auto maintenance (oil change, mechanic, etc.)
24. Roadside assistance (AAA, etc.)
25. Other services *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 4)*

Manufacturers:

26. All manufacturers (makers of automobiles, computers, etc.)

Government:

27. Federal (Social Security, VA, IRS, Medicare, etc.)
28. State and Local (not a utility company)

Nonprofit / Charitable / Social / Political:

29. Educational (public & private schools, universities, etc.)
30. Political (campaign, political action committee, political party, etc.)
31. All other nonprofit organizations

Friend or Relative:

32. Friend or Relative (not from a business)

More questions on back of page →

4

First-Class Mail Received *cont.* — Purple

E. PURPOSE: What was the MAIN purpose of the mail piece? *(Write in one number only)*

1. Holiday / Seasons greeting card
2. Other greeting cards (birthday, sympathy, thank you)
3. Invitation or announcement from friend or relative → **SKIP TO J**
4. Letter from friend or relative → **SKIP TO J**
5. Bill / Invoice / Premium (not for a credit card)
6. Financial statement (not for a credit card)
7. Credit card bill / Credit card statement
8. Notice / Announcement / Business invitation (no bills, no ads)
9. Advertising / Promotional / Sales only (no bills) → **SKIP TO G**
10. Insurance explanation of benefits
11. Tax related (information, forms, etc.)
12. DVD / Blu-ray / Video game rental
13. Request for donation (money, time, blood drive, goods, etc.)
14. Confirmation or thank you for donation
15. Rebate received in response to coupon submitted
16. Direct deposit receipts or check stub (not a payment)
17. New or replacement credit or debit card
18. Payment or other check / Money order / Credit (no rebate)
19. Survey / Questionnaire
20. Sweepstakes / Contest promotion
21. Newsletter
22. Prospectus
23. Social Security related (information, statement, etc.)
24. Other *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 4)*

STOP IF THIS MAIL PIECE WAS FROM A FRIEND OR RELATIVE, SKIP TO J

F. ADVERTISING: Did this mail piece contain any advertising or promotional material?

1. Yes
2. No → **SKIP TO J**

G. READING: Was the advertising... *(Write in one number only)*

1. Read by a member of the household
2. Read by more than one member of the household
3. Looked at but not read by any member of the household
4. Discarded without being read
5. Set aside for reading later

H. REACTION: Would this advertising be described as...

1. Useful information we like to receive
2. Interesting or enjoyable, but not useful
3. Neither interesting, enjoyable, nor useful
4. Objectionable or offensive

I. RESPONSE: Is anyone in your household considering responding to the advertisement?

1. Yes
2. No
3. Maybe

J. CLASS: Tell us what markings are on the mail piece. *(Select all that apply)*

Look at the markings in the top right-hand corner. For examples of First-Class Mail markings, see pages 5-8 of the Instruction Booklet.

1. Presorted First-Class, or PRSRT, or FP
2. Forever Stamp
3. First-Class Stamp with price (not Forever Stamp)
4. First-Class Postage (Metered strip or Permit Mail – see examples)
5. Single Piece, or SNGLP, or SP
6. Mail from outside the U.S
7. Federal Government Mail with Official Signature (FRANKED)
8. Other Federal Government Mail
9. Other classification *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 4)*

Remember – packages and pieces marked Presorted Standard, Marketing, Nonprofit, or Periodicals do not belong in the First Class mail type.

Please mark all mail pieces for this day & place in the daily envelope.

Question Sheet

First-Class Mail Sent

WRITE NUMBER CODES IN ANSWER BOOKLET INSTEAD OF CIRCLING YOUR ANSWERS HERE

A. FORM: Was the mail piece... *(Refer to the mail piece size template on page 2)*

IF THIS IS A PACKAGE: GO TO GREEN PAGE 13

1. In a letter size envelope
2. Postcard
3. In an envelope larger than letter size
4. Other *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 6)*

B. ADDRESSEE TYPE: What type of industry did you send the mail piece to?

Financial (including all types of credit cards):

1. Credit Card (from any bank, store, or company)
2. Bank / Savings & loan / Credit union / Loan company
3. Insurance company (medical, dental, life, auto, etc.)
4. Real estate / Mortgage
5. Investments (stock, mutual fund, retirement plan, etc.)
6. Other financial *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 6)*

Merchants:

7. Supermarket / Grocery store
8. Department / Discount store
9. Other store (electronics, shoes, clothes, hardware, drug store / pharmacy, etc.) *(Specify store type on Answer Booklet page 6)*
10. Mail order company (Lands End, Blair, L.L. Bean, etc.)
11. Restaurant (incl. fast food, pizza delivery, etc.)
12. Publisher (newspapers, books, magazines)
13. Auto dealership (not manufacturer or service department)
14. Individual seller (on eBay, craigslist, or other online sales site)
15. Other merchants *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 6)*

Services:

16. Telephone / Cell / Cable / Satellite / Internet
17. Electric / Gas / Water / Utility company

Services continued:

18. Medical (doctor, dentist, hospital, not insurance company)
19. Other professional (lawyer, accountant, etc.)
20. DVD / Blu-ray / Video game rental company (Netflix, etc.)
21. Craftsman (plumber, carpenter, electrician, etc.)
22. Travel / Entertainment service (theater, hotel, airline, etc.)
23. Auto maintenance (oil change, mechanic, etc.)
24. Roadside assistance (AAA, etc.)
25. Other services *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 6)*

Manufacturers:

26. All manufacturers (makers of automobiles, computers, etc.)

Government:

27. Federal (Social Security, VA, IRS, Medicare, etc.)
28. State and Local (not a utility company)

Nonprofit / Charitable / Social / Political:

29. Educational (public & private schools, universities, etc.)
30. Political (campaign, political action committee, political party, etc.)
31. All other nonprofit organizations

Friend or Relative:

32. Friend or Relative (not to a business)

C. PURPOSE: What was the MAIN purpose of the mail piece? *(Write in one number only)*

1. Holiday / Seasons greeting card
2. Other greeting cards (birthday, sympathy, thank you)
3. Invitation / Announcement (birth, marriage, etc.)
4. Letter / Correspondence (written by you – not a form)
5. Order
6. Inquiry
7. Payment (bill payment, dues, membership fees, etc.)
8. Donation
9. Survey / Questionnaire response
10. Sweepstakes / Contest entry
11. DVD / Blu-ray / Video game return
12. Proxy vote response
13. Election materials (absentee ballot, registration, etc.)
14. Rebate request
15. Tax related
16. Completed form / Application / Paperwork (not a tax form)
17. Other *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 6)*

STOP IF THIS MAIL PIECE WAS TO A FRIEND OR RELATIVE, SKIP TO G

D. AD RESPONSE: Was the mail piece sent in response to advertising or solicitation for funds?

1. Yes
2. No → **SKIP TO F**

E. AD MATERIAL: Was the advertising / promotional / solicitation material...

1. Received in mail (not in magazine)
2. Seen in magazine
3. Seen in newspaper
4. Seen on television
5. Heard on radio
6. Received over telephone
7. Seen on the Internet
8. Other advertising *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 6)*

More questions on back of page →

6

First-Class Mail Sent *cont.* — Purple

F. RETURN ENVELOPE: Did you use your own envelope or card?

1. Yes
2. No – a return envelope or card **with postage** was provided
3. No – a return envelope or card **without postage** was provided

G. SPECIAL SVCS: Did the mail piece have any of the following special services? ***(OK to choose more than one)***

1. Certified
2. Registered
3. Insured
4. Return Receipt Requested
5. Certificate of Mailing
6. Restricted Delivery
7. COD
8. No special services
9. Other *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 6)*

H. PO BOX: Was this mail piece sent to a PO Box?

1. Yes
2. No

I. POSTAGE TYPE: What type of postage was used? ***(Either postage that you put on yourself or postage that was already on the envelope or card)***

1. Business Reply Mail (no postage necessary)
2. Permit Reply Mail (no postage necessary)
3. Forever Stamp
4. Regular postage stamp
5. Meter stamp
6. Other *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 6)*

Question Sheet

Presorted Standard or Marketing Mail Received



For Presorted First-Class Mail: Go to Purple page 3

WRITE NUMBER CODES IN ANSWER BOOKLET INSTEAD OF CIRCLING YOUR ANSWERS HERE

A. ADDRESSEE: Mail piece was addressed to...

1. Specific member(s) of the household
2. Current Resident, Occupant, Postal Patron, etc. (with or without street address)
3. Someone not living at this address

B. FORM: Was the mail piece... *(Refer to the mail piece size template on page 2)*

1. In a letter size envelope
2. In an envelope larger than letter size (not catalog)
3. Catalog in envelope
4. Catalog not in envelope
5. Detached label card
6. Postcard
7. Addressed flyers / Circulars / Folded piece (no envelope)
8. Newspapers / Magazines / Newsletters
9. Can't classify type *(Please describe on Answer Booklet pg. 8)*

C. MULTIPLE: Did the mail piece contain...

1. Material from one organization only
2. Material from several organizations → **SKIP TO F**

D. SENDER TYPE: What type of industry did the mail piece come from?

Financial (including all types of credit cards):

1. Credit Card (from any bank, store, or company)
2. Bank / Savings & loan / Credit union / Loan company
3. Insurance company (medical, dental, life, auto, etc.)
4. Real estate / Mortgage
5. Investments (stock, mutual fund, retirement plan, etc.)
6. Other financial *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 8)*

Merchants:

7. Supermarket / Grocery store
8. Department / Discount store
9. Other store (electronics, shoes, clothes, hardware, drug store / pharmacy, etc.) (*Specify store type on Answer Booklet page 8*)
10. Mail order company (Lands End, Blair, L.L. Bean, etc.)
11. Restaurant (incl. fast food, pizza delivery, etc.)
12. Publisher (newspapers, books, magazines)
13. Auto dealership (not manufacturer or service department)
14. Individual seller (on eBay, craigslist, or other online sales site)
15. Other merchants *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 8)*

Services:

16. Telephone / Cell / Cable / Satellite / Internet
17. Electric / Gas / Water / Utility company
18. Medical (doctor, dentist, hospital, not insurance company)

Services continued:

19. Other professional (lawyer, accountant, etc.)
20. DVD / Blu-ray / Video game rental company (Netflix, etc.)
21. Craftsman (plumber, carpenter, electrician, etc.)
22. Travel / Entertainment service (theater, hotel, airline, etc.)
23. Auto maintenance (oil change, mechanic, etc.)
24. Roadside assistance (AAA, etc.)
25. Other services *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 8)*

Manufacturers:

26. All manufacturers (makers of automobiles, computers, etc.)

Government:

27. Federal (Social Security, VA, IRS, Medicare, etc.)
28. State and Local (not a utility company)

Nonprofit / Charitable / Social / Political:

29. Educational (public & private schools, universities, etc.)
30. Political (campaign, political action committee, political party, etc.)
31. Union or professional organization
32. Church / Religious organization
33. Veterans (VFW, American Legion, DAV, etc.)
34. Charity
35. AARP (for AARP insurance plans, record code 3)
36. Other nonprofit, etc. *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 8)*

E. FAMILIARITY: Was this mail piece from an organization someone in household...

1. Does or has done business with
2. Knows, but no one does business with
3. Organization no one in household knows

F. RETURN ENVELOPE: Was a return envelope or card included?

1. Yes – pre-stamped or postage paid
2. Yes – needs a stamp
3. No return envelope or card included

More questions on back of page →

8

Presorted Standard or Marketing Mail Received *cont.* Blue

G. READING: Was the mail piece... ***(Write in one number only)***

1. Read by a member of the household
2. Read by more than one member of the household
3. Looked at but not read by any member of the household
4. Discarded without being read
5. Set aside for reading later

H. REACTION: Would this mail piece be described as...

1. Useful information we like to receive
2. Interesting or enjoyable, but not useful
3. Neither interesting, enjoyable, nor useful
4. Objectionable or offensive

I. COUPONS: Did this mail piece contain coupons?

1. Yes
2. No

J. PURPOSE: What was the MAIN purpose of the mail piece? ***(Write in one number only)***

1. Advertisement for item(s) or service(s) to be purchased (credit card offers, etc.)
2. Request for donation (money, time, blood drive, goods, etc.)
3. Political materials
4. Newsletter / Newspaper / Magazine
5. Subscription renewal notice (for a publication)
6. Financial materials (report, proxy vote, prospectus, privacy or terms notice, etc.) NOTE: for credit card offers, record code 1
7. Invitation / Announcement / Schedule
8. General information
9. Other *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 8)*

K. RESPONSE: Is anyone in your household considering responding to the mail piece?

1. Yes
2. No
3. Maybe

L. CLASS: Tell us what markings are on the mail piece. ***(Select all that apply)***

Look at the markings in the top right-hand corner, above or below the address, and inside the window. For examples of Presorted Standard or Marketing Mail markings, see pages 9 – 13 of the Instruction Booklet.

1. Presorted Standard, or PRSRT STD, or Standard, or STD, or Marketing, or MKTG, or MKT, or Presorted USPS Marketing, or PRSRT MKTG, or PRSRT MKT
2. AUTO
3. Carrier Route Presort, or CAR–RT SORT
4. ECR with LOT, or WSS, or WSH
5. CUSTOMIZED MARKETMAIL, or CUST MKTMAIL, or CMM
6. Federal Government Mail with Official Signature (FRANKED)
7. Other Federal Government Mail
8. Can't classify type *(Please mark & place in envelope along with other mail pieces for this day)*

Question Sheet

Nonprofit Organization Mail Received

STOP *WRITE NUMBER CODES IN ANSWER BOOKLET INSTEAD OF CIRCLING YOUR ANSWERS HERE*

A. ADDRESSEE: Mail piece was addressed to...

1. Specific member(s) of the household
2. Current Resident, Occupant, Postal Patron, etc. (with or without street address)
3. Someone not living at this address

B. FORM: Was the mail piece... ***(Refer to the mail piece size template on page 2)***

1. In a letter size envelope
2. In an envelope larger than letter size (not catalog)
3. Catalog in envelope
4. Catalog not in envelope
5. Detached label card
6. Postcard
7. Addressed flyers / Circulars / Folded piece (no envelope)
8. Newspapers / Magazines / Newsletters
9. Can't classify type *(Please describe on Answer Booklet pg. 10)*

C. MULTIPLE: Did the mail piece contain...

1. Material from one organization only
2. Material from several organizations → **SKIP TO F**

D. SENDER TYPE: What type of industry did the mail piece come from?

Nonprofit / Charitable / Social / Political:

1. Educational (public & private schools, universities, etc.)
2. Political (campaign, political action committee, political party, etc.)
3. Union or professional organization
4. Church / Religious organization
5. Veterans (VFW, American Legion, DAV, etc.)
6. Charity
7. AARP
8. Animal welfare organization (ASPCA, Humane Society, etc.)
9. Environmental / Wildlife organization (WWF, Sierra Club, etc.)
10. Public broadcasting
11. YMCA / YWCA
12. Museum
13. Other nonprofit, etc. *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 10)*

Merchants:

14. Publisher (newspapers, books, magazines)
15. Other merchants *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 10)*

Services:

16. Medical (doctor, dentist, hospital, not insurance company)
17. Travel / Entertainment service (theater, hotel, airline, etc.)
18. Roadside assistance (AAA, etc.)
19. Other services *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 10)*

Government:

20. Federal (Social Security, VA, IRS, Medicare, etc.)
21. State and Local

E. FAMILIARITY: Was this mail piece from an organization someone in household...

1. Does or has done business with
2. Knows, but no one does business with
3. Organization no one in household knows

F. RETURN ENVELOPE: Was a return envelope or card included?

1. Yes – pre-stamped or postage paid
2. Yes – needs a stamp
3. No return envelope or card included

G. READING: Was the mail piece... ***(Write in one number only)***

1. Read by a member of the household
2. Read by more than one member of the household
3. Looked at but not read by any member of the household
4. Discarded without being read
5. Set aside for reading later

H. REACTION: Would this mail piece be described as...

1. Useful information we like to receive
2. Interesting or enjoyable, but not useful
3. Neither interesting, enjoyable, nor useful
4. Objectionable or offensive

I. COUPONS: Did this mail piece contain coupons?

1. Yes
2. No

More questions on back of page →

10

Nonprofit Organization Mail Received *cont.* Gray

J. PURPOSE: What was the MAIN purpose of the mail piece? ***(Write in one number only)***

1. Advertisement for item(s) or service(s) to be purchased
2. Request for donation (money, time, blood drive, goods, etc.)
3. Political materials
4. Newsletter / Newspaper / Magazine
5. Subscription renewal notice (for a publication)
6. Course catalog (college classes, etc.)
7. Invitation / Announcement / Schedule
8. General information
9. Other *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 10)*

K. RESPONSE: Is anyone in your household considering responding to the mail piece?

1. Yes
2. No
3. Maybe

L. CLASS: Tell us what markings are on the mail piece. ***(Select all that apply)***

Look at the markings in the top right-hand corner, above or below the address, and inside the window. For examples of Nonprofit Mail markings see pages 15 – 18 of the Instruction Booklet.

1. Nonprofit Organization, or Nonprofit Org., or Nonprofit
2. AUTO
3. Carrier Route Presort, or CAR–RT SORT
4. ECR with LOT, or WSS, or WSH
5. CUSTOMIZED MARKETMAIL, or CUST MKTMAIL, or CMM
6. Federal Government Mail with Official Signature (FRANKED)
7. Other Federal Government Mail
8. Can't classify type *(Please mark & place in envelope along with other mail pieces for this day)*

Packages & Expedited Materials Received

STOP *WRITE NUMBER CODES IN ANSWER BOOKLET INSTEAD OF CIRCLING YOUR ANSWERS HERE*

A. FORM: Was the mail piece... *(Refer to the mail piece size template on page 2)*

1. SMALL envelope or padded mailer (11 ½" X 6 1/8" or smaller)
2. LARGE envelope or padded mailer (larger than 11 ½" X 6 1/8")
3. Box or other 3 dimensional packaging
4. Other *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 12)*

B. ADDRESSEE: Package / mail piece was addressed to...

1. Male head of household
2. Female head of household
3. More than one head of household
4. Other adult living in household (18 and over)
5. Child (under 18)
6. Whole family
7. Other addressee *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 12)*

C. CONTENTS: Did this package / mail piece contain... *(Select all that apply)*

1. Clothing / Footwear / Shoes / Jewelry / Accessories
2. Travel products or information
3. Computer hardware, software, or accessories
4. Electronic equipment
5. Household / Kitchen / Lawn and garden products
6. Book(s) (include telephone books)
7. CD / DVD / Blu-ray / Video game
8. Toys
9. Food products
10. Checkbooks
11. Health / Medical / Dental / Vision products
12. Cosmetics / Beauty products / Toiletries
13. Photos / Film
14. Credit card (new, replacement, or return of lost card)
15. Notice / Announcement / Business invitation
16. Letter
17. Advertising / Promotional materials
18. Other contents *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 12)*

D. SENDER TYPE: What type of industry did the package content / mail piece originate from?

1. Friend or Relative (not from a business)
2. Financial (credit card, bank, stockbroker, insurance, mortgage, etc.)
3. Supermarket / Grocery store
4. Department / Discount store
5. Other store (electronics, shoes, clothes, hardware, drug store / pharmacy, etc.) (*Specify store type on Answer Booklet page 12*)
6. Mail order company (Lands End, Blair, Oriental Trading Co., etc.)
7. Individual online seller (on eBay, Craigslist, etc.)
8. Online retailer (Amazon, Wayfair, Overstock, etc.)
9. Publisher (newspapers, books, magazines)
10. Other merchants *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 12)*
11. Service (telephone, cable TV, Internet, medical, travel, Netflix, etc.)
12. Manufacturer (makers of automobiles, computers, etc.)
13. Government (local or federal government, including Medicare, IRS, USPS, Social Security, VA, etc.)
14. Nonprofit / Charitable / Social / Political (all schools, charities, political candidates, religious and social organizations, etc.)
15. Other Industry *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 12)*

E. WHO ORDERED: Was the package / mail piece...

1. Ordered by a household member
2. Ordered by a friend or relative for a household member
3. An unsolicited sample → **SKIP TO G**
4. Not ordered / Delivered for some other reason → **SKIP TO G**

E2. HOW ORDERED: If ordered, how was the package / mail piece ordered?

1. Online – from Amazon
2. Online – from a store's website (e.g.: Wal-Mart, Target)
3. Online - from an individual seller (e.g.: eBay, craigslist)
4. Online – from any other website
5. Ordered in store
6. Ordered by telephone call
7. Ordered by mail
8. Other: *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 12)*

More questions on back of page →

Packages & Expedited Materials Received *cont.* Green

F. AD RESPONSE: Was this package ordered in response to advertising?

1. Yes, in response to a catalog I received in the mail
2. Yes, in response to direct mail advertising (not a catalog)
3. Yes, in response to advertising I saw online
4. Yes, in response to some other kind of advertising
5. No - was not in response to advertising

G. RETURN ENVELOPE: Was a return shipping label or envelope included?

1. Yes – postage paid
2. Yes – not postage paid / needs postage
3. No return shipping label or envelope included

H. ADVERTISING: Was any advertising or promotional material enclosed?

1. Yes
2. No → **SKIP TO L**

I. READING: Was the advertising... *(Write in one number only)*

1. Read by a member of the household
2. Read by more than one member of the household
3. Looked at but not read by any member of household
4. Discarded without being read
5. Set aside for reading later

J. REACTION: Would this advertising be described as...

1. Useful information we like to receive
2. Interesting or enjoyable, but not useful
3. Neither interesting, enjoyable, nor useful
4. Objectionable or offensive

K. RESPONSE: Is anyone in your household considering responding to the advertisement?

1. Yes
2. No
3. Maybe

L. SPECIAL SERVICES: Did the package / mail piece have any of the following special services? *(Select all that apply)*

1. Return Receipt Requested
2. Delivery Confirmation
3. Signature Confirmation
4. Insured
5. COD
6. Stamped "Special Handling"
7. Certificate of Mailing
8. Restricted Delivery
9. No special services
10. Other *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 12)*

M. SHIPPING & DELIVERY COMPANY: *(Select all that apply)*

1. U.S. Postal Service (USPS)
2. UPS
3. FedEx
4. Other (Amazon, etc.) *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 12)*

N. CLASS: Package / Mail Classification *(Select all that apply)*

USPS (United States Postal Service):

1. First-Class (Package or Parcel) (up to 13 oz.)
2. Parcel Select
3. PS Lightweight / Parcel Select Lightweight
4. Priority Mail
5. Express Mail / Priority Mail Express
6. Bound Printed Matter or BPM
7. Media Mail
8. USPS Retail Ground
9. Marketing Mail Parcels

UPS:

10. UPS (Ground, 3 Day Select, SurePost, Mail Innovations)
11. UPS Next Day Air
12. UPS 2nd Day Air

FedEx:

13. FedEx (Ground, Express Saver, SmartPost)
14. FedEx Overnight
15. FedEx 2Day

Other:

16. Other classification (Amazon, etc.) (Specify on Answer Booklet page 12.)
17. Package received from outside the U.S.

Packages & Expedited Materials Sent

STOP *WRITE NUMBER CODES IN ANSWER BOOKLET INSTEAD OF CIRCLING YOUR ANSWERS HERE*

A. FORM: Was the mail piece... *(Refer to the mail piece size template on page 2)*

1. SMALL envelope or padded mailer (11 ½" X 6 1/8" or smaller)
2. LARGE envelope or padded mailer (larger than 11 ½" X 6 1/8")
3. Box or other 3 dimensional packaging
4. Other *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 14)*

B. CONTENTS: Did this package / mail piece contain... *(Select all that apply)*

1. Clothing / Footwear / Shoes / Jewelry / Accessories
2. Travel products or information
3. Computer hardware, software, or accessories
4. Electronic equipment
5. Household / Kitchen / Lawn and garden products
6. Book(s) (include telephone books)
7. CD / DVD / Blu-ray / Video game
8. Toys
9. Food products
10. Checkbooks
11. Health / Medical / Dental / Vision products
12. Cosmetics / Beauty products / Toiletries
13. Photos / Film
14. Greeting card (holiday, birthday, thank you, etc.)
15. Invitation
16. Letter
17. Completed forms (insurance forms, proxy vote, etc.)
18. Other contents *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 14)*

C. ADDRESSEE TYPE: What type of industry did you send the package / mail piece to?

1. Friend or Relative (not to a business) → **SKIP TO F**
2. Store (supermarket/grocery, department/discount, electronics, shoes, etc.) (*Specify store type on Answer Booklet page 14*)
3. Mail order company (Lands End, Blair, Oriental Trading Co., etc.)
4. Individual online buyer or seller (on eBay, Craigslist, etc.)
5. Online retailer (Amazon, Wayfair, Overstock, etc.)
6. Other Industry *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 14)*

D. AD RESPONSE: Was the package / mail piece sent in response to advertising or solicitation for funds?

1. Yes
2. No → **SKIP TO F**

E. AD MATERIAL: Was the advertising / promotional / solicitation material...

1. Received in mail (not in magazine)
2. Seen in magazine
3. Seen in newspaper
4. Seen on television
5. Heard on radio
6. Received over telephone
7. Seen on the Internet
8. Other advertising *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 14)*

F. REASON: Why did you send this package / mail piece?

1. Gift or other item sent to friend or relative
2. Returning merchandise ordered
3. Returning unsolicited merchandise
4. Sending item sold on eBay, craigslist, or other online sales site
5. Other reason *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 14)*

G. SPECIAL SERVICES: Did you send this package / mail piece with any of the following special services? *(Select all that apply)*

1. Return Receipt Requested
2. Delivery Confirmation
3. Signature Confirmation
4. Insured
5. COD
6. Stamped "Special Handling"
7. Certificate of Mailing
8. Restricted Delivery
9. No special services
10. Other *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 14)*

More questions on back of page →

14

Packages & Expedited Materials Sent *cont.* Green

H. CLASS: Package / Mail Classification ***(Select all that apply)***

USPS (United States Postal Service):

1. First-Class (Package or Parcel) (up to 13 oz.)
2. Priority Mail
3. Express Mail/Priority Mail Express
4. Bound Printed Matter or BPM
5. Media Mail
6. USPS Retail Ground
7. Parcel Return Service

UPS:

8. UPS (Ground, 3 Day Select)
9. UPS Next Day Air
10. UPS 2nd Day Air

FedEx:

11. FedEx (Ground, Express Saver, SmartPost)
12. FedEx Overnight
13. FedEx 2Day

Other:

14. Other classification *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 14.)*
15. Package sent outside the U.S.

Question Sheet

Magazines, Newspapers, or Other Periodicals Received

Periodicals do not have First-Class, Presorted Standard, Marketing Mail, or Nonprofit postage markings.

Record only if delivered by the U.S. Postal Service.

WRITE NUMBER CODES IN ANSWER BOOKLET INSTEAD OF CIRCLING YOUR ANSWERS HERE

A. TYPE: This periodical is...

1. Daily newspaper
2. Weekly newspaper
3. Other newspaper
4. Weekly magazine
5. Monthly magazine
6. Other magazine
7. Newsletter
8. Other periodical *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 16)*

B. SENDER TYPE: Was the periodical from...

1. Union
2. Religious organization
3. Veterans' organization
4. Charitable organization
5. Educational organization
6. Professional organization – someone in household is member
7. Any other organization
8. Any other publisher

C. SUBSCRIPTION: Type of subscription?

1. Paid - ordered by household member
2. Free - ordered by household member
3. Free - not ordered by household member
4. Free - came with membership
5. Gift subscription from a friend or relative
6. Other subscription *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 16)*

D. ARRIVAL TIME: This periodical...

1. Arrived earlier than expected
2. Arrived on day expected
3. Arrived later than expected
4. Was not expected to arrive on any special day

E. DELIVERY: This periodical...

1. Could arrive later and not cause difficulty/inconvenience
2. Comes on the proper day and shouldn't come any later
3. Doesn't have a regular delivery day
4. Arrives so late that it causes difficulty/inconvenience
5. Delivery date is not important
6. Other delivery need *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 16)*

Question Sheet

Unaddressed Mail Received

STOP **Unaddressed mail has no postage markings and no address information.**

Packets of advertisements that are folded together are considered a single mail piece.

WRITE NUMBER CODES IN ANSWER BOOKLET INSTEAD OF CIRCLING YOUR ANSWERS HERE

A. CONTENTS: Did the mail piece contain...

1. Coupons from a single organization
2. Coupons from multiple organizations → **SKIP TO D**
3. Advertising from a single organization
4. Advertising from multiple organizations → **SKIP TO D**
5. Both coupons and advertising from a single organization
6. Both coupons and advertising from multiple organizations → **SKIP TO D**
7. Political materials
8. Product samples (with or without coupons)

B. SENDER TYPE: What type of industry did the mail piece come from?

Financial (including all types of credit cards):

1. Credit Card (from any bank, store, or company)
2. Bank / Savings & loan / Credit union / Loan company
3. Insurance company (medical, dental, life, auto, etc.)
4. Real estate / Mortgage
5. Investments (stock, mutual fund, retirement plan, etc.)
6. Other financial *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 18)*

Merchants:

7. Supermarket / Grocery store
8. Department / Discount store
9. Other store (electronics, shoes, clothes, hardware, drug store / pharmacy, etc.) *(Specify store type on Answer Booklet page 18)*
10. Mail order company (Lands End, Blair, L.L. Bean, etc.)
11. Restaurant (incl. fast food, pizza delivery, etc.)
12. Publisher (newspapers, books, magazines)
13. Auto dealership (not manufacturer or service department)
14. Individual seller (on eBay, craigslist, or other online sales site)
15. Other merchants *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 18)*

Services:

16. Telephone / Cell / Cable / Satellite / Internet
17. Electric / Gas / Water / Utility company
18. Medical (doctor, dentist, hospital, not insurance company)

Services continued:

19. Other professional (lawyer, accountant, etc.)
20. DVD / Blu-ray / Video game rental company (Netflix, etc.)
21. Craftsman (plumber, carpenter, electrician, etc.)
22. Travel / Entertainment service (theater, hotel, airline, etc.)
23. Auto maintenance (oil change, mechanic, etc.)
24. Roadside assistance (AAA, etc.)
25. Other services *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 18)*

Manufacturers:

26. All manufacturers (makers of automobiles, computers, etc.)

Government:

27. Federal (Social Security, VA, IRS, Medicare, etc.)
28. State and Local (not a utility company)

Nonprofit / Charitable / Social / Political:

29. Educational (public & private schools, universities, etc.)
30. Political (campaign, political action committee, political party, etc.)
31. Union or professional organization
32. Church / Religious Organization
33. Veterans (VFW, American Legion, DAV, etc.)
34. Charity
35. AARP (for AARP insurance plans, record code 3)
36. Other nonprofit, etc. *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 18)*

C. FAMILIARITY: Was this mail piece from an organization someone in household...

1. Does or has done business with
2. Knows, but no one does business with
3. Organization no one in household knows

D. READING: Was the mail piece... ***(Write in one number only)***

1. Read by a household member
2. Read by more than one household member
3. Looked at but not read by any household member
4. Discarded without being read
5. Set aside for reading later

E. REACTION: Would this mail piece be described as...

1. Useful information we like to receive
2. Interesting or enjoyable, but not useful
3. Neither interesting, enjoyable, nor useful
4. Objectionable or offensive

Appendix C2: Diary Package – Answer Booklet

UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE®

4g

Answer Booklet for:

SUNDAY

Use with the Question Booklet

Please send us your mail pieces with your completed Answer Booklets.
(keep the contents of the mail piece if it's something you need)

Thanks for your Help!

222891

Summary Page

Please print clearly as in the example below:

1 OR 20

Use a pen in black or blue ink
DO NOT USE PENCIL

Did not Receive or Send any Mail/Packages Today: → ☐

(If no mail received or sent, mark the box above with an "X." You are done for today.)

Mail RECEIVED Sunday: ☐ **Total # Received**

Record the total number of mail received above and then record for each mail type below.

1. **First-Class:** ☐ **Total # Received** → *GO TO PAGE 3 (PURPLE)*
2. **Presorted Standard, or Marketing Mail:** ☐ **Total # Received** → *GO TO PAGE 7 (BLUE)*
3. **Nonprofit Organization:** ☐ **Total # Received** → *GO TO PAGE 9 (GRAY)*
4. **Packages & Expedited:** ☐ **Total # Received** → *GO TO PAGE 11 (GREEN)*
5. **Magazines, Newspapers, or Other Periodicals:** ☐ **Total # Received** → *GO TO PAGE 15 (YELLOW)*
6. **Unaddressed Mail:** ☐ **Total # Received** → *GO TO PAGE 17 (PINK)*

Mail SENT Sunday: ☐ **Total # Sent**

First-Class (Envelopes and Postcards): ☐ **Total # Sent** → *GO TO PAGE 5 (PURPLE)*

Packages & Expedited: ☐ **Total # Sent** → *GO TO PAGE 13 (GREEN)*

Answer Sheet Example

Please print clearly as in the example: 1 OR 20

Use a pen in black or blue ink
DO NOT USE PENCIL

As an example, let's say you received four First-Class mail pieces on Monday. Mail Piece #1 is a First-Class postcard from a mail order company, and Mail Piece #2 is a personal letter.

1. Open the **Question Booklet** to purple page 3, **First-Class / Presorted First-Class Mail Received**.
2. For question A, your number code is either: 1 (envelope), 2 (postcard), 3 (flyer or catalog), or 4 (envelope larger than letter size) as shown on the question sheet.
3. Write a "2" for a postcard in the first column under Mail Piece #1 (see below).
4. Finish answering the remaining questions (B-J) about the postcard.
5. Answer the same questions about Mail Piece #2, the letter from a friend, on the same page in the column under Mail Piece #2, then continue to record Mail Pieces #3 and #4.

Mail Piece #1
Postcard

Mail Piece #2
Personal Letter

Answer Sheet — Purple

First-Class / Presorted First-Class Mail Received

Answer questions about each mail piece down the columns.
There are columns for up to 12 pieces of mail.

Questions are in the Question Booklet.	Mail Piece #1	Mail Piece #2	Mail Piece #3	Mail Piece #4	Mail Piece #5	Mail Piece #6	Mail Piece #7	Mail Piece #8	Mail Piece #9	Mail Piece #10	Mail Piece #11	Mail Piece #12
A. FORM	2	1	2	1	1							
B. ADDRESSEE	1	2	1	3	3							
C. RETURN ENVELOPE	3	3	3	2	3							
D. SENDER TYPE	10	32	16	1	27							
E. PURPOSE	9	4	9	7	6							
F. ADVERTISING				1	2							
G. READING	2		1	3								
H. REACTION	3		1	1								
I. RESPONSE	2		1	3								
J. CLASS OK to choose up to 4 codes. *(See example on pg. 2)*	1 4	3	2 5	1 4	1 4	9						

Monday — 877714 — Page 3

Match to question on the First-Class / Presorted First-Class Mail Received "Question Sheet."

See the "Question Sheet" for the list of codes for each question.

For questions where it is "Select all that apply," you can record up to four codes.

Sunday — 777483 — **Page 2**

First-Class / Presorted First-Class Mail Received

Answer questions about each mail piece down the columns. There are columns for up to 12 pieces of mail.

Questions are in the Question Booklet.	Mail Piece #1	Mail Piece #2	Mail Piece #3	Mail Piece #4	Mail Piece #5	Mail Piece #6	Mail Piece #7	Mail Piece #8	Mail Piece #9	Mail Piece #10	Mail Piece #11	Mail Piece #12
A. FORM												
B. ADDRESSEE												
C. RETURN ENVELOPE												
D. SENDER TYPE												
E. PURPOSE												
F. ADVERTISING												
G. READING												
H. REACTION												
I. RESPONSE												
J. CLASS **OK to choose up to 4 codes.** *(See example on pg. 2)*												

First-Class /Presorted First-Class Mail Received

Specify other answers and/or provide comments here

Mail Piece #	Question Letter	Specify Other Answers or Comments

First-Class Mail Sent

Answer questions about each mail piece down the columns.
There are columns for up to 12 pieces of mail.

Questions are in the Question Booklet.	Mail Piece #1	Mail Piece #2	Mail Piece #3	Mail Piece #4	Mail Piece #5	Mail Piece #6	Mail Piece #7	Mail Piece #8	Mail Piece #9	Mail Piece #10	Mail Piece #11	Mail Piece #12
A. FORM												
B. ADDRESSEE TYPE												
C. PURPOSE												
D. AD RESPONSE												
E. AD MATERIAL												
F. RETURN ENVELOPE												
G. SPECIAL SVCS **OK to choose up to 2 codes.**												
H. PO BOX												
I. POSTAGE TYPE												

First-Class Mail Sent

Specify other answers and/or provide comments here

Mail Piece #	Question Letter	Specify Other Answers or Comments

Answer Sheet

Blue

Presorted Standard or Marketing Mail Received

Answer questions about each mail piece down the columns.
There are columns for up to 12 pieces of mail.

Questions are in the Question Booklet.	Mail Piece #1	Mail Piece #2	Mail Piece #3	Mail Piece #4	Mail Piece #5	Mail Piece #6	Mail Piece #7	Mail Piece #8	Mail Piece #9	Mail Piece #10	Mail Piece #11	Mail Piece #12
A. ADDRESSEE												
B. FORM												
C. MULTIPLE												
D. SENDER TYPE												
E. FAMILIARITY												
F. RETURN ENVELOPE												
G. READING												
H. REACTION												
I. COUPONS												
J. PURPOSE												
K. RESPONSE												
L. CLASS OK to choose up to 4 codes. *(See example on pg. 2)*												

Presorted Standard or Marketing Mail Received

Specify other answers and/or provide comments here

Mail Piece #	Question Letter	Specify Other Answers or Comments

Nonprofit Organization Mail Received

Answer questions about each mail piece down the columns.
There are columns for up to 12 pieces of mail.

Questions are in the Question Booklet.	Mail Piece #1	Mail Piece #2	Mail Piece #3	Mail Piece #4	Mail Piece #5	Mail Piece #6	Mail Piece #7	Mail Piece #8	Mail Piece #9	Mail Piece #10	Mail Piece #11	Mail Piece #12
A. ADDRESSEE												
B. FORM												
C. MULTIPLE												
D. SENDER TYPE												
E. FAMILIARITY												
F. RETURN ENVELOPE												
G. READING												
H. REACTION												
I. COUPONS												
J. PURPOSE												
K. RESPONSE												
L. CLASS OK to choose up to 4 codes. *(See example on pg. 2)*												

Nonprofit Organization Mail Received

Specify other answers and/or provide comments here

Mail Piece #	Question Letter	Specify Other Answers or Comments

Packages & Expedited Materials Received

Answer questions about each mail piece down the columns.
There are columns for up to 12 packages.

Questions are in the Question Booklet.	Mail Piece #1	Mail Piece #2	Mail Piece #3	Mail Piece #4	Mail Piece #5	Mail Piece #6	Mail Piece #7	Mail Piece #8	Mail Piece #9	Mail Piece #10	Mail Piece #11	Mail Piece #12
A. FORM												
B. ADDRESSEE												
C. CONTENTS OK to choose up to 4 codes. *(See example on pg. 2)*												
D. SENDER TYPE												
E. WHO ORDERED												
E2. HOW ORDERED												
F. AD RESPONSE												
G. RETURN ENVELOPE												
H. ADVERTISING												
I. READING												
J. REACTION												
K. RESPONSE												
L. SPECIAL SVCS OK to choose up to 2 codes.												
M. SHIP & DELIV OK to choose up to 2 codes.												
N. CLASS OK to choose up to 4 codes. *(See example on pg. 2)*												

Packages & Expedited Materials Received

Specify other answers and/or provide comments here

Mail Piece #	Question Letter	Specify Other Answers or Comments

Packages & Expedited Materials Sent

Answer questions about each mail piece down the columns.
There are columns for up to 12 pieces of mail.

Questions are in the Question Booklet.	Mail Piece #1	Mail Piece #2	Mail Piece #3	Mail Piece #4	Mail Piece #5	Mail Piece #6	Mail Piece #7	Mail Piece #8	Mail Piece #9	Mail Piece #10	Mail Piece #11	Mail Piece #12
A. FORM												
B. CONTENTS OK to choose up to 4 codes. *(See example on pg. 2)*												
C. ADDRESSEETYPE												
D. AD RESPONSE												
E. AD MATERIAL												
F. DISTANCE												
G. REASON												
H. SPECIAL SVCS OK to choose up to 2 codes.												
I. CLASS OK to choose up to 4 codes. *(See example on pg. 2)*												

Packages & Expedited Materials Sent

Specify other answers and/or provide comments here

Mail Piece #	Question Letter	Specify Other Answers or Comments

Magazines, Newspapers, or Other Periodicals Received

Answer questions about each mail piece down the columns. There are columns for up to 12 pieces of mail.

Questions are in the Question Booklet.	Mail Piece #1	Mail Piece #2	Mail Piece #3	Mail Piece #4	Mail Piece #5	Mail Piece #6	Mail Piece #7	Mail Piece #8	Mail Piece #9	Mail Piece #10	Mail Piece #11	Mail Piece #12
A. TYPE												
B. SENDER TYPE												
C. SUBSCRIPTION												
D. ARRIVAL TIME												
E. DELIVERY												

Magazines, Newspapers, or Other Periodicals Received

Specify other answers and/or provide comments here

Mail Piece #	Question Letter	Specify Other Answers or Comments

Answer Sheet

Pink

Unaddressed Mail Received

Answer questions about each mail piece down the columns.
There are columns for up to 12 pieces of mail.

Questions are in the Question Booklet.	Mail Piece #1	Mail Piece #2	Mail Piece #3	Mail Piece #4	Mail Piece #5	Mail Piece #6	Mail Piece #7	Mail Piece #8	Mail Piece #9	Mail Piece #10	Mail Piece #11	Mail Piece #12
A. CONTENTS												
B. SENDER TYPE												
C. FAMILIARITY												
D. READING												
E. REACTION												

Unaddressed Mail Received

Specify other answers and/or provide comments here

Mail Piece #	Question Letter	Specify Other Answers or Comments

Appendix C2: Diary Package – Diary Envelope

UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE®

5a

MONDAY

Insert your Mail Pieces and completed Answer Booklet for Monday in this envelope.
At the end of your recording week, please send all your Daily envelopes *(with the completed Answer Booklets and Mail Pieces in each),* in the postage-paid Priority Mail envelope provided.
Thanks for your Help!

Appendix C2: Diary Package – Gift Selection Forms

Gift Selection Form for households eligible for the additional $10 incentive.

UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE.

Gift Selection Form

6

In appreciation for your participation, choose ONE of the following gifts*:

- ⬭ Forty dollars
- ⬭ 100 First-Class stamps

* Please allow 10-12 weeks for processing

Make any changes to your name and address below (please print clearly):

Households eligible for the additional incentive, please select one:
- ◯ Wal-Mart
- ◯ Amazon.com

«SAMPN»-«ASSIGN»

«FIRSTNAME» «LASTNAME»
«ADDRESS»
«CITY», «STATE» «ZIP»

_____
Name

_____ _____
Street number Street name (include apt. or unit #)

_____
City, State, and Zip

(_____) _____ - _____
Telephone number

Mail this form back with your Mail Pieces and completed Answer Booklets!

Gift Selection Form for all other households.

UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE.

Gift Selection Form

6

In appreciation for your participation, choose ONE of the following gifts*:

- ⬭ Forty dollars
- ⬭ 100 First-Class stamps

* Please allow 10-12 weeks for processing

Make any changes to your name and address below (please print clearly):

«SAMPN»-«ASSIGN»

«FIRSTNAME» «LASTNAME»
«ADDRESS»
«CITY», «STATE» «ZIP»

Name

Street number Street name (include apt. or unit #)

City, State, and Zip

( ) -

Telephone number

Mail this form back with your Mail Pieces and completed Answer Booklets!

Appendix C2: Diary Package – "I'm Done…" Card

I'm done, what do I send back? 7

1. Completed **Answer Booklets** & **Mail Pieces** for each day in the corresponding Daily envelope.



Mail Pieces



Answer Booklets



Daily Envelopes

2. **Gift Selection form** with your choice of gift selected.



3. Place Daily envelopes and Gift Form in the **postage-paid Priority Mail envelope.** Drop in any public U.S. Postal Service mail box or at your local post office.

